The Joker and The Princess

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Explicit

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Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Princess Adora (She-Ra), Magicat Catra (She-Ra), Oblivious Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Jealous Catra (She-Ra), Manipulative Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), catra joker, Alternate Universe - Royalty, Jealous Adora (She-Ra), Protective Catra (She-Ra), Protective Adora (She-Ra)

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by masternoveller

Summary

Catra and Adora grew up together in a castle where Adora is a Princess and her parents are alive.
Catra is framed for stealing and treason, resulting in a sentence of death.
Shadow Weaver wants power. She wants to rid Adora and her family. But is she working alone or is this part of a bigger plot?

Will our heroes be able to stop Shadow Weaver's plan?

Notes

I'll be updating this one haphazardly...so yeah.
It's a work in progress hence the haphazardly updates.

Frame Up

The Joker aka Catra.

The Princess aka Adora.

They've been friends since Catra had been taken in by the castle's lost children drive. Catra wasn't lost. Her family had perished in one of the many wars around the lands. Prime's armies were always a threat. They only sought blind allegiance. A dictator who had a lust for power was simply insatiable. Catra's village stood no chance. Almost everyone died. It was pure luck that Catra had wandered off from the village on the day of the attack. She was 3 years old, for humans that is no age to let your child wander off. But she was no human after all. She was a hybrid. A magicat. Half humanoid and half cat. She had a name back then. One that she refuses to use now. It always brought back bad memories and nightmares that took years to get over. So, when she met Adora for the first time, the blonde girl gave her a name. She liked the blonde girl well enough that she kept that name. Catra didn't know at the time that Adora was actually Princess Adora, she was just Catra's one and only friend growing up. Eventually she made a few more friends as they got older, but the two of them would always remain close.
As they both turned 18, Catra was employed as the Court Jester or as Adora liked to call it, the Joker. Catra provided the light entertainment for the King and Queen, mostly playing a funny limerick on her guitar, telling a funny story or performing feats of acrobatic agilities that came easily to the magicat. It always seemed to amaze Catra that even after all this time, Adora would still find her antics amusing and keep her to herself well after court had ended, often they would be tucked away in Adora's room when all the proceedings were finished. There was always talk of Adora finding a suitor. It had become more prevalent now that Adora had turned 18. Many balls and formals were held in the name of finding the perfect suitor for Adora, but Catra knew deep down that Adora only had eyes for her. And Adora had Catra's heart firmly in her hands. They'd danced around the notion more

times than they could count, but until Catra could prove herself worthy, they'd have to dance around it for a while longer. It made Catra insanely jealous watching men and women fawn over her princess. Whispering words into her ear, touching her arm, back or shoulders, dancing with her or making her laugh. All of it made Catra grit her teeth. But she couldn't look away. She had to watch. She was made to watch. Standing on the right of the King, Catra had been trained to also be the King's personal bodyguard. Not that anyone else was aware. Not even Adora. The King and Queen had made it clear to Catra that she was not worthy of their daughter and as an act to earn it, she had volunteered herself to be the right hand of the King. She had taken a vow to protect the crown at all costs. Still, the royals did not think it worthy enough. Catra would not give up. Not when she was so close.

Court had just ended, Catra collected her guitar and followed the royals out of the room, watching their backs. When the King and Queen were safely back in their chambers, Adora pulls Catra away and into her room by the elbow.
"Catra!" Her voice 2 octaves higher as a smile reaches her eyes.
"Hey Adora," Catra eyes the princess, "What trouble are you going to get me into this time?"
"Pfft! I don't get you into trouble!" Adora pouts, "You get yourself into trouble." A cheeky grin on her face makes Catra smile back, her fangs sticking out from her lips, "Come back to my room, would you?"
"Sure, Princess." Catra rolls her eyes as she smirks, "You know people might start getting ideas with the way you keep pulling me into your bedroom?"
A nervous giggle and a flush of red coats Adora's cheeks, "Shut up!" she shoves Catra's shoulder playfully, "And it's Princess Adora to you."
Catra laughs, "Are you sure you want me to be so formal, Princess Adora?"
Adora's blush deepens, "No." she replies softly, "And I don't care what people think. You're my best friend. Everyone knows that."
The matter-of-fact tone dampens Catra's mood a little. She just sighs and nods, "Of course Princess. Take me to your bedroom."

Adora beams as she pulls Catra by the hand towards her bedroom door, “Wait.” Adora stops, “Let me get the door for you Princess.”
Catra gestures for Adora to step aside.
“I can open my own door.” Adora whines, “You don’t have to do it for my every time you know.”
“I know.” Catra simply says as she opens the door and steps inside first, “But safety first. If someone was planning to attack you, they’d have to go through me first.”
Adora giggles, “Are you going to protect me too?”
“Yes Princess.” Catra answers crossing her arms and looking a little annoyed at Adora’s implication, “I can be the Joker and your protector.”
As they both sit down on Adora’s bed, Adora pulls Catra into a hug, “You are my Joker. I am your protector. Remember?” Catra chuckles as Adora pulls back from the hug with a frown on her face, “It’s true! I’m the one with the sword training and all.”
Catra remembers that Adora doesn’t know that she’d been trained up to protect her mother and father from all dangers in public. She also remembers another thing about what Adora has just said, “Oh, I remember Princess.” Catra chuckles again, “I remember being your punching bag for years.”
“It’s not my fault you didn’t want to learn it too.” Adora pouts, “Besides, no one would spar with me.”
“That’s because they were too scared to hurt the princess.” Catra simply replies, “Besides getting my assed kicked by you was definitely more fun than doing chores around the castle.”
Adora’s eyes light back up, feeling proud that she could defend herself if she needed to. “Thank you by the way.” Her voice is so earnest it breaks down all of the walls Catra has built up, “I don’t know what I would have done if you never came here.”
Catra wraps her arms around Adora, her tail resting in Adora’s lap as she lets the blonde stroke it, “I guess you’d have more friends and less scars.”
“You mean your adolescent clawing phase?” Adora jeers, “I like them. Makes me look badass.”
Catra snorts a laugh, “You definitely are badass, Princess.” Nudging Adora playfully and then wrapping her tighter against her. “I heard from your father that he is planning to hold another

formal to find you a suitor."
Adora scoffs, "Ugh! I hate this so much!" She throws her hands up in annoyance before going back to stroking Catra's tail, "I just wish they'd let me find my suitor in my own time."
"They're just looking out for you." Catra goes for a formal approach, "I don't know if you've noticed though," Catra pauses as Adora looks into her eyes, "your father has a really good eye for other princesses. I mean did you see the one last month. Her body…I mean, woah!"
Adora frowns and Catra can see the jealous glint in her eye, "She wasn't even that interesting."
Catra cackles, "Yeah, but she was hot."
"Catra!" Adora whines, "Stop."
"What? I'm not doing anything." Catra acts all innocent, "Besides at least you have a chance with them. All I get is looked down upon. As your father so aptly put it, I am not worthy to have a princess of my own."
Adora's eyes widen, "Father said that?"
Catra nods, "He's not a bad guy, Adora. I mean I understand where he's coming from." Catra takes a breath in, "It's just so hard, you know?" Adora shakes her head, so Catra explains. "Well, here's the thing Princess. I'm surrounded by the upper class all day, every day. I keep my eyes down as it's offensive for me to look another member of the court, let alone a Princess in the eyes. But this is my life. The life that was chosen for me. And I really can't complain because if it wasn't chosen for me, I would probably be living out on the streets somewhere begging for food and money. So, when the King tells me I'm not worthy for a Princess, well I take that as a challenge." A mischievous grin appears on Catra's face as she finishes her sentence, "So, I plan to make myself worthy of any Princess in the lands."
Adora huffs a little, "Which princess have you got your eye on, huh?" Her tone sounding angrier than questioning, "Who are you trying to make yourself worthy for?"
Before Catra can answer, Adora's parents burst through the door with a few guards behind them. At the very back, a familiar figure, Shadow Weaver, the royal's advisor. Or as Catra likes to call her the resident snake.

“Catra!” the King angrily speaks, “You need to leave, now!”
“Father. What is going on?” Adora asked confused at what is unfolding, “Why have you come bursting into my room?”
“Adora, stay out of this please dear.” Her mother says sternly as Catra gets up from the bed and stands before the King and Queen.
“Your majesties, can I ask what is happening right now?” Catra’s eyes darting between the pair, “I don’t understand what is going on right now.”
“I trusted you!” the King grunts out, “And you have betrayed me.” He pulls out a sword from his belt. It’s the Sword of Power. The royal sword. “Then tell me Jester, why did we find this in your belongings?”
Catra eyes the sword, “Your majesty,” her words are shaky, “I swear I don’t know how that got there.”
“Save it!” The King almost growls, it makes Catra cower in place, “Do not lie to me.”
“Sir, I am not lying.” Catra stays frozen in place, “I have never stolen anything from this castle in my life.”
“Ah…” A satisfied hum comes from Shadow Weaver, “So, you admit to stealing outside of these castle walls?” Catra shuts her mouth quickly, it’s no secret that she wasn’t always the upstanding citizen, not that she was one now either, but her past, her younger, wilder years would always be a mark against her name. Another reason the King deemed her unworthy of courting a Princess. His daughter of all things. “Well? Speak.” Shadow Weaver continued, “If you have nothing to hide, then answer my question.”
Everyone stared at Catra, suddenly she was hit with guilt and embarrassment at the actions of her former self, “Majesties, I’ve changed. You know that.” Catra begins, “I have sworn on my life to protect this family.”
Adora gasps. She did not know this. “Catra?” Catra doesn’t turn, “Is this true? But, when did you take this oath? Show me the mark.”
Her father steps in, “Catra swore the oath on her sixteenth birthday. The day she swore to give up her misguided ways.” He rubs his temples in frustration, “But, I see that the oath you swore

meant nothing to you.”
“That’s not true!” Catra protests, “I don’t know how the sword got into my belongings.”
“There are only a few people in this entire kingdom that know about this sword, Catra.” The Queen states unemotionally, “Your markings are all over the handle. It was hidden within your belongings. What do you expect us to think?”
“My markings?”
The King holds the handle to Catra, there are claw marks along it, “If this is not enough proof, I suggest you come up with a more plausible explanation.”
“My Lord,” Shadow Weaver cuts in, eying the sword in his hands, “perhaps it is time for the Jester to depart.” Catra glares at the witch of a woman, “If you would like, I can escort the thief to the cells below.”
“What? No!” Adora yells, “You can’t just throw her in jail.”
Catra turns to Adora looking deflated and defeated, “I’m sorry Princess Adora. It seems I’ve been set up.” She takes Adora’s left hand and places a chaste kiss on the back of it, “I think this may the last time we see each other.”
Catra steps back as two guards arrest her. “Father wait!” Adora pleads, “What are you going to do with her?”
“The punishment for treason is death.” Shadow Weaver almost beams as she says it, “Not to mention stealing from within and outside of these castles walls.” She reaches out and cups Adora’s face, which Adora shakes off quickly, stepping back and looking at her friend with scared eyes, “Do not worry Princess Adora. I will make sure her punishment is carried out swiftly. Painlessly.”
“Father! Mother! You can’t do this!” Adora sobs, her pleas are dismissed as Catra is led out of Adora’s bedroom, followed by the rest of the guards and the King, his face is red with anger and sadness. The Queen hangs back with her daughter, “Please mother! How can you let Catra be put to death?”
“I’m sorry Adora.” The Queen simply says, “I know you two are friends. But she should have known better.”
“But she says she didn’t do it.” Adora all but stomps her foot, “You didn’t even give her a chance.”
“She said her part.” Adora’s mother waved her hand, “I’m sorry

again Adora. I thought she had changed as well. But I guess old habits die hard." She breathed in, "Perhaps it's just in her basal instincts. You know she had a streak of self-destruction for a while back. I thought she had gotten over it. Perhaps it's knowing that she will never be worthy enough for you has pushed her over that edge."
"Worthy for me?" Adora asks puzzled, "Why would she need to be worthy for me? She's my best friend."
"Oh my…" Adora's mother pursed her lips, "I did not think you were so oblivious." Adora gives her mother a heated look but still not understanding what she meant, "Adora, have you not noticed how she gets when we hold those formals and balls so you can find a suitor?"
"No."
"The way she looks at you every time you interact with a potential suitor, it's torture for her." Her mother moves to take Adora's hand, "But she is well aware of how we feel about her. Yes, we love her. But she is not worthy enough for you." Gently squeezing Adora's hand, "You will get over her. Once you find your suitor it will get easier."
Adora pulls her hand away, tears run down her face, "I love her." The words are so soft it's almost as if Adora's telling herself what she already knows. Turning to her mother, "Please just, leave me be."
Her mother nods and walks out the doors as if nothing has happened.

This Ointment Stinks

Chapter Summary

Shadow Weaver reveals her true colours and intentions.
Catra bears the brunt of those intentions.

Chapter Notes

I didn't think I'd have chapter 2 done so quickly, but here we are.
Hopefully the spelling and grammar isn't too bad. I haven't really done a real thorough proofread.
thanks for the comments and kudos too!

Catra is roughly thrown into one of the prisoner cells located deep under the castle. She knows this place well. As a youngster, causing chaos with Adora, Catra had earned a few nights in these cells. Adora was just grounded and sent to her room. She reminisced of the times she had spent in these cells, sometimes drunk, sometimes bruised but there was never a hint of regret in those days. Catra smiled to herself as she settled on a familiar bunk along with the graffiti she had etched into the walls with her claws. This cell was her cell.
Catra sensed another figure standing on the opposite side of the bars, Shadow Weaver.
“Can I help you, witch?” Catra spat.
Shadow Weaver moved herself into full view of Catra, seemingly annoyed that she had been found out to be lurking. The woman held her hands together in front of her and approached the bars.
“You already have.” Catra growled in response which made Shadow Weaver chuckle, “It was all too easy. Especially since you’ve been so focused on the Kings daughter. Brought down my lust. How does it feel, Catra?”
Catra growled again, louder.
“What? No smart remarks? I am truly disappointed in you.” Shadow Weaver feigned emotion, her voice then turned sadistically happy, “Although, know how torturous it is for you to

watch the princess be flirted with whilst choosing a suitor, who no doubt will fulfil all of her womanly needs. Unlike you. You may have fooled her parents into thinking you've changed but you are still nothing but that sad, lonely and pathetic runt that just so happen to survive Prime's army cleansing of your village."
A cackle from Catra stunned Shadow Weaver, shaking her out of her monologue, "And what is so funny?"
"Womanly needs huh?" Catra laughed harder, "No suitor could fulfil those needs. No one in this world is worthy to fulfil those needs. That was made clear to me by her mother and father. I don't stand a chance." Catra's eyes darkened, "But you already knew that. Didn't you?"
Shadow Weaver stepped back, "I ask the questions, not you." The words gritted out through her teeth, "Besides, it's of no matter. You will be executed in the morning." The witch moved closer to the bars again, "Also, I lied to the princess, it will not be painless. I have every intent on torturing you tonight."
"Of course, you would." Catra sighs, "So do it already."
For the next 2 hours, Shadow Weaver used her dark magic to torture Catra in the small cell until eventually Catra blacked out from the pain. Only to be brought back again by electricity burning through her body as it began again. Eventually Shadow Weaver got tired and exhausted enough of her magic to continue. Catra heaved in breaths on the hard stone floors, her body ached, blood covered most of her fur and she could feel where her skin had ripped open underneath.
"Is that all you got, witch?" Catra gritted out with a tired chuckle, "I knew you couldn't kill me."
Shadow Weaver grinned wickedly, "I am not allowed to kill you." With a final wave of her hand, electricity shot through Catra's body once again, causing her to spasm where she lay, "I am not your executioner. I just have to get you there, alive."
Catra's body stopped shaking as she just stilled herself, wincing and hissing through the pain. She heard Shadow Weaver turn around and walk out of the prison cells. Once the door was shut, the cell was dark, moonlight flowed in from the only barred window in the cell as Catra pushed herself shakily off the floor and onto the cot. Once the worst of the pain subsided and her eyes

adjusted to the minimal light, she counted to ten before rolling off the bed. She paused, waiting for any signs of guards moving around. When no sounds were heard she crawled under the bed and pushed through one of the stones in the wall. It was not by chance she was thrown into this cell. A cell she had escaped from on numerous occasions during the nights only to return for the morning count as if nothing had happened. This time, she would not be returning. She pushed out the final stone and slipped through to the other side of the castle wall and stood on the ledge between the castle and the woods, separated by a moat 20m wide. She hated the water and it was going to sting with all the open wounds she had from Shadow Weavers torture session, but it was better than being executed in the morning. Hesitantly she walked into the water until her feet no longer touched the bottom before ducking her head under the water and began to swim to the other side. Once on the other side, she started walking towards the woods. Once sufficiently far enough into the woods, she climbed to the top of one of the larger trees and by then exhaustion took over and she passed out.

…

Morning came, Adora hadn't slept a wink knowing her best friend would be executed soon. She wished the night never ended and this was all just a bad dream. Unfortunately for her, it wasn't. She didn't want to get out of bed. She didn't want to watch the execution. He parents had come by earlier to tell her of the procession of the execution and what was expected of her. She stayed silent throughout the who talk. She had no intention of attending. She wasn't even allowed to say goodbye. The execution would be held in private; no public were to attend. Just enough castle guards, the advisor and the royals would be witnesses. She waited anxiously for the knock to come, to take her to execution room and then witness her friend's death. It never came. Something was wrong. She could hear arguing from outside her door. It sounded like it was getting closer to her own door. Before she knew it someone knocked harshly on her door. Adora opened it quickly.

"Where is she?" Her father asked angrily.

"Who?"

“Who do you think? Catra. Where is she?” Her father grunted, “You must know where she is.”
“I don’t know.” Adora answers confused and relieved at the same time, “I thought Shadow Weaver brought her to the prison cells.”
Shadow Weaver appeared from behind her father, “I did. She escaped.”
“And how is that my fault?” Adora put her hands on her hips, “I don’t know where she is. But wherever she is, I’m glad she escaped.”
“She must be punished!” Shadow Weaver screeched.
The King held his hand out to silence Shadow Weaver, “Enough!” he turns to the castle guards, “Find her now!” He turns back to Adora, “If I find out you had anything to do with this, I will pick your suitor for you.”
“You can’t do that!” Adora returns seething, “It’s my choice. Not yours!”
The King mirrors his daughter’s stance, hands on his hips, “I will and I can change the rules if I please.”
“What makes you think I had anything to do with her escaping?” Adora counters, crossing her arms over her chest, “If it was up to me, I would have gone with her. Did you check her cell? Maybe she’s hiding under the bed or something, I don’t know!”
“Shadow Weaver checked already.” The King responded, “But let us go and take a look for ourselves, shall we?”
Adora nodded, then realised she was still dressed in her sleepwear, “Let me get changed first.”
“My Lord, that is not necessary.” Shadow Weaver cut in, “I did a thorough check this morning and she was not anywhere to be found. There are not many places in a prison cell to hide.”
“I still want to check for myself.” The King responds, waiting outside with Shadow Weaver for Adora to finish changing, “She can’t have gone far.”
Once Adora is ready, the three of them set off to the prison cells. Shadow Weaver leads them to Catra’s cell only to be met with a loud gasp from Adora upon seeing the bloody mess on the floor.
“What did you do to her?” Adora seethes, her hands balled into fists, “Why is there so much blood?”
“It’s not her blood.” Shadow Weavers says offhandedly, “That

blood was there before I put her in the cell."
Adora steps around the blood and calls out the blatant lie, "If that is so, why is their fur mixed in with this blood? Catra doesn't go around rolling in blood as far as I know." Before Shadow Weaver can answer, Adora puts her hand up to stop her, "And don't tell me it's not her fur. Because I know that's a lie. I know Catra's fur. And this, is her fur. Now, what did you do to her?"
The King turned and glared at his advisor, "Tell us what you did."
Shadow Weaver sighed as she thought up a lie, "Catra was resisting, so I had to use some…persuasion, to get her into the cell. Then she began acting aggressively towards me, so I did what I had to do to defend myself."
Adora scoffed at that answer as her father put his hand on her shoulder and squeezed, "I've heard enough." He turns to Shadow Weaver, "I am putting you in charge of finding Catra and bringing her back here alive."
"Yes, my King." Shadow Weaver half bows and walks out.
"Shadow Weaver." The King says before she walks out entirely, "Do not hurt her again. You are not the executioner."
Shadow Weaver only nods as she disappears outside the prison cells.
"Adora?" The King's voice softens as he sits on the bed in the cell, "Catra cannot come back here. She stole from us. She has betrayed her oath."
"But she wouldn't!" Adora protests, "It's not true! I know it isn't."
"The evidence against her is too great to ignore. I'm sorry." He puts a reassuring hand on Adora's shoulder before getting up and moving out of the cell. He turns back, "I really liked her too. She seemed to have really changed her way since taking the oath."
Adora stands alone in the cell. Her eyes flow over the blood on the floor. On the bed. Under the bed. That was strange. Why would there be blood under the bed. She stood back and peeked under the bed. It didn't seem like there was anything under there. Adora moved the bed away from the wall and that's when she saw bloody prints on the stone bricks. Catra had escaped through the wall. Adora prayed that she was safe and not too badly hurt. She quickly moved the bed back and headed out to the other side of the prison wall, where Catra would have come through.

She walked around the castle, carefully inspecting the stone bricks where the prison wall would approximately be. It was easy enough to find since the bricks that Catra had put back were stained with blood. Adora ran her fingers over those bricks as a wave of worry hit her. She turned around and faced the moat. Catra hated the water with a passion. She would never have willingly crossed this body of water unless she had no choice. As she stood on the bank of the moat, she saw something glint in the reeds. It was Catra's pocket knife. Catra had been here. She must have dropped it while crossing the river. Adora held the folded knife tight in her hand for a second before pocketing the item, staring across the moat one last time before heading back into the castle.

…

Catra woke up with the shock of nearly falling out of the tree she had fallen asleep in last night. Her body hurt. Her cuts hurt. She hoped her cuts wouldn't be infected by the moat water. She needed to get medical supplies to properly clean her wounds, but what she really needed right now was water. Once she got control of her limbs, she gingerly climbs down the tree and lands unsteadily on the ground below. She knows there will be a search party out looking for her soon, she has delayed her execution for now, but it'll only be a matter of time before she's hauled back to the castle to face her punishment, one that she doesn't deserve. She knows Shadow Weaver is behind this. Which also means that the witch is looking to do something to the King and Queen. But they've essentially cast her out, facing death. Time to start walking as far away from the castle, from Adora, as she can.

She comes across a small house in the middle of the woods, it's the first time she's seen it here but the house looks like it has been here for a long time. Strange that. In her need for water, she stumbles over to the house and knocks on the door. Almost immediately, the door swings open and an old lady with big white hair and a broom appears.

"Ah, Catra!" She says, "Razz has missed you!"

"Razz?"

"Yes dearie?" Razz replies, "Oh, look at you. Come on in. We need to get you cleaned up before those cuts get infected. Razz has the

perfect ointment for that."
"Do I, do I know you?" Catra asked feeling very confused, "Or am I that out of it right now that I'm dreaming this whole thing up."
Razz was about to whack Catra over the head with her broom before she thought better of it, "Come inside Catra. You're letting all the flies out."
Surprisingly, Razz was very strong, pulling Catra into the house in one quick tug and then pushing her to lay down on the couch.
Catra was stunned, "Uh, listen lady, you're really nice and all but I don't think this is right."
"Oh shush!" Razz snapped at Catra, going through her kitchen and grabbing the ointment, "I am very aware that you and Adora are together. It's just so perfect. Now stay still while I apply the ointment onto your cuts."
Catra froze when she felt Razz grab her arm, the ointment looked like mould and smelt even worse. As soon as Razz applied it onto Catra's arm, Catra flinched away, hissing in pain. "What the hell is this stuff?"
"It works!" Razz said making grabby motions at Catra to come back, "Take a look."
Once the burning sensation died down, Catra took a good look at the cut which was stitching itself back together, forming a neat scar in its place. "But…how?"
"Come back here child!" Razz scolded as Catra stood still, the old woman grabbed the magicat by the elbow and pushed her back onto the couch, "Now, stay still. We have a lot more to apply."
Catra hissed through the ordeal, but she stayed as still as she could so Razz could get to all the open wounds. Razz finished up and moved to put the ointment away back in the kitchen. Catra poked, "Can I get up now?"
"Why yes. Could you not get up before?" Razz asked quizzically, "You are young after all."
Catra sat up and watched the old woman wander around her kitchen, "Thank you Razz." She rubbed her temples, squeezing her eyes shut for a moment, "Can I have some water? Please?"
"Ah, such manners!" Razz exclaimed happily, "You lacked such manners when you were a child."
"Wait, how… you know what, nevermind." Catra sat back as Razz

fetched her some water, she chugged it down quickly and then stood up, “Thank you again. I have to go now.”
Razz just smiled back, “Yes dearie. Please take care of yourself and Adora.”
Catra nodded as she headed for the door, “You said we’ve met before this?”
“Ah, such a long time ago.” Razz looked like she was reminiscing, “With a young mind like yours, I would hope that you would maintain more memories. Try not to get hit in the head too much dearie.”
Knowing that there was no use in trying to make sense of any of this, Catra nodded once more, opened the door and stepped out, shutting the door behind her. As she neared the edge of the house gardens Razz come out one last time, “Oh dearie!” She shouted, “Be careful of the witch and the evil man.”
“Great…riddles.” Catra mumbled under her breath, she nodded once again, then waved a goodbye and started back into the woods.
Catra walked through the woods towards the small village on the other side of the woods, she hoped this village would be welcoming and that news of her so-called betrayal had not yet reached these parts. She was just apart to step out into the open when she heard a familiar voice. Instantly she began to climb the closest tree, getting out of sight but not too far that her ears couldn’t hear what was being said. Shadow Weaver was talking to another person behind the tavern. The motifs the on the individuals clothing meant they worked for Prime. Catra listened into the conversation closely.
Shadow Weaver huffed, “Do not tell me what to do! You know how strong my magic is. I can destroy you on the spot if I so choose!” Her threat didn’t seem to deter the Prime soldier, “Tell Prime, I will have the kingdom cleansed in a week.”
“He will not be pleased, witch!” the Soldiers gruff voice indicating annoyance, “I will not die because of your incompetence, you hear me.”
“Yes, I hear you.” Shadow Weaver seethed, suddenly the soldier grunted in pain. The familiar sparks of Shadow Weaver’s magic burning the soldier in his armour, “Do not push me!”

She released him, “You fucking bitch!” He screamed but still unable to get off his knee on the ground, “Prime will hear of this!”
“No.” Shadow Weaver said calmly, “You will tell him I will poison the King and Queen in a weeks’ time when they have Princess Adora’s masquerade ball to find her a suitor. Once they are dead, we will use the Princess and bend her to our own needs.”
The soldier finally got up, “This better fucking work!” He brushed off his armour bottoms of dirt, “If it doesn’t…”
“You’ll what?” Shadow Weaver mocked, “I’ll kill you myself before you even step foot on this land again. Now take my message back to Prime.” The soldier glared at her, “Go now! Do not cross me!”
The soldier huffed as he got up. He stepped back a few steps and pushed a few buttons on his wrist controller, “This better work witch! I’m going to enjoy Prime ripping you apart.” With that last little snark, he teleported out of sight.
Shadow Weaver remained for a moment. She scoffed and threw an energy bolt at a tree just to the left of the one Catra was perched in. Under her breath she muttered, “That wretched animal better show up soon. I should have killed her last night.”
Catra’s eyes widen, she always thought she’d be safe from Shadow Weaver if she was in the castle, but the last revelation meant her thoughts were very wrong. Shadow Weaver pulled out a vile of green liquid, she held it up to the sun, staring at it, laughing wickedly at it. The very sound sent chills down Catra’s spine. Finally Shadow Weaver left the town. Catra made sure she was gone and there were no castle guards around before she hopped down from her tree. She looked around the town and saw her face plastered on posters taped to the walls, with the words in bold lettering; WANTED FOR TREASON. BY ORDER OF THE KING. DO NOT KILL. EXECUTION IMMINENT UPON ARRIVAL. REWARD $50,000.
Fuck.

New Old Friends

Chapter Summary

Catra meets Netossa and Spinneralla.
Catra also really needs to see Adora again to warn her about Shadow Weaver.

Chapter Notes

Here's the next chapter update.
I'm really enjoying writing this one.
Thanks for reading!
And apologies if there's some spelling or grammatical errors...my brain goes faster than my fingers can type sometimes.

Catra paces up and down on the edge of the woods, muttering to herself when two women approach her. They look like a couple.
“Hey kid!” the one with big silver hair calls out.
Catra stops. Shit, she’s been caught. Instead of running all Catra can muster up is a weak response, “Yeah?”
“You keep pacing, you’re going to need a ladder to get yourself out of that hole.” The woman with purple hair nudges her partner, the silver haired woman continues, “May I ask why you are walking up a storm in our front yard?”
“Front yard?” Catra looks around and sure enough it is a front yard, a neat little house with a footpath not too far away, how did she miss that? “Um, sorry about that. I’ll just be leaving.”
“Hey! Wait a minute!” The silver haired woman yells out, Catra turns to walk away, “We know the rumours circulating about you are lies!”
Catra stops, “What? What did you say?”
The woman with the purple hair takes a few tentative steps forward, her arms up in surrender, “Listen, Catra right?” Catra nods, “Prime’s armies have been in and out of this town. We’ve overheard a lot of things. And I’m sure you probably caught on to Shadow Weaver’s little conversation as well.” Another nod, “So,

come with us."
"How can I trust you aren't going to turn me in for a reward?" Catra asks, eyes squinted, she crossed her arms in front of her, waiting for an answer.
"You don't." The purple one says, "But I'm also guessing you don't remember how you got into the orphanage drive all those years ago. We picked you up, out of those woods. We delivered you to the footsteps of the castle." Catra swallows deeply, she doesn't remember any of this, "We would have taken you in ourselves, but we were so young back then. It would have been irresponsibly of us to take you in and then not be able to take care of you."
Catra stared at the two women, trying to access the deepest parts of her memories. Flashes of memories zipped in and out of her brain but then something stuck. "Tell me about this." Catra pointed to the scar that ran from her thumb to just below her elbow, she pulled the sleeve back down, crossed her arms again and waited.
"Spinny was there. I only saw the aftermath." The silver haired one said.
"It's okay dear." Spinny replied with a gentle smile. She turns back to Catra, "If I tell you, will you come inside with us?"
Catra nods.
Spinny sighs, "You had just found out your village was burnt to the ground. You came across the bodies of your family and you ran this way. I don't know how long your ran for but when you arrived here, you were about to drop dead from dehydration. A Prime soldier beamed down in front of this house." She gestured to the house behind them, "It was my house when my family was still around. Anyways, the soldier beams down and saw you. He was about to report it back to the base when you attacked him. But being so small, you were overpowered. That scar is when you fought for your life. The knife went from your elbow, down to your thumb. I watched you claw the knife out of that soldier's hand and then take that same knife and stab him with it. You killed him."
Spinny laughed at the sadistic memory, "We were stunned to see someone so small and so young could be so vicious."
Catra touched the scar with her claw and looked at the women, astonished. "You better have food in there." Catra muttered as she

walked towards the house.
“By all means, come in kid.” The silver haired woman spoke, “By the way, I am Netossa and this is my wife Spinnerella.”
Catra chuckled, “Seriously?” the two women looked affronted by Catra’s reaction before their faces morphed into something softer when Catra mumbled just loud enough for them to hear, “Better than being named after a house pet.”
Netossa led Catra inside and gestured for her to sit at the table, “Make yourself at home. Just no feet up on the tables. You aren’t wearing shoes.” Catra raised an eyebrow at her teasingly then raised her hands in surrender, “Why’d you change your name? And why did you become the court jester?”
A small smile creeps onto Catra’s face, “The princess calls me her joker.” Catra snapped herself out of her reverie as she watched the two women look at each other, “You know? Because the joker is a wild card?”
The two women laugh at their own inside joke, “The princess huh? She thinks you’re…wild?”
Realising that the two women were teasing her, Catra sits back upright, “Shut up.” Her face feeling hot, “Do you have water or food or something?”
Spinneralla turns towards the kitchen and pours some water into a glass, bringing it back to Catra, “Here you go, love.”
“Thank you.” Catra graciously accepts the drink and once again chugs it down.
“I have some bread if you are hungry.” Looking at the hungry look in Catra’s eyes, Spinnerella takes a bread roll and hands it over to Catra, “Here, take it. Eat.”
“Thank you again.” Catra feel embarrassed at accepting the food, she can see the two women are not exactly the most well off. But their home feels inviting and the two wives don’t seem malicious.
“I need to get back to the castle to warn Adora.”
“Woah! Hang on!” Netossa steps in front of Catra blocking her way out, “In case you haven’t noticed, your face is everywhere. Plus, that reward is no laughing matter.”
Catra groans, “Okay…then what do you suggest I do?”
Netossa rubs her chin in thought, “Aha! We need to get you a disguise!”

“Or…” Catra jumps in, “I’ll just wait until dark and sneak back into her room.”
“You’re just going to sneak into the Princess’ bedroom? At night?” Netossa gives Catra a smug grin, “Seems like you’ve done this more than once.”
Catra’s face heats up, the blush under her fur on her face as she clears her throat, “It’s not like that.” Catra closes her eyes and takes a breath, “It can’t be like that. The King would never approve.”
“How do you know?” Spinerella cuts in.
“He told me.” The two women have the same shocked expression on their faces, “What? Don’t look so shocked. It’s not like Adora would want me in the same way.”
The two wives give each other a knowing look before Netossa steps out of Catra’s way, “I’m sorry, Catra. As far as we know, you and the Princess seem really close. She listens to you.” Catra nods in acceptance, “Let us help you. Prime and his army need to be defeated and this war needs to end.”
“How are you going to stop this?”
Spinnerella and Netossa both reveal their magic as Catra’s eyes widen. Spinneralla starts explaining, “We are actually Princesses too. We’ve been in hiding since Prime’s army destroyed both our kingdoms. Our people scattered to other towns and villages, but our kingdoms couldn’t be saved. If Prime found out who we really are, well, it wouldn’t end well for us.” Catra stood still, processing all this information, “So, we want to help you.”
“Okay.” Catra says, “How?”
“Well, first, we are going to you fed and rested before you sneak into the castle to warn the Princess.” Spinerella says ever so motherly, “Then, we’ll come along and be your back up tonight. Just in case something happens, we can cause a distraction.”
“Are you sure? I mean, I don’t want you guys to get into the shit because of me.” Catra asks, concern in her voice, “Shadow Weaver is after me. You guys don’t need to blow your covers. I can do this on my own.”
“Nope. No way kid.” Netossa scolds, “We’re coming with you. End of discussion.”
“Fine.”

The trio come out under the cover of darkness. They've given Catra a dagger that's she's attached to her belt and hidden under her cloak. They start the trek back to the castles moat and through the woods. The don't pass by Razz's house. The house doesn't seem to be where it should be. Catra shrugs the thought off, maybe Razz was just a hallucination concocted in Catra's woozy state and dehydration. Anyways, this is not the time to dwell on that.

They get to the moat in fairly quick time. Taking cover behind a few slightly taller bushes and looking over the water. Catra can see Adora's room from her, but just. She'll need to get around to the right side of the castles before she can start climbing. Looking around, there's an increase in guards around the castle walls. Catra slumps down against a tree, "Dammit!" she whisper yells, "There's too many guards!"

"See. This is why we are here." Netossa puts her hands on her hips stating the point, "We can distract the guards, right honey?"

"Yes dear." Spinneralla replies confidently, "I can send some targeted wind gusts in the opposite direction is you can get a few of the guards tangled in your nets."

The wives grin at each other, as Spinneralla pulls Catra up, "We can do this."

Catra nods. She gets ready on the edge of the tree line, just out of sight from any guards. Luckily for her, all the castle guards are human, thus none can see in the dark. Spinneralla and Netossa move to the far end of the tree line and being working their magic. Once the other guards have abandoned their posts, Catra makes her move. She silently makes her way through the water and through the moat. Coming up on the bank on the other side. Checking to see if anyone is around before sprinting off silently in the direction of Adora's bedroom window. She does a final check around before making her way up the castle walls. It's a well-worn path she follows, from years of sneaking into Adora's room from the cells or her own quarters.

Catra gets to the top, landing softly on the balcony stairs and quickly moving off to the side to do a check of the inside. She sees Adora lying in bed on her side, facing away from the balcony doors. Her bedroom door is shut and no one else is in there.

Great. Catra taps her signature knock on the balcony door and waits. Adora upon hearing the knocks, jumps up swiftly off the bed and straight to the balcony doors, opening them quickly and pulling Catra in before shutting the doors just as fast.
"Hey Adora." Catra softly rasps, but upon seeing the red around Adora's eyes, she moves her hand up to thumb away a tear, "Are you okay?"
Adora shakes her head as she pulls Catra into a tight hug, whispering, "I was so worried about you."
Catra returns the embrace whispering into Adora's hair, "I'm alright Adora. I'm not going anywhere."
They part as Adora uses her sleeve wipe the tears from her face, "What are you doing here? They'll take you back to the cells if they find you."
"I know." Catra answers, "But I have to warn you about Shadow Weaver." Adora nods a little confused, "That snake is planning to poison you and your family at the masquerade ball."
"How do you know that?"
"I heard her speaking to one of Prime's soldiers." Catra whispers back, "You need to stop her. We need to stop her."
"Okay." As Adora answers, keys are jingling outside her door, "You need to go!" She quickly pushes Catra back out the balcony.
"Okay. I'll be in touch… somehow." Catra quickly says as she steps up onto the balcony rail.
Thinking fast, Adora grabs a communicator and hands it to Catra, "Here, take this. We can keep in contact this way. Don't contact me. I'll contact you when I'm alone." Catra takes it and slips it into her pocket, before she can start back down the castle wall, Adora grabs Catra by the collar of her cloak and plants a quick kiss on her lips, "Go now!"
Stunned for a moment, Catra gives Adora a goofy smile before descending, whispering-yelling to Adora in glee, "Your Joker will be back, Princess!"
A small smile tugs on Adora's lips as she presses her fingers against them for a moment. Eventually turning around on the balcony to look back into her room as her bedroom door opens and her father comes in, "Adora? Ah, there you are. Why are you standing on the balcony?"

Adora fidgets with her fingers nervously before answering, “I… I just needed some air. I was thinking. I was thinking about Catra.”
She walks back inside, shutting the doors behind her and sits on her bed, “Can you please call off the search and her execution father?”
“I’m sorry Adora, but I cannot do that.” The King answers, “She has broken my heart too. I never thought her to be treacherous.”
“But she isn’t! She denied stealing the sword!” Adora protests as her father sighs, “Why don’t you believe her?”
Her father doesn’t reply, instead her gets up and walks to the door, “Get some sleep Adora.”
Once again, Adora is left alone in her room.

Masks and Formals

Chapter Summary

The masquerade ball fast approaches and so does Shadow Weavers evil plans.

Chapter Notes

Enjoy the newest chapter.
I'm still working on the next one after this...so yeah.
In the meantime, enjoy the read!

“Father. Do we really need to have this ball?” Adora asks almost in a pleading tone, “I’m really not in the mood.”
“Adora.” Her father replies leaning over the to talk to his daughter from across the dining table, “You need to find a suitor. You can’t keep rejecting everyone.”
“Why do I need to find a suitor?” Adora whines, “It’s not like someone is just going to sweep me off my feet. It just feels so, rushed. There’s just so much pressure.”
“I know.” The King sits up and rubs his hands together, “I remember finding your mother. It took a while, but we eventually got there.” He leant over once again, “Don’t worry Adora, you’ll find someone. I have the sent for the best princes and princesses out in the lands to, as you said, sweep you off your feet.”
Adora huffs, knowing her father is not going to cancel this ball. She needs to find another way. Shadow Weaver is planning something terrible and she needs to stop it before it happens.
“Why have you chosen a masquerade for this occasion?”
“I thought it would be fun to dress up.” A big belly laugh followed, “And who knows, perhaps someone might catch your eye.”
“Doubtful.” Adora mumbled under her breath, “Fine. But I don’t have to like it.”
Another laugh from the King as the two of them finished breakfast. Adora retreated back to her room to the Kings dismay, he knew his daughter was still heartbroken and angry at what he

had to do. He thought it best to give her some space until the ball. The ball would hopefully brighten her mood.

Adora sat on her bed and looked out the balcony doors, remembering her first kiss with Catra. She didn't intend to do it last night, but she couldn't pass up the chance, in case she wouldn't get the opportunity again. Adora smiled when she remembered Catra's dopey grin afterwards and the how happy Catra was before she climbed back down the castle walls. Snapping out of that memory she pulls out her communicator and turned it on. She stood up off the bed and hid the device under her pillow just in case, then walked up to the door, putting her ear on it to check if there was anyone around or listening. Once she was satisfied that no one was listening she returned to the bed and held the device in her hands. Pushing a few buttons, the device began to send a signal out.
"Hey Adora." Catra rasped into her device, it looked like she had just woken up. It was strange though, she seemed to be in a bed. In a house. But who's house? And why was Adora feeling irritated by not knowing. Catra yawned then said, "I didn't expect you to contact me so early today?"
"Where are you Catra?" Adora asked, the words coming out a little gritted.
Catra looked around before answering, "Oh, I'm at a friend's place. They let me crash after last night." Catra yawned again, throwing off the blanket and then standing up to stretch as a woman's voice could be heard from the background asking if Catra wanted breakfast, "Hang on Adora." As Catra answered the question from the other room, she turns back to the screen, "Sorry about that. She's a little peeved that she got wet yesterday."
Adora was feeling a mix of confusion and jealousy, "She?"
"Oh yeah, Netossa and Spinnerella helped me out yesterday. They let me stay with them." Catra replied casually, "What's up with you? Everything okay? You look…angry?"
"Pfft, I am not." Adora pouts, "Well, I hope they are treating you well."
Adora's tone is definitely not like her usual conversational style as

Catra finally figures it out, “Adora? Are…are you jealous?”
“No. Of course not.” Adora looked away from the device, “It’s not like there’s anything going on between us anyways.”
Catra smirked at Adora’s image on her device, “Princess. You don’t need to worry about them. They are married. To each other. And way older.”
“Hey!” Netossa yelled from the kitchen, “We are not old!”
Catra rolls her eyes, yelling back, “If you are older than me, then you are old!” She heard Adora laugh in the background as Netossa started arguing. “Anyway Princess, like I said, nothing to worry about. Besides, if I remember right, a very beautiful girl kissed me last night. Do you remember who that was?”
Adora’s face went red, “Shut up!”
Catra cackled on the other end, “Okay okay! I’m sorry.” She took a calming breath, “So, any updates on your end?”
Adora sighed, “Father won’t call off the ball. He is rather insistent on my finding a suitor.” A low growl involuntarily erupted from Catra’s chest as she tried to shove that feeling down. To her surprise, Adora just giggled, “And who is jealous now?”
“Whatever…” Catra mutters, “Anyways, we need to come up with a plan to protect you and your family. Any ideas?”
“You said something about poison last night.” Adora says, “Do you know what kind or if there’s an antidote or something for it?”
Catra shakes her head, “All I know is that it’s green. If you can get your family to avoid eating or drinking anything green maybe?”
“So, it’s something we have to eat or drink then?” Adora ponders, “Which means Princess Perfuma will need to tone down her plants or make them different colours.”
Catra rubs the back of her neck, “Does the King still want me executed?”
Adora nods sadly, “I tried to get him to renege it, but he’s just so stubborn! He wouldn’t even listen to me.” Adora took a breath, “I know you didn’t steal the sword Catra. I don’t even know how you would have gotten claw marks on it, but I know you wouldn’t have done it intentionally.”
“Adora, listen to me.” Catra closed her eyes, “Those claw marks were from a long time ago. When we were kids and we were mucking around. I found the sword in one of those musky old

room. I didn't know how to control my claws back then, so there's a good chance, a really good chance those marks were done my twelve-year-old me." She opened her eyes, "But I never stole it. I left it in that musky old room and haven't thought about it again until the other day."
"I believe you." Adora said with such certainty that it brought Catra's confidence back, "I'm pretty sure it was Shadow Weaver that framed you."
"Yeah, she pretty much admitted it the night she tortured me in the cell." Catra looked up and saw Adora's face drop, "Oh, Adora, no. I'm fine. See?" Catra moved the device around to show Adora that her wounds were healed, "I met some random old woman in the woods and she patched me good. That ointment stuff she had stung like a bitch and smelled like shit, but it worked wonders."
"Okay." Adora finally said, "We still have a few days to think of a plan to stop Shadow Weaver. I have to go now."
"Okay." Catra sighed, "Take care of yourself Princess."
"You too. I lo…I'll talk to you later." Adora gazed softly at her screen, "We'll figure this out."
"Yes ma'am!" Catra mocked saluted.
Adora giggled softly, "Such a joker!"
"I'm your wild card, princess."
"Okay, I really have to go now." Adora smiled, her eyes looking a little sad.
"We'll be okay Adora." Catra comforted, "Don't worry about it for now. Me and the two oldies here will start working on a plan."
Adora giggled a little louder as Catra was smacked behind the ears by one of the women before Catra waved a goodbye and hung up.
…
The masquerade ball came by sooner than Catra or Adora wanted. They had somewhat of a plan but essentially it was to keep the King and Queen away from anything that had green in it. Adora couldn't tell her parents about Shadow Weaver's intentions as she didn't have proof, so this would have to be covert operation. The ball is in full swing. The King and Queen sit on their thrones overlooking the ballroom, their masks covering their faces as they watch their guests dance and chatter amongst themselves.

Adora sat just below them. With their jester banished the King had set two of his most loyal guards flanking all of them. The music was loud and the food was plentiful. Adora made sure her parents did not consume anything that even resembled green. But she was running out of excuses and methods of making that happen.
The King and Queen decided it was time they joined in the festivities. They made their way to the dance floor, the two guards keeping the other guests in check as her parents danced together, laughing and carrying on. Adora took this opportunity to peruse the room to find where Shadow Weaver could be lurking. All of a sudden she is pulled onto the dance floor by someone. She's about to tell them off, when she see's their eyes.
"Catra?" She whispers as she wraps her arms around the mysterious person's neck, "What are you going here? You're going to get caught."
Catra chuckles, "You look beautiful tonight Princess." Catra reluctantly parts, bowing deep to the Princess as a sign of respect before pulling the blonde back in, "The snake is on the balcony up there." Catra eyes the spot, pointing it out to Adora, "She hasn't made a move yet."
Adora tries to focus but she can't look away from Catra. She's never seen Catra dressed in formal attire so to say she's stunned is an understatement. "I've never seen you in a suit…" Adora trails off as Catra gentle cups Adora's chin.
"Focus, Princess." Catra grins, "You can look at me all you want, once my name is cleared."
Adora shakes her head, trying to focus, "Right. Right…"
Catra feels a tap on her shoulder, she can smell it's the King. Instead of turning to face the man, Catra takes Adora by the hand and places a chaste kiss on the back, "Thank you for dancing with me, Princess Adora. I hope to see you again." Catra bows again and moves off into the crowd. Adora's eyes follow Catra as she disappears from view.
"Ah!" The King exclaims, "I see, someone has caught my daughters fancy."
Adora turns back, her cheeks flush red, "Father, stop."
He laughs and brings Adora in for a gentle hug. "You should go

after them.”
This time Adora laughs, “No, I think I’ll let the fates decide if we are to meet again.”
It is then that Shadow Weaver approaches them, a wicked grin on her face, “My my.” She starts, “I see the Princess has found herself a suitor.”
Adora eyes furrow, “No, we only just met. I highly doubt that would cement them as my suitor.”
Behind her back, Shadow Weaver pulls out two glasses or green liquid, “Your Majesties, I would like to propose a toast.” She hands the glasses to royals, “To the King and Queen!” She loudly cheers, watching closely as the King and Queen raise their glasses to their lips.
Adora quickly knocks them, spilling the drink all over her parents’ hands, “Adora!” Her mother screeches, “What are you doing?”
“Don’t drink that!” Adora yells.
“And why not?” Her mother asks wiping her hang on the front of her dress, “What has gotten into you?”
“It’s poison. Shadow Weaver is trying to poison you.” Adora explains.
“Adora.” Shadow Weavers creepy voice cuts in, “Why would I want to poison the King and Queen?”
Thinking on her feet, Adora takes the glass out of her mother's hand and holds it out to Shadow Weaver, “If it’s not poisoned, then drink it.”
Shadow Weaver moves away slightly, “Adora, I cannot drink that.”
“Why not?!”
“Alcohol makes me feel sick.” Shadow Weaver calmly says.
“Just take a sip.” Adora pushes the drink back towards Shadow Weaver, “Heck, just swirl it around your mouth and then spit it out.”
“No.” Shadow Weaver says sternly.
Two women step out from the crowd, directly in front of Shadow Weaver.
“We saw her put something in those drinks majesties.” Spinneralla declares, “Princess Adora is right to be suspicious.”
“It’s true.” Netossa adds, “I wouldn’t drink whatever she gave you.”

The King turns to Shadow Weaver, “What did you put in these drinks?”
“I assure you nothing like that happened.” Shadow Weaver grits her teeth.
Netossa smirks as she steps forwards, a video device in her hands. She hands it over to Adora, who passes it along to the King. Playing the video.
The video is footage of Shadow Weaver spiking the drinks in the background of the ball. Seeing as she’s been caught, Shadow Weaver sweeps her arms up, summoning all her dark magic, drowning the room in darkness as electricity sparks across the room.
The next moment, the darkness clears and Shadow Weaver is on the ground, clutching her face as blood seep through her fingers, falling in droplets onto the floor.
“Seize her!” the guards scream as Shadow Weaver swings her arms again, flinging the guards against the walls as she hobbles out of the room. She turns back one final time and Adora sees three very distinct claw marks across her face before Shadow Weaver is gone.
The King calls for calm in the ballroom. Once all the noise has ceased, the King asks all the guests to leave in an orderly fashion as the event is now over. Once the guests have all left, he turns to his wife and daughter, “Are you both alright? Are any of you hurt?”
They both shake their heads. Adora looks her father in the eye, “Do you believe me now?”
“I’m sorry Adora.” The King apologises, “I was just so blinded by everything.”
“She set up Catra.” Adora adds, “You have to take the execution order off her now.”
The King sighs, “How can you be so sure?”
“How can you still believe her to be a traitor?” Adora raises her voice, “Shadow Weaver framed her.”
“Let me, let me think this through.” Her father compromises instead, “Now, we should get back. It’s getting late.”

Outside Catra is waiting for her new friends, her claws still bloody after attacking Shadow Weaver when she pulled out that dark

magic spell. She tries rubbing the blood off her fur around her hand, but it's no use. It's just spreading out more.
"Hey Kid!" Netossa strolls over.
"How'd it go?" Catra asks excitedly, "Did they get her? Did they arrest her?" The look on the wives face says it all, "She got away huh?"
"Yeah, I'm sorry." Spinneralla concedes, "They underestimated her powers."
"Why do I feel like there's more that you aren't telling me?" Catra asks nervously, "Spill."
Netossa holds her hand up to her wife to answer the question, "You still aren't off the execution list."
Catra sighs as she drops down against the castle wall, "I knew the King was stubborn…" She looks across the moat and then up into Adora's room, "Guess we should head back before I'm found out then."
The wives nod and they walk over to the bridge to cross back to the other side with the rest of the crowd still dressed in their masks.

Shadow Weaver retreats into a secret room of the castle, trying to stem the bleeding on her face. All of a sudden someone beams into her room.
"Ah! Shadow Weaver." The figure says, "You have failed me."
"No, Lord Prime. I just need more time." Shadow Weaver pleads, "I just need some more magic. I was so close!"
"I see." Lord Prime paces intimidatingly around Shadow Weavers hideout. He holds out a vial, "Take this."
"My Lord?"
"Inject it into yourself, prove to me your loyalty and I will grant you this extension of time and power." An unsettling smile on his face as he says it, "However fail me again and I will kill you myself. And believe me, you will want to be dead before it comes to that."
Shadow Weaver hastily injects herself with the vial Prime has given her. Her body twitches wildly for a while, her screams are ragged as the green concoction runs through her body. When she opens her eyes they glow green. A wicked grin on her face.

“I will not fail again my Lord.”
Prime nods and beams out of the room.
Shadow Weaver blinks and the green disappears from her eyes. She looks out the small window in her hideout and sees a familiar silhouette.
“There you are, Catra.” An evil smile on her lips, “You will not get away from me again. I will rip you apart the next time I see you.”

Am I Still On Notice?

Chapter Summary

Shadow Weaver's second attempt.

Chapter Notes

Here we are again. A new chapter to boot.
Enjoy.

It has been two days and still the King has not made a decision on retracting Catra's execution, much to Adora's frustration. She knows her parents are avoiding her, but she can't fathom why. Their interactions have been brief and whenever Adora's brings up Catra, her parents find a way to either change the subject or all of a sudden need to be somewhere else.
Shadow Weaver has gone missing and all attempts to find her have come back empty handed. The guards have been on high alert in case she comes back to finish what she started. So far, it's been quiet.
Catra hasn't heard from Adora since the ball. It's starting to drive her crazy. She's been staying with Netossa and Spinnerella and is feeling like she's overstaying her welcome. She wants to go home. She wants to see Adora. She wants things to go back to how they were.
"Hey Kid." Netossa greets breaking Catra out of thoughts, "What's up with you?"
"Nothing." Catra mumbles.
"Doesn't seem like nothing." Netossa sits down on the couch next to Catra, "Spit it out. There are no secrets in this house. Sorry, that's not true. There are no secrets in this house as long as you aren't dealing with Prime's army or Shadow Weaver."
Netossa manages to crack a smile out of Catra. Catra tries to go back to her serious face as Netossa nudges her, waiting for an answer, "Fine. I'm just mad. Okay?"
"You should be mad, Kid." Netossa agrees crossing her arms across her chest, "I'd be mad too if I was sentenced to death for a

frame up."
Catra throws her head dramatically back against the couch, "I'm mad because the King still won't lift the fucking execution order on me. He knows I didn't do it. I just don't understand why he won't change it." Catra sighs and softly says, "I'm mad that I can't see Adora."
"Mm, you got it bad." Netossa pats Catra on the shoulder, "Give it some time. They're probably too busy trying to find Shadow Weaver than deal with administration issues."
"Really?" Catra deadpans, "How hard is it for him to say that he retracts the execution order on me? Literally one fucking sentence!"
"I get it, it's frustrating." Catra rolls her head on the back of the couch, closing her eyes, "But you can't give up. And I'm sure Princess Adora isn't giving up either."
"Yeah." Catra concedes, "She is kind of stubborn."
Netossa nods and gets up, going back to help Spinneralla in the other room. Catra slumps back into the couch, a smile on her face.

Another two days pass and Catra can't take it anymore. She has to see Adora. Make sure she's okay. The communication device is one option, but Adora told her not to contact her just in case she wasn't alone. She waits until Netossa and Spinneralla have retreated back to their bedroom and fall asleep before she sneaks out. She sprints through the woods to the edge of the moat, hiding behind some bushes. The number of guards around the castle have increased again now that it's not only Catra that they're looking for. She moves around to get to where Adora's bedroom is. There's no lights in her room. That's very odd. She usually sleeps with at least one light on somewhere in her room, an old habit she picked up a long time back when they were kids. Immediately Catra felt anxious and worried for Adora. This was not normal.
As she's about to leave her cover of protection, the communication device in her pocket vibrates. Fishing it quickly out from her pocket, Catra answers the call. It's Adora. Thank fuck!
"Hey Adora." Catra whispers, moving back deeper in the woods so

that the light of the device doesn't alert any of the guards.
"Catra?" Adora says in her normal tone.
"Shh!" Catra shushes her forcefully, "Not so loud!"
"Sorry!" Adora whispers back, "Where are you?" Adora's eyes widen in the realisation Catra's in the woods and not back at the house with Netossa and Spinneralla, "Go back to the house Catra!"
"What? Why?" Catra asks confused.
"Shadow Weaver is in the woods!" Adora whispers, "I've seen her lurking along the tree line, but every time the guards get there, she's gone! You have to leave. Now!"
Catra turns quickly and sprints back through the woods. Adora stays on the communicator staring at nothing but black and only hearing Catra's breaths as she runs back. All of sudden there's a thump. Adora starts screaming through the device, "Catra! Catra! Are you there? Talk to me!"
The next thing Adora hears is a groan. Catra's groan. "I'm okay Princess." Catra gets up from where she fell, "I just tripped on something." Catra runs her hands over her arms and legs to make sure nothing hurt more than it should. She was fine. She could hear Adora breathe in relief. Catra started to run again away from the castle and back to the house. It felt like the longest run she'd ever done. The darkness mixed with the fear of running into Shadow Weaver out in the open drove her to move even quicker. She got back to the house and slipped back inside. Pulling the communicator out again she could see Adora waiting with eager eyes, "I'm back."
"Good." Adora said with a huff, "What were you thinking? You can't just come back to the castle. What if you got caught? Or if you ran into Shadow Weaver? I'd never forgive myself if you were only coming to check on me."
"Adora. Stop." Catra collected herself, her breathing was still ragged from the sprint back but she managed to calm Adora down, "I'm sorry Princess. I worry about you."
"You don't have to worry about me. I'm not the one wanted for treason or theft!" Adora almost cries, "You have to promise me, you won't do something like that again!"
Catra sighs, "You know I can't do that." She watched as Adora's

eyes looked sadder, “I’m not going to stop worrying about you. I’m also not going to stop trying to protect you. I took an oath.”
Adora was silent for a few moments, “Show me the mark. Prove that you took the oath and you’re not joking.”
“Okay, whatever you want Princess.” Catra agreed. She put the device down on the table propped up against a few books then proceeded to unbutton the sleeve on her left arm, rolling it up to reveal a thick leather arm band around her forearm. She unlaced the band and turned her arm to reveal the tattoo she had received as part of the oath she took. “There. Are you happy now?”
Adora moved closer to her screen to get a good look at the tattoo, but it was still pixelated. All she could make out was two playing cards on top of the oaths' symbol for her family. Catra quickly covered the mark up and rolled her sleeve back down. “Why didn’t you tell me?”
Catra chuckled, “You know I am not allowed to disclose that information.” Adora pouted at her, “Don’t be like that Princess. Now, tell me why I haven’t heard from you in so many days?”
Adora’s face turned serious, “I wanted to, I really did. But after Shadow Weaver escaped, I haven’t had a minute to myself until now. Father posted guards outside my door the last few days as well as guards for everywhere I went. There’s been some kind of disturbance tonight so all the guards are on that. They’ve locked me in my room and told me to turn out the lights, to make it look like I’m not in my room.”
“Good thinking. It worked.” Catra agreed, “I thought something had happened to you when I didn’t see the light in your room tonight.”
“We need to figure out how get Shadow Weaver. Father won’t call off your execution order until she’s been arrested.” Adora rubbed her temples, “He knows you were set up, but he’s just so stubborn to admit he was wrong.”
“Yeah…wonder where he gets that from…” Catra teased.
Adora glared at her screen, “Stop joking!”
Catra giggled, “What? But that’s exactly what I am!” Adora crossed her arms and pouted again, “Okay, stop doing that! I’m sorry! How do you plan to capture Shadow Weaver anyways?”

“I don’t know.” Adora flopped back onto her bed before popping back up to grab the device, “She’s just so slippery!”
Catra thought about it for a little while. They sat in silence watching each other through the screen until Catra clicked her fingers, “I know! I have the perfect plan to capture that snake!”
They planned for another hour before Adora started yawning more than she was breathing. Catra bid Adora goodnight and continued on planning while her princess slept. She kept the device on for another half hour, listening to Adora’s soft snores before turning it off. Once Catra’s plan was completed, she sat back and smiled. Now to wait for the perfect opportunity.

Adora hated the plan. Mostly because it was outside the castle walls and she could not be involved in it until Catra had led Shadow Weaver back into the castle, where the guards could apprehend her. Adora hated that Catra had decided to be the bait for this plan. She knew Shadow Weaver always despised Catra and now that they were both not welcome in the castle, there wasn’t really anything to stop her from going through with actually killing Catra. The thought alone sent cold shivers down Adora’s spine. Catra told Adora that when she had spotted Shadow Weaver, she would use their communication device to alert Adora. Adora would be able to hear everything that was happening but the device would be in Catra’s pocket. Netossa and Spinnerella would be waiting in the wings in case something went wrong. Adora paced about her room, unable to keep still. Her heart didn’t know what to do with itself, it felt like it was going to beat out of her chest if this plan didn’t hurry up.
Catra and the two princesses made their way back into the woods. They walked silently when Catra spotted a familiar house. Strange. It wasn’t there the last few times she’d come this way. She motioned for her companions to follow her towards the house. Razz’s house. Catra walked up to the door and before she could knock, the door swung open and Razz greeted her with a broom to the head.
“Ow! What was that for?” Catra rubbed her head.
Razz whacked her a second time with her broom as Catra put her arms up to stop the deluge, “I’m trying to knock some sense into

you, dearie!”
“What? Why? What did I do?” Catra huffed as the other two princesses giggled behind her.
“You need to be more careful with Shadow Weaver.” Razz said with a frown, “I can’t have Adora be sad because you go and get yourself killed.”
“I’m not going to die Razz.” Catra brushed off the old woman’s warning, “We’ve got a plan to take her down, okay? It’ll be fine. Adora will be fine. I’ll be fine.”
Razz looked at her with uncertainty, “Madam Razz does not like your plan.” She frowned, her eyes glazed over a moment before her face changed and a serene smile appeared on her face, “You better be going little one. You and Adora will be okay at the end. But she will be sad for you along the way.”
Catra was again confused by Razz’s warnings and ramblings, under her breath she muttered, “Great…riddles…again.” Another whack to the head from Razz’s broom, “Alright! We’re going!”
Catra jumped down the steps and joined the other two princesses again. They turned to get back on track when Razz yells out, “Be careful little one! Shadow Weaver does not work alone.”
The next thing they hear is the door slam shut.
Netossa nudges her wife, “Woah, that was weird.”
“Shush dear!” Spinnerella scolded to Netossa’s giggles as they followed Catra along the track back to the moat.

They get to edge of the tree line. Catra can see Adora’s light back on in her room. A small smile tugs at her lips, more so in relief that Adora’s safe and she knows where she it than anything else. The three of them wait in the tree line, just out of sight from the guards of the castle.
“What are we waiting for? Where is she?” Netossa asked a little annoyed at having to wait, “I thought you said she’d be here.”
Catra rolls her eyes, “Have you seriously never done something like this before?”
Spinneralla rubbed her wife’s back soothingly, “Be patient dear.”
Netossa huffed, crossing her arms in disdain before accepting the situation. Catra shot Spinneralla a thankful glance and it was returned with a gentle smile. Shadow Weaver had been seen

lurking around these parts of the woods in the days since her escape, which lead Catra to believe she was still somehow staying the castle somewhere. That old witch seemed to have a secret hiding spot in every wing.
Catra finally spots Shadow Weaver emerging from a secret door on the side of the castle, she glides effortlessly down to the ground like she's floating on the black fog of her magic. The witch makes her way around the castle walls and towards the bridge off the castle grounds to the mainland.
"Get set." Catra orders her two companions, "Just watch my six." Netossa and Spinneralla crouch down into position and nod back to Catra. Catra pulls out her communicator and dials up Adora who picks it up instantly, "Hey Princess. I'll see you soon. Get ready."
Without letting Adora answer, Catra shoves the device back into her pocket and makes her way to confront Shadow Weaver. She follows Shadow Weaver stealthily with her two companions following in the tree line just out of sight. When Shadow Weaver gets to the bridge, before she can knock the guards out to leave Catra steps out and onto the far end of the bridge.
"Hey, Weaver!" Catra yells over to the witch. She's met with Shadow Weavers glowing green eyes and an evil grin. Then the realisation hits her, "You've been infected. Haven't you?"
Shadow Weaver laughs wickedly. The castle guards move to arrest her but are quickly subdued by Shadow Weavers magic. The guards all drop to the floor, unmoving. "Catra." The name drips with contempt from her lips, "I should have killed you the other night."
Catra laughs nervously, "Yeah, well you didn't. But feel free to keep trying. Witch."
Shadow Weavers eyes glow a brighter green as she seems to be possessed, "Ah! So this is the Catra that has been ruining my plans." The voice is Shadow Weavers but the words are not, "How would you like to join me? Be my right hand per se?"
Catra's confusion clears fast, "Prime?"
"Yes, you are bright after all." A grimace on Catra's face, not sure if she should feel proud or sick that the enemy lord is praising her. He continues to talk through Shadow Weaver, "This…vessel…is

weak. Greedy. And treacherous. If you join my army, I can guarantee that this…being… will no longer hurt you. You will be praised and commended if you join my army."
Catra is stunned, "I wasn't looking for a job offer to be honest." Her tone mocking, "I mean, it does sound really good… but I think I enjoy being the joker." A smirk comes across her face watching the anger rise out of Shadow Weavers eyes, "Oh, I'm sorry. Not used to rejection huh?"
Prime growls through Shadow Weavers body, "You will regret that decision."
The green glow in Shadow Weavers eyes fade and her eyes return to normal. They focus on Catra with a glare, "Prime will not protect you, jester." Shadow Weaver starts throwing electric bolts towards Catra that she easily dodges, "You will die by my hands or by an executioner. Take your pick."
Catra backflips over the top of Shadow Weaver, kicking her in the back and making her fly forward further onto the bridge, "I prefer not to die either way." A mischievous grin on Catra's face as she goads the witch inside the castle, "Come get me, witch!"
Shadow Weaver growls with anger as more bolts fly towards Catra. Just like the bolts, Catra sprints away from them and deeper into the castle. She's quickly stopped in her tracks by a dozen castle guards with spears pointed directly at Catra's throat. She only just manages to stop in time when Shadow Weaver floats through on her magic, rage in her eyes as she starts lighting up the room in electricity. The guards are split between which enemy to take down, but that is quelled when Catra is caught in Shadow Weavers tendrils, lifting her high off the ground and choking her at the same time as burning through her insides.
"Get her!" Adora screams at the guards, "Arrest Shadow Weaver! What are you doing? She's killing Catra!"
The guards shake out of whatever trance they were in and advance on Shadow Weaver. It's enough for the witch to lose her concentration on torturing Catra to drop her back on the ground. Adora rushes over to Catra and pulls her out of harm's way while the castle guards continue to attack Shadow Weaver.
"Catra!" Adora screams, shaking Catra in her arms, "Catra!"
"Hey Adora." Catra chokes out, everything in her body feels like

it's on fire and it's not from being in Adora's arms, "I'm…I'm okay."
They exchange soft smiles until guards start flying around them, slamming into the walls. The King appears with his sword drawn, "Shadow Weaver! How dare you come back here and hurt my people!"
Shadow Weaver laughs wickedly and then she makes a noise of surprise when a net is thrown around her and tightening. "What is this?"
"Boom! Nets!" Netossa celebrates, "See honey, that's how you do it!"
Spinnerella rolls her eyes at her wife as she uses her magic to blow Shadow Weaver up against the far wall so the castle guards can arrest her. "You will all pay!" she screams, "Prime sees all! Prime knows all!"
She's led away by the guards with the net still wrapped up around her securely. The King looks over to the two princesses, "Thank you for your help."
"No problems." Netossa replies casually, "But we need to talk about Catra."
The King raises and eye at the woman, then glances over his shoulder to his daughter and notices she's holding Catra in her arms, "What of her?"
"You need to lift the execution order off her. You know she was framed." Netossa states plainly.
Spinnerella stands next to her wife, "Please King Randor." She looks over at Catra still laying in Adora's arms, "She loves your daughter. Has she not proven her worth?"
The King huffs before his face softens, "Adora?"
Adora turns her head reluctantly away from Catra, "Yes father?"
"Take Catra to the infirmary to get checked out." Adora's eyes light up but before she can speak he adds, "The execution order is revoked."
Adora hugs Catra tighter into her chest, "Did you hear that Catra? You've been exonerated!"
Catra chuckles at Adora's excitement, "Help me up?" Adora helps Catra onto her feet, "My King. We have a bigger issue than Shadow Weaver."
The King nods, "I know. Prime."

First Attack

Chapter Summary

Catra is free to roam now she's not under an execution order.

Chapter Notes

Here's the next installment.
Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Now that Catra's execution order is well and truly 'axed', Catra has returned to her dwellings. Her room hasn't changed for the few days she was banished, which by normal standards of the castle, quite rare. She knows Adora probably had something to do with that. She sighs as she picks up her guitar and sits on her bed, mindlessly plucking the strings to a song she's played so many times over for Adora. Her eyes close, just listening to the sounds of the strings linger in the air in her room. She hears a knock at her door. Immediately she stops plucking at the strings and gets up, placing the guitar onto her bed and walking to the door.
"Hey Adora." Catra rasps out as she opens the door.
"How do you do that?" Adora asks with a smile on her face, "Is it my knock?"
Catra smirks shaking her head, "It's not your knock."
"It's my walk, isn't it?" Adora guesses.
Catra shakes her head again, "Nope, not that either. Though I could probably pick up your footsteps if I wanted to."
"That was it then! Right?" Adora grins, pleased with herself, "If not that, what?"
"I can smell you Adora." Catra flatly replies. She watches as Adora goes red, "I can smell your scent." Catra tries to clear up, which doesn't really work as Adora goes even redder, "You've got a really specific and familiar scent Adora. I'd know it was you from a mile away."
Adora looks up and offers an awkward smile, she holds out her

hand, “Here. This is yours.”
Catra reaches for the item in Adora’s hand, it’s her pocketknife on the day she escaped the prison cell. She twirls it around in her fingers a bit, “Thanks Princess. Where did you find it?”
“In the reeds, by the moat.” Adora replied, “There was blood all over the stones where you had escaped. I was just really worried something had happened to you.”
Catra pulled Adora in for a hug and she felt Adora melt into it. “It’s okay Princess. I’m okay.” Catra comforted, “I’m not going anywhere. I’m your Joker. Don’t forget that.”
She could feel Adora smile into her shoulder. “I…I should probably get back to my room.” Adora said sheepishly, releasing herself from the hug.
Catra pulled her back in and kissed Adora on the lips. Adora made a little yelp before realising what was going on before returning the kiss. When Catra parted, Adora still had her eyes closed. Catra smirked, “I missed you too Princess.”
Adora opened her eyes, “Yeah, me too.” Adora leaned in once more, hovering her lips over Catra, “By the way, you looked really hot in that suit.”
And just like that, Adora moved away, a smirk on her own lips as she turned around to Catra mouthing words that wouldn’t come out.
“Goodnight my Joker. I’ll see you in the morning.” Adora walked out the door, leaving it open as Catra chased after her, but just stopping at the doorway as the guards took up position flanking the princess back to her room.
“Goodnight Princess!” Catra yelled back with glee. “Sweet dreams!”

There’s a meeting in the war room of the castle once it’s dawn. The King has sent word for the other kingdoms to be wired in for the meeting. The King sits at the head of the round table in the tallest chair. The Queen and Princess flank him on either side. Netossa and Spinneralla sit next to each other along with the castle’s generals and higher ranked officials. Catra stands with her back against the wall. No one pays her any attention, her position is close to the door to listen for anything that may be happening

outside. Holograms of representatives from other kingdoms are beamed into the empty seats around the table. Once the last participant has beamed in the meeting starts.
"Thank you everyone for attending." The King greets, "As most of you are aware, Prime and his army have been gaining more ground. And only just last night we found out that he is able to possess the minds of his believers and followers."
"How could you possibly know that?" A representative from Bright Moon asked, "They've only been sending clones and their ground forces. I haven't heard of anyone being possessed."
"My advisor was…is compromised." The King answers, "She tried to kill me and my family."
Gasps were heard around the room as Netossa spoke up, "Don't worry. We took care of her last night. She won't be able to do anything while locked up, that's for sure."
"Yes. Thank you, Princess Netossa." The King cleared his throat, "Prime is coming."
Another round of gasps.
"Where is he targeting?" Perfuma asked, concern in her voice, "Will there be an all out attack on the entire planet?"
The King shakes his head, "No. I believe he will attack us, one kingdom at a time." He turns and looks at his family, "This is meeting is just a warning for all of you. Be prepared. Don't be caught unexpected."
"King Randor." The Queen of Bright Moon cuts in, "If you require assistance, I will be happy to send some troops your way. Or even some artillery if required."
"Thank you, Angella." King Randor replies, "That will not be necessary. You will need all your troops and supplies for when the time comes."
"Shouldn't we be fighting on a united front?" Princess Entrapta asked, "I have drones, robots and other tech to help you need them."
"Thank you for the offer Princess, but I'm afraid I don't think we have enough time for them to be delivered. Prime and his army will be coming soon." The King sends her a grateful look, "All I ask is that if things do not stop here…" he trails off a little, glancing at his family again, "you will take my family and my people in refuge

if needed."
The room of attendees all agree without a second thought, bringing a smile to the King's lips, "Thank you. And may your kingdoms come out unscathed."
The rest of the virtual occupants send their regards and thanks in the heads up before disappearing. Netossa and Spinneralla get up from their seats and make their way to the King. Spinneralla starts, "King Randor?" He nods to continue, "We will like to fight against Prime, here, with you and your people."
The King smiles again, "Of course. We need all the help we can get!"
The two princesses bow curtly and stop before Catra, Netossa looks over at Adora and then back to the Joker, "Yeah, she definitely thinks you're wild!"
Catra huffs, pushing Netossa playfully, "Shut up!"
"Someone's got it bad!" Spinnerella joins in as Catra starts shoving them out of the door much to Adora's delight at the scene unfolding.
"Hey Kid!" Netossa turns around looking serious, "Look after yourself and them, alright?"
"Of course, I will." Catra replies earnestly, "I took an oath after all."
"We won't be far!" Spinneralla turns around and smiles softly back at Catra, "Don't forget to look after yourself!"
Catra rolls her eyes but smiles back at them as the make their way out. Once the princesses have left, Catra closes the door and turns around to a room full of wicked grins and wide eyes. She's just realised that the whole room has overheard that whole conversation, well hopefully not the first part, but definitely the ending. She sends the room a wry grin and makes her way back to leaning up against the wall.
"Alright, let's begin." The King turns back to his generals, "We need to place troops along this wall just outside the castle walls, between the moat and the castle."

The meeting goes on for hours before a plan of attack is finally agreed upon and he dismisses the room for lunch and then to start getting preparations ready. In the meantime, the King goes

down to speak with his ex-royal advisor, currently held in a different prison cell than the one Catra was in.
“Ah, King Randor.” Shadow Weaver greets with disdain, “If you have come to seek information from me, I’m afraid you are wasting your time.”
Catra stepped out from behind the King, her claws on display as the King signals for her to stand down, “Shadow Weaver. I was going to appeal to your better side, but I can see, you don’t have one.” The witch sneered at the comment but stayed silent, “Why are you working for Prime? Tell me!”
Shadow Weaver remained silent. Catra decided to stir this conversation up if she wasn’t going to provide any answers, “Shadow Weaver rides on Prime’s coattails.” Catra jeered, “If she had enough power and magic, she wouldn’t need extra help, would she?”
The King nodded, “That is true.”
“Why, I bet that’s why she preyed on those who were defenceless in the first place. Isn’t it?” Catra knew that would get a rise out of the witch, “She just loves taking out her failures on those that are not.”
“Pfft!” Shadow Weaver scoffed, “What makes you think you aren’t a failure, Jester?” Shadow Weaver stood up and moved closer to the bars, “Do you really think the King would think you worthy of his daughter?”
Out of curiosity she looked up at the King, the King looked away, that was all Catra need to confirm her answer, “It doesn’t matter.” Catra muttered out.
“Oh, I think the King would have to disagree with you on that one.” An evil grin on Shadows Weaver’s face, “Does he know you have already stolen her first kiss?”
The King turns abruptly, facing Catra with anger in his eyes, “What?”
Shadow Weaver laughed, “Oh, he doesn’t know, does he?” She turns to the King, “Your majesty, it seems your daughter has fallen for the Jester. What a delight this is. To think, your daughter could love someone so… common.”
Catra turned to Shadow Weaver. Her claws slid out. The King seethed next to her, trying to hold his emotions together as

Shadow Weaver continued to laugh wickedly. That's when the first explosion was heard. More occurred not that long after.
Catra shook herself out of her anger and readied herself to get into position, "My King, I need to get to my post."
"We will talk about this later. Jester." His voice was angry as he looked over to Shadow Weaver, "Pray that Prime does not blow up the castle and trap you in here, snake."
Shadow Weaver just waves them off and returns to sitting on her cot and staring at the walls.
The pair then left the prison. Catra sprinting to the highest tower to take her position on watch duties as the King took up his position in the war room to coordinate the troops. The alarms sounding through the air as the civilians all made their way to the underground refuges. Those who wanted to fight were given weapons to defend themselves if Prime's army overcame the castle troops. In the end, there were more civilians ready and waiting to fight than were going to let the enemy take their homes and everything they hold dear without a fight. The ones in the underground refuge were mostly the very old and very young. There were a few adults around that weren't able to fight due to personal circumstances but were willing to look after those in the refuge that couldn't look after themselves. The ultimate last defence. The troops were ready and in position, now they were waiting on the attack itself. Everyone was on edge.
BOOM! Another bomb went off just on the other side of the moat, close to the tree line that Catra had hid in.
"Incoming!" Catra yelled from her perch, she fired her rifle towards the first of the clones that made it through the tree line. As soon as the first shot was fired, the troop on the top of the walls followed suit. Catra gritted her teeth as the sound of her rifle so close to her ear, made her grit even harder every time she pulled the trigger. Off in the distance she saw the drones coming along with a very large machine. The large machine stopped, its gun recalibrated and then it fired. "Take cover!" Catra screamed out as the missile came towards the castle.
It detonates on the east side of the castle. There was not enough time to get people out of the way for that. Before another two more missiles came raining down. It blew up more centrally this

time while the second one took at the far west side wall. Everything was crumbling.
"Retreat!" a general yelled, "Retreat! Get everyone out! Now!"
Catra watched as the troops started moving everyone out the back and underground into the secret tunnels that lined the way to Limeria. There was still a small contingent of troops still fighting within the castle walls when the clones started beaming in. Catra took the clones down with her claws, clearing the way for as many people to get to the tunnels. The troops and her had formed a circle around the entrance as they fought off the clones fighting back-to-back. As soon as the soldier gave the all clear, Catra blew the hole up to stop anyone from getting in or getting back out.
"Return to the core!" The generally yelled, "Now, you fucks!"
The troops all turned to run back to the core of the castle, Catra at the rear, ripping through the clones that dared to follow them. As they ran towards the war room, the two soldiers in front of her were ripped in two by new clones that had beamed in. These ones had faces. Faces in the name of Prime. Catra dodged their swords and sliced through their knees, making the collapse as a few of the troops turned around to take care of the new clones.
"Get the King out!" Catra screamed while she slashed at another clone's face, stabbing it in the eye to finish the job, "Don't worry about us. We can handle this! Go! Now!"
The general ran with more gusto to get to the core of the castle, he was flanked by five soldiers, all highly skilled as they managed to fight off the clones, drones and gun fire headed their way. They reach the King in quick time, "My King. We need to leave. Now!"
Just as the King stood up, sword in his hand, Prime beamed in. The general screamed at the King this time, "Now! We will take care of…" before he could finish the sentence, Prime had run him through with a sword. The general looked down in disbelief at the sword that now ran through his body, Prime grinned and then slashed upwards. Slicing the general in half from the waist. Blood spurted out, covering everyone and everything in close proximity.
The other four guards all attacked Prime with vigour, anger and pride in their eyes. Prime defended himself easily, moving like he had choreographed the entire scene as he laughed. He noticed

the King about to slip out when he swung his sword and in one swift action the four guards all stopped. Their torso's detached from their legs. Cut in half. They hadn't bled to death as of it and still twitched, clinging onto their swords in one last effort.
"Let me put them out of their miseries, shall I?" Prime smiled. The King was stunned, frozen in fear as he watched Prime go through the four guards, running them through with his sword through their chests. "There. Now. Where were we?"

Outside, Catra and the small group of troops were still fighting Prime's clones. They were beginning to tire and there didn't seem like an end in sight to the ever-constant number of clones coming towards them. They were all pushed back into one of the mess halls, with nowhere to go.
Catra looked around her. The looks on the soldiers faces said it. She turned to them, "Remember your oaths!" She turned back to the incoming clone invasion, "Kill them all!"
The fight continued. The small group of soldiers with Catra was getting smaller and smaller. Catra had picked up the guns of the fallen and fired until the weapons were emptied. Her body was cut up, shot and bloodied. But so were her comrades. A clone walked in with grin and a very large bomb.
"A present for Catra. From Prime." The clone said as they threw the bomb towards what was left of the troops.
Catra pounced as far away as she could but it would never have been far enough. She felt her body thrown up in the infernal heat that burned at her as she was lifted up high enough to be propelled over the castle walls.
"There!" yelled Netossa. She threw her nets up to catch Catra as Spinnerella gently brought her back to the safety of the woods.
"We need to get out of here. Now!"
"Catra! Catra!" Netossa screamed into Catra's face, "Wake up Kid! What happened to not dying?!"
Catra groans, "Fuck…"
"Language!" Spinnerella scolds.
"Seriously?" Catra groans again, "Fuck!" She yells it louder, "I told Razz I'm not dying. Can't break a promise to an old woman I don't even know…right?"

Spinneralla crouches down next to Catra, “Can you walk?”
“Why? Can’t I just lie here for a while?” Catra whines, “Everything hurts.”
“Well, Kid. Everything will hurt a whole lot more if you don’t get your ass up now!” Netossa grunts out, “They’re coming. We need to get out of here now!”
They all jump back when a sparkly girl appears out of nowhere.
“What the fuck?” Catra yelps.
“Good. There you guys are.” The sparkly girl says, “Adora said to bring you back.”
“What?” Catra grunts, “Who the fuck are you?”
“Princess Glimmer!” Spinneralla greets happily, shushing Catra up, “Yes, get us out of here please.”
“You guys know how this works right?” Glimmer asks, “Just make sure you’re touching each other while I teleport us back.”
And in a flash, they are transported into Bright Moon.
Catra groans again, “Ugh. My stomach. What the fuck Sparkles?”
“It’s Glimmer, you ass!” Glimmer huffs back.
“Catra!” Adora’s voice rushes through as she slides to the ground, grabbing Catra’s hand, “Are you okay? Where’s father? Or mother?”
Catra looked away, “I’m sorry Princess.” Catra sighs trying to let Adora’s hand go, “I couldn’t get back to the core. There were just too many.”
Adora sat back on the ground, worry on her face before she squeezed Catra’s hand, “It’s not your fault Catra.”
“Somehow I don’t believe you.” Catra tried to turn on her side before the pain sought an end to that action.
“Catra.” Adora said softly as she moved next to her, “Look at you. I don’t blame you.” To prove the point, Adora places a kiss on Catra’s forehead, ignoring all the blood on her face.
“Can you thank Sparkles for me?” Catra asks teasingly.
“Her names Glimmer.” Adora smiled softly. She turns to Glimmer, “Where’s your infirmary?”
“It’s over there.” Glimmer pointed, then she gave Adora a knowing look, “Really Adora? The Jester?”
Adora’s face heated up as her blush took over. Catra didn’t help by chuckling softly.

“Adora!” Queen Angella called, “You need to see this.”
Adora squeezed Catra’s hand firmly once more before getting up and going over to Queen Angella. Before she has a chance to say anything there is a recording playing in a loop in the war room. On the screen is Prime. In the background, Adora’s mother and father.
“This is Lord Prime. Bring Princess Adora back to her castle or I will personally execute the King and Queen. And to prove I am not playing around…” A castle soldier is brought up to be face to face with Prime. Prime throws the soldier his sword, “Come at me, soldier.” The soldier charges. He is instantly disarmed of the sword and run through. And to be rub salt in the wound as the soldier kneels, touching the wound on his chest, Prime cuts his heads off in one deftly swing. Blood splatters across the onto the screen as Prime wipes his sword on the dead soldier’s clothes. He turns back to the camera, “You have two days. I will be waiting.”
The video runs again from the start.
“This is Lord Prime…”

Chapter End Notes

I'm pretty much writing every day since I've got some time off.
So expect the next chapter fairly soon.
Thanks again for reading.

Slipping Away

Chapter Summary

A mission to rescue Adora's parents is mounted from Bright Moon.

Chapter Notes

Hi Everyone!
Thanks for taking the time to read my stuff.
I probably should do a better job proof reading this, but...that would mean holding up on posting it... haha
Anyways, Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“We have to do something!” Adora pleads with the Queen and Glimmer, “You can’t stop me from going otherwise!”
“Adora.” Queen Angella speaks calmly, “You can’t just charge in there without a plan. That’s suicide!”
“What do you suggest we do then?” Adora’s words are heated but worried. She slumps down against the wall of the war room, “He’s got my parents.”
“I know.” Queen Angella puts her hand on Adora’s shoulder. “We will figure something out.”
“The Princess Alliance!” Glimmer provides, almost screaming, “I’ll get them all together and we plan a rescue.”
Adora looks up, hope in her eyes, “Do you think they can help?”
Glimmer smirks smugly, “Definitely! They all have magic.”
“Netossa and Spinneralla are princesses too.” Adora mentions, “They helped Catra out…Oh my god! Catra!” Adora gets up quickly off the floor, “I need to check on her.”
Glimmer grabs Adora’s wrist, “Adora no.”
“Why?”
Bow walks in with a clipboard, reading the contents. He smiles despite whatever is happening in the room, “Oh, hi Adora.” Adora only manages a small smile in greeting, “I just checked on Catra.

She'll be fine Just needs some rest."
"So, let her rest." Glimmer pleads.
Adora shakes her head, "I have to see her."
Bow nods and moves out the way, "Come with me then."

Adora follows Bow to the infirmary silently. They come upon Catra's bed, Adora moves to Catra's side, grabbing her hand and intertwining their fingers. She flinched slightly when she saw how bad Catra's injuries really were now that she was under proper lights. She was bandaged almost head to toe. Adora held back a sob as she kept looking. Blood seeped through the bandages on some areas.
Bow stood next to Adora, "Don't worry Adora. She's just sleeping."
Adora just kept staring at Catra laying in the bed in front of her.
Bow looks over Catra, "She's a tough one huh?"
Adora chuckled wetly. She nodded. "Yeah, she is."
Catra's ear twitched hearing Adora's voice so close to her. Her whole body hurt like she was fling sky high by a bomb…wait, that did happen. She'd have to thank Netossa and Spinneralla for saving her life. Also Sparkles too. She lay in the bed, listening to Adora and another voice talk next to her. Catra guessed that no one saw her ear twitch. So she did it again. Suddenly a gasp. She tried to keep a neutral face as she felt Adora move up the bed and gently ran her fingers through Catra's short hair and massage her ears. Catra's purr revved up, much to Catra's annoyance at not being able to control it. The next thing she feels is a flick in the ear.
That makes Catra wake up really quick, "Ow! What the fuck Princess?!"
Adora steps back and snickers behind her hand, "That's what you get for scaring me. Again!"
Catra flicks the ear that Adora had flicked and looked at her with a smirk, "So… not funny then?" Judging by Adora's face, it was not.
"Mmm, guess I better change tact." She was about to get out of bed when both Adora and Bow stopped her, pushing her back into bed, "Woah! Dude, I'm sure you're a nice guy and all, but I don't swing that way. Plus I don't share."
Bow looked confused as Adora blushed. Catra burst out laughing,

“You are terrible!” Adora whined, “And I don’t share either. So you better remember that, Joker!”
“What did she mean by that Adora?” Bow tried to whisper to Adora.
“Dude…”
“It’s Bow. Hi!” He greeted enthusiastically.
“Okay…Bow…” Catra rolled her eyes, “Your whispering skills are really shit.”
Catra laughs again as Bow turns red, “Well, I’m glad you’re feeling better. You got hurt pretty bad.”
Adora huffed, “She’s always getting hurt.”
“Am not!” Catra protests, “Oh wait,” thinking for moment, a grin on her face, “yeah, the princess is right. I do get hurt a lot.”
“Well, stop that!” Adora looked intensely into Catra’s eyes, there was no jest in those eyes, “I can’t lose you too.”
Catra’s demeanor changed, “Adora? What happened?”
“He’s got them.” She paused, “Prime has my parents. And he wants me in return for them. I’ve got two days or else…”
“Hey…” Catra reaches out ignoring the pain in her shoulder, “we’ll figure this out, like always. Okay?”
“But how?” Adora’s eyes filled with tears, “I saw them kill Max. He broadcast it to everyone. He just…”
Catra pulled Adora into the bed with her. Her body protested with the extra weight on top of her, but she didn’t care. Adora cried into Catra’s neck as Bow pretended to be interested in something outside the window.
“Shh…” Catra calmed Adora down, “We’ll get them back.”
Adora nodded, tears still falling onto Catra’s shoulders, “Glimmer is going to organise the other princesses to help.”
Catra smiled, “Good. Sparkles seems good at that.” She hugged Adora tighter into herself, “I’m not letting Prime get you. You hear me?” When she didn’t get a response from Adora she pulled Adora back slightly so they were eye to eye, “You hear me?”
Under Catra’s glare, Adora nods. “Okay. Yeah.”
Glimmer teleports in to see Adora on top of Catra on the bed and Bow pretending to be doing something, “What is going on here?”
“Oh Glimmer!” Adora quickly climbs off Catra and the bed making Catra hiss in pain when she pushes down on the wrong spot,

“Shit! Sorry Catra! Are you okay?”
Catra laughs, “Yeah, just had a princess crawl on and off me. Most fun I’ve had in a long time.”
Adora blushes again at the joke. She flicks Catra’s ear again, causing Catra to let out a howl of pain along with a chuckle, “You deserve that!” Adora turns back to Glimmer, “Hey Glimmer! How’d it go? Are they coming?”
Glimmer gave Adora a smug look that instantly made Adora blush again, “Was I interrupting something?”
“Wha…? Uh, no?” Adora stutters out, “We were just, just talking.”
Glimmer raises an eyebrow at Adora, “Can we please drop it?”
Adora sighs and slumps down.
Glimmer breaks out in a laugh at Adora, “Fine. Bow?”
“Hey Glim.” Bow replies.
“We need to get the war room ready for all the princesses arriving in a few hours. Do you know where we keep all the extra chairs?” Glimmer asks, “Also, Adora?”
“Yeah?” Adora asks uncertainly, “I swear, we weren’t doing anything!”
Glimmer snorts, “No, I wasn’t going to go there again… I was going to let you know that all the princesses are coming. We’ll need to come up with an agenda or something.”
“Do you mean a plan, Sparkles?” Catra chuckles from the bed, “Make sure Spinneralla and Netossa are there, would you?”
Glimmer huffs, “It’s Glimmer, you ass!”
Catra laughs, “That never gets old!”
Adora places a hand on Catra’s head, almost threatening to flick her ears again, “Can you please not antagonize the people that are trying to help us?”
Catra moves her head up and down so it feels like Adora is rubbing the top of her head as she sighs, “Okay.” Turning her head to look at Glimmer, “Thank you for helping us Princess Glimmer of Bright Moon.” Another flick to the ear, “Ow! What the fuck Adora?”
“What did I just say?” Adora scolds as Glimmer breaks out in a fit of giggles. Bow is hiding his snickers behind his hand, “Guys, seriously.”
“Sorry!” Glimmer gets out once she catches her breath, “I can see

why you like her.”
“Oooh!” Catra mocks, “Someone likes me!”
“Shut up!” Adora says without any bite as she leans in a places a chaste kiss on Catra’s lips, shutting her up rather quickly, pulling back and crossing her arms as Catra processes what just happened, “That’s what I thought.” She’s met by the same goofy smile Catra gave her the first time on the balcony.
“You two are sickening sweet.” Glimmer complains.
“Awe… but it’s just so…so…cute!” Bow beams.
“Um, where were we?” Adora trying to hide her blush changes the subject.
“Oh yes, we need to go plan.” Glimmer replies, “Let's give Catra space to rest, okay?”
Before they walk out, Catra clears her throat and asks, “Can I see the video recording?”
They all stop. Adora replies back, “Are you sure?”
“Yeah.” Catra answers, “If that’s okay?”
Glimmer nods and Bow goes back to Catra’s bed, “I’ll, uh, catch up with you.” He turns to Catra, “I don’t want Adora to watch it again.” Catra nods as Glimmer and Adora exit.
Bow takes out a small screen and pushes a few buttons on it. Eventually the video plays. Catra watches it twice before letting Bow know he can put it away. She thanks him but he doesn’t leave.
“What?”
“Nothing.” He replies, but it’s clear there’s a question he wants to ask.
“Seriously dude, what?” Catra asks a little more irritated, “Just ask the question that you’ve been sitting on for the last half an hour or leave.”
He finally relents and to Catra’s surprise jumps up on the bed next to her, “Look, I wanted to ask…”
“Go on.”
“How’d you do it with Adora?” Bow realises what he just said, “No, no, no…I didn’t mean do it with Adora…haha…” He blushes, as does Catra who just sighs, but she’s also enjoying his inability to convey his thoughts, “I mean, how did you get Adora to like you. Like, like like you? You know, in a more than friends’ kind of way?”

He starts fidgeting with Catra's bedsheet in his fingers waiting for an answer."
"What the fuck are you on about dude?" Catra laughs, "She already like likes you or whatever."
Bow's eyes light up but then they dim just as quickly, "That's, that's not true."
Catra blows out an irritated breath, "Like I care. Take it or leave it Bow. Plus you don't want to go down my path, trust me."
"Why?"
"Well, firstly, her father still thinks I'm unworthy of Adora. So that's a thing." Catra huffs, "I bet you aren't unworthy of your princess huh?" Bow shakes his head, "Well, secondly, I had to swear an oath to lay my life down to protect them. I'm guessing you don't need to do that either." Again Bow shakes his head.
"Alright. Third on the list, is to piss off a powerful sorceress, have her frame you for theft and somehow treason at the same time, then have her torture you before escaping into the woods where you meet some crazy old woman that assaults you with her broom but at the same time heals your wounds with some stinky ointment all because her father has put an execution order on you for the said frame up."
Bow turns to face Catra, "Did that all really happen? Or are you joking? Since you know…you're a joker and all…"
Catra growls at his insinuations, "I'm not lying. How do you think I know Spinnerella and Netossa?"
Bow shrugs, "Sounds harsh Catra."
Catra sighs, "Trust me. If I could change the King's mind about me…"
"Catra." Bow puts his hand on Catra's shoulder causing Catra to growl again, he pulls it back immediately, "Sorry! Anyways… Adora clearly loves you."
"She what?" Catra sits up.
Bow chuckles at her reaction, "You are just as bad as me!"
"Am not!" Catra protests as she lies back down, "At least Adora and I have already kissed."
Bow blushes, "Uh, yeah. Like I was saying, Adora's loves you. I'm sure her father will come around."
He smiled that soft and comforting smile to Catra, she rolls her

eyes but smiles back, “Just, tell her Bow. What’s the worst that could happen?”
He made a worried face as Catra laughed at him, “I’ll tell her after we get Adora’s parent back.”
“I’ll hold you to it!” Catra chuckles, “Now, get out of here so I can get some rest!”
Bow jumps off the bed with the biggest smile Catra’s seen from him, “Thanks! And yeah, you should rest. See you later Catra!”
His enthusiasm makes Catra smile as she relaxes back into the bed to ‘rest’.

It’s been a few hours and all the princesses are in the war room. Glimmer has spent most of that time teleporting them over whilst some make it on their own. They do a quick introduction with Queen Angella overseeing this planning session.
“Uh, why are we all here?” Mermista asks, looking at her fingernails sounding bored, “Did we really need to all be here?”
Glimmer rolls her eyes, “Listen everybody. Adora’s parents are in trouble. Prime has taken them as hostage.” The room falls silent at the mention of Prime. “He is offering to release them on one condition.”
“What’s that? Wouldn’t it be easier to avoid conflict if we don’t need to?” Perfuma asks innocently.
“He will only release them if he gets Adora in return.” Glimmer replies, “Which we are not going to let happen.”
“Why does he want Adora?” Frosta pipes up, “I mean, he’s got the King and Queen…”
“Adora is the only one that has access to the Sword of Power. Prime needs the sword to power up his machine to take over this planet.” Bow explains, “The sword has some magically properties that can only be activated by Adora. We aren’t really sure how it works though.”
“Where’s the sword now?” Mermista asks a little more interested, “Because if Prime already has it…”
Netossa stands and pulls the sword out from her cloak, “I’ve got it right here.”
“Why do you have this?” Adora looks at the sword in Netossa’s hand, “How’d you get it?”

Netossa smirks as Spinneralla stands up, gently coaxing her wife to sit, “Catra got it out. Before she was blown out by the bomb.”
Adora stood up and took the sword from Netossa. It still had claw marks on it from when Catra was twelve. This was what started the whole thing. She squeezed the hilt of the sword harder in her hand, “What’s our plan?”
They all looked at each other and the planning session was well underway. The room was loud with opinions from all the princesses about how to proceed. The main focal points were that Adora was not to be traded and the second point was the sword was to kept far away from Prime. They all asked how the sword was activated and why Adora couldn’t just use the sword to defeat Prime. She had to keep explaining to them that she didn’t know how to use the sword or how it even activated. She didn’t even believe that it was her that could activate it. The discussions went well into the night. They were all so engrosses in their debates and arguments they hadn’t even noticed Catra had snuck into the meeting and stood in the shadows for about an hour before slipping back out.

While the princesses debated long into the night, Catra had slipped out of Bright Moon’s castle. On her way out she comes across another princess.
“What are you doing out here?” Entrapta enquires upside down, scaring the crap out of Catra who jumps back, “Should you not be back in bed resting?”
Catra gets up off the floor, dusting herself off, “Hey Traps! Thought I’d find you out here.”
“Oh, you were looking for me?” Entrapta slips over and rights herself. She moves closer into Catra inspecting her wounds, “Your wounds seem to have healed up rather quickly.” She smiles at Catra widely, “That is very interesting.”
“Yeah yeah.” Catra brushes Entrapta off, “Are you going to help me get back to Adora’s castle or not?”
Entrapta hummed, “Yes. I think I will.” She pushes a button on her tracker pad and a big machine comes out of the woods, “This is Emily the second.”
“The second?”

“Yes, Emily is inside the meeting right now taking in all the data, filtering all the nonsense out before getting back to me with any useful information.” Entrapta hums again, “Why are you going back to the castle alone?”
“I’m not alone.” Catra replies, “I’ve got you right?”
Entrapta beams, “Of course! Climb on.”
They both board Emily the second as the big robot easily carries them back to Adora’s castle, surprising the machine can be quite stealthy. Entrapta idly chatting away as Catra leans back and just listens.
“Do you have a plan Catra?” Entrapta asks as Emily the second stops, “Because it would be foolhardy to charge in head first without one…”
“Yeah, I do.” Catra grins, “We’ll be in and out before anyone knows we’re gone.”
Entrapta lets Emily the second continue on through the woods, “Emily has detected that the princesses are still arguing. So your assumption that we will be in and out before they know it may be quite plausible.” Catra nods in response, “Are you going to tell me your plan? Or are we ‘winging’ it again.”
Catra replies with an even wider grin as Entrapta mirrors it, “Traps, when have we actually really planned anything?”
“That’s true. Data shows that our success to failure ratio is much higher when we have very loose plans.” Entrapta states matter of factly, “Plus this means I get to test all my new tech!”
Catra laughs, “Yes you can.” Catra grabs Entrapta’s wrist before she can get too excited, “One thing though.” Entrapta nods, “We can’t hurt the King or Queen. No exceptions. Okay?”
“Okay!” Entrapta beams, “Should I even ask what you plan to do?”
“I’m going to get them out.” Catra replies as she turns to Entrapta letting go of her wrist, “I’m going to fulfil my oath.”

Adora rubs her temples, tired and frustrated that nothing is getting done. “Enough!” she yells, “We need to work together. We’re running out of time! So, please stop arguing.”
Glimmer pats Adora on the shoulder, “Look, lets take a break.” She turns to room and announces, “Everyone, take a break. Come

back in half an hour."
"What? We don't have time for break Glimmer!" Adora protests as she watches the princesses get up and walk out the room chatting amongst themselves.
"Adora. Everyone is on edge and tired." Glimmer calmly explains, "Let everyone cool off for a little bit and clear our heads. We'll figure something out soon."
"Fine." Adora sulks, "I'm going to see how Catra's doing."
Bow interrupts, "Uh…Adora?"
"What is it Bow?" Adora closes her eyes trying to calm herself down.
"Catra has kind of, sort of…left?" Bow confesses.
"What? When?" Adora asks shocked, "I thought she was bed bound? How is she even up and about?"
Bow shrugs but tries to provide an explanation anyways, "I think… it might be something to do with her genetic makeup?" He pulls out his tracker pad, "She's not human like me and you, essentially that is. I mean some of us have magically powers and all, well all of you princesses have…"
"Bow get to the point." Adora huffs, "Please."
He gives her an apologetic look and then resumes, "I think because she's a hybrid, her body heals faster. Kind of like animals out in the wild heal faster and on their own without medical intervention. I'm assuming is similar to when a cat licks its wounds?"
"That would explain a lot… but what do you mean she left?" Adora goes back to her original question, "Is she just somewhere in Bright Moon or somewhere else completely?" He looks at her sheepishly, "When did she leave?"
"I think, maybe a few hours ago…?" Bow answers looking away, "She can't have gotten too far though. Right?"
Adora sighs and nods, "You're probably right."
Glimmer comes back from her chat with her mum, "What's happening guys? Why the long faces? Well, er, longer faces?"
"I kind of lost Catra?" Bow admits.
"What?!" Glimmer yells, "How can you lose someone that's in a hospital bed, bandaged up to the head?"
Bow shrugs, "I only left her for a little bit."

“Bow. Go find her. Now!” Glimmer orders as he salutes and quickly runs out.
Adora looks around the room and notices Entrapta’s bot, Emily still in the room. She turns to Glimmer, “Have you seen Entrapta?”
Glimmer scans the room, “No. But Emily’s here.”
“I know. But doesn’t Entrapta usually collect Emily when we have breaks and whatnots?” Adora asks.
“Now that I think about… she does do that doesn’t she?” Glimmer thinks, “I don’t think I’ve seen her since our introductions and then she slipped out early saying something about mapping out network signals or something.”
Adora’s eyes widen, “Shit! She’s with Catra!”
“How do you know that?” Glimmer seems sceptic, “For all we know, she could be running around the vents or something.”
“No.” Adora says with certainty, “Catra’s gone back to the castle to rescue my parents… oh no…”
“What Adora?”
“She’s going to sacrifice herself. That stupid oath.” Adora laments, “She still thinks she’s unworthy.”
“Unworthy?” Glimmer seems confused.
“She told me that my father told her she was not worthy enough for me.” Adora told Glimmer, feeling the guilt in her stomach, “I thought she knew that I didn’t care what my parents think.”
“So…she’s going to rescue your parents to prove to your father that’s she is worthy for you?” Glimmer surmises, “What the actual fuck Adora? That’s seriously messed up.”
“It doesn’t matter, we need to stop her before she does something really stupid.” Adora rushes out, “Come on! We need everyone to help!”

It takes a solid hour before the princesses are ready to move out when a big robotic machine comes storming through the woods towards the castle. The princesses all get ready to defend only to hear a familiar voice from on top of said robot.
“Entrapta?” Adora asks, “Where’s Catra?”
Entrapta is not her normal happy self as she dismounts the large robot. Her eyes fixated to the ground. Perfuma puts her arms around Entrapta shoulders and pulls her in. Entrapta lets herself

get dragged in, but doesn't move.
"What happened?" Perfuma asks softly.
Entrapta looks up at Perfuma, tears in her eyes and then glances over to Adora before turning back to face the ground, "Catra and I went to rescue Adora's parents." Her words are rough as she tries to hold back her sobs. Entrapta turns to Adora, "Your parents are safe Adora."
Adora releases a relieved breath before she holds it again, "Where are they?"
"Catra got them out" Entrapta tries to keep her line of thought, "They are safe. We evacuated them to where your people have taken refuge."
"Limeria." Adora says to no one in particular, "Glimmer, can you get me there?"
"Adora wait." Entrapta's voice raises, "I have this…" she holds out her hand to Adora, "for you."
Adora reaches and accepts whatever Entrapta has in her hand, she looks at the item, "No." Adora whispers. "No. no, no, no!"
In her hand is Catra's pocketknife, the one Adora had just given back to her recently at the castle before the invasion. Entrapta continues her speech from the points she had memorised, "She's alive."
Adora looks up, "What?"
Entrapta nods as the rest of the princesses all murmur around them. "She's alive. Catra's alive. Prime has her."
Adora pushes Perfuma out of the way and stands face to face with Entrapta, "Tell me what happened."
A single tear fall from Entrapta's eyes as she takes a breath in. Instead of talking, she pulls out her tablet, pushes a few button and hands it over Adora. "Here. This is everything that happened."
Entrapta turns and walks back to her large bot as Emily joins her. She slumps against Emily looking despondent. Adora takes the tablet and sits on the castles front steps, as the rest of the princesses gather around the screen. Adora presses play:

"Traps, when have we actually really planned anything?" Catra says to Entrapta with a grin on her face.

“That’s true. Data shows that our success to failure ratio is much higher when we have very loose plans. Plus this means I get to test all my new tech!” Entrapta’s face is close to the camera as she says the words.
Catra laughs, “Yes you can. One thing though.” A pause, “We can’t hurt the King or Queen. No exceptions. Okay?”
“Okay! Should I even ask what you plan to do?” Entrapta’s camera turns back to Catra.
“I’m going to get them out.” The look in Catra’s eyes shows no fear and she lets go of Entrapta’s wrist, “I’m going to fulfil my oath.”
There’s a long silence and nothing but the sight of the sky moving as the camera is angled up as the pair travel in silence. Adora clicks forward on the video until the scenery changes. It’s the edge of the woods, looking at the castle. There’s smoke coming from within the castle walls and clones and drones are patrolling around the perimeter.
“Okay Traps, you ready?” Catra says, a grin on her face as her claws come out. The camera nods up and down, “Good. Oh wait.” Catra stops in her tracks as she turns back to Entrapta, “Here.”
“What’s this?” The camera points at Entrapta’s hand where Catra has placed her pocketknife.
“Just in case you need it.” Catra casually puts it, “Also, if I don’t make it out…can you give it to Adora?”
“You’ll make it Catra. You always do.” Entrapta replies enthuastically. “But I can hold onto it for you in the mean time if it makes you feel better.”
A grateful Catra smiles back to Entrapta, “Thank you. And you’re right, we’ll make it. We always do!”
The camera goes back to Entrapta following behind Catra as they weave their way through the woods without the Emily the second. They finally get to a clearing and Catra’s scouting for a way in. Catra comes back, “Can Emily the second create a distraction?”
A squeal comes from Entrapta, “Yes! What do you want?”
“What has she got?” Catra asks a very excited Entrapta who pulls out a remote and holds it in her hand, “What’s this?”
“Your distraction.” Entrapta says matter of factly. She pushes a green button on the control and a few missiles fly through the sky

and towards the castle, crashing into the side of the castle walls as Prime's clones move towards the disturbance. "See!"
Catra grins back at Entrapta, "That, is very cool. Got anymore?"
The camera nods again as it shows Entrapta push a few more buttons and more missiles fly into the castle, "Ooh, I hope Adora doesn't get mad at me for destroying the castle…" Catra shoots Entrapta another mischievous grin.
Adora's lips twitch at seeing Catra joke around.
"Okay, time for us to get going!" Catra runs out, Entrapta follows closerly behind as they duck into an emptied room, Catra gestures Entrapta to stay quiet and they creep through to the building until they get to the communications room. Catra gestures Entrapta to disable everything in the room as she moves away into another room. All of a sudden all the lights inside turn off and it's nothing but darkness. "Good work Traps!" Catra whispers, "Come on, we need to get to the south tower."
They move along the corridors and halls of the castle in the darkness, occasionally there's the sound of Catra slashing through metal, a few grunts and then the sound of bodies hitting the ground. Eventually they reach a room that's glowing green. Catra gestures for Entrapta to get closer to the walls and stay in the shadows as the peeks into room. She quickly presses back into the wall, facing Entrapta. Catra nods once.
"That meant your parents were in the room." Entrapta speaks from across the princesses, still slumped against Emily, "That was her signal."
Adora nods as she goes back to the screen:
"Hey Traps." Catra whispers, "When I get them free, I need you to get them down the tunnels under the castle. Don't let them turn back. Promise me!" Catra's hands are on Entrapta's shoulders as her face hardens, "Promise me!"
The camera nods, "I promise Catra." Entrapta whispers back.
"Don't go with them. Head back to Bright Moon once they are on their way Limeria." Catra commands, "Whatever you hear or see once they are free, do not come back for me. You hear?"
"Catra?" Entrapta's voice breaks a little, "No. You can't do this. Remember? We have to make it."
Catra smiles sadly at Entrapta, "We will make it." It's a lie, Catra

knows it and it shows in the way she says it, “We will make it. Trust me.”
“You don’t need to prove anything Catra.” Entrapta grabs Catra’s wrist.
Catra turns around stunned. Entrapta is not one for contact on the best of days, but she knows that this means Entrapta feels strongly about this. Catra puts both her hands on Entrapta’s shoulders, “It’s okay Traps. I have an oath to fulfil. I swore to my life to it. I know you don’t understand. And I know Adora’s going to kill me for this.” Catra grins when she says Adora’s name, “But, you have to trust me. I’ll come back. I promised remember?”
Entrapta nods again. “I remember. Just be careful.”
Catra nods and releases Entrapta. They both lean against the wall waiting for an opening for Catra to slide in and rescue the King and Queen. It takes a good 25 minutes before that happens. Adora watches the entire 25 minutes of them waiting, her worry building as each second passes.
The green light dims and Catra slips into the room, Entrapta doesn’t follow. She waits in the other room, hiding in the shadow of the wall. There’s some faint noises in the background that Adora can’t make. Then a very clear growl. Catra’s growl. The sound of metal hitting stone. Then 4 very distinctive sounds of metal hitting chain. Catra runs back in where Entrapta is, clutching her shoulder, the one that was shot the last time she was in the castle.
“Traps!” she yells, “Now!”
Entrapta pushes the red button her controller and a bright flash of light white outs the screen. The sounds of grunting can be heard in the background while the white took over the room. Once the picture returned to normal Catra was leading the King and Queen out of the room.
“Go. Get them out now!” Catra yells to Entrapta.
The camera nods up and down again as Catra pushes the royals further away from the room they were being held hostage in.
“Follow me!” Entrapta yells with glee, “We’ll need to go through the vents first.”
The royals just nod back as they follow Entrapta through the vents, Catra at the rear while Entrapa leads. Their breathes are

heavy and rapid as they flee from Prime.
“How far?” Catra whispers.
Entrapta looks at her device in her hand, different from the remote, “Just another two bends then we’ll be at ground level.”
Two bends later and Entrapta pulls out the grate for the vent and steps out cautiously. Once she’s sure the coast is clear, Entrapta signals for the others to come out. “Ah!” Entrapta makes a happy noise, “You kept my room in the same condition I left it in!”
There’s a chuckle from Catra in the background while Entrapta starts digging through boxes around the room, “Yeah, of course I did.”
The King scoffs, “What is the meaning of this Jester?” Entrapta turns for a moment capturing the King’s movement before going back to whatever she’s looking for, “Why does the Princess of Dryll have a room or whatever this is here?”
Catra doesn’t answer right away, “My King. This is Entrapta’s lab. I apologise for keeping this hidden from you. But I thought it would come in handy if anything was to happen. And well, look at this. We need her. We need this room.”
“Aha! Got it!” Entrapta victoriously celebrates, “Your majesties if you could hold out your arms so I can get these shackles off.”
The King scoffs again but both the King and Queen do what is asked and within minutes they are free of their binds. The Queen rubs her wrists, “Thank you Princess Entrapta.”
Entrapta brushes it off and goes back going through some other boxes.
“I got it, Traps.” Catra hold up the pair of shovels in her hands, “Now, we just have to dig.”
“What? Why would we need to dig?” The Queen asks, confused, “Where’s the rest of the rescue team?”
Catra walks over to the Queen, “My Queen, I had to blow up the tunnel entrance during the invasion to ensure the people got safely to Limeria.” Catra held up the shovels, “So, we need to dig it out so I can get you through there as well.”
“That could take forever!” The King chimes in, “How are we going to be able to dig fast enough not to be caught again?”
Entrapta returns to her boxes and pulls out a robot of sorts and tucks it into her bag, not paying attention to anyone. She then

moves to stand next to Catra. Catra gestures to Entrapta. "Oh right!" Entrapta realising it's her turn to speak, "Yes, the shovels are for you two once you are in the tunnels. I can get you into the tunnels quickly. But just in case you get to a point in the tunnel that requires some debris removal, they will come in handy."
"You guys ready?" Catra asks as she hands one shovel to the King and one to the Queen, "We don't have a lot of time. There's no rescue team. Too risky."
The Queen smiles, gently gripping Catra's arm where the tattoo is, "I see what my daughter sees in you."
A blush comes across Catra's face, the goofy smile makes and appearance before she drops it when she sees the King seething, "Uh, thanks my Queen. We need to go now!"
Catra leads them back to the underground refuge. The King and her make light work of the few drones on the way there. Once they get there, Entrapta pulls out the robot she took from her lab and turns it on.
"This is Molly." Entrapta introduces proudly, "Molly, please dig a hold wide enough for someone of the King's stature. "
The robot made a couple of beeps and then started on the task as the King and Queen watched in awe whilst Catra perused the area, keeping watch. After about 5 minutes, Molly reappeared and beeped twice. Catra came back over and inspected the hole.
"Looks good. Good work Traps."
"It was Molly!" Entrapta answers with a glee, "She really is something isn't she?"
"Uh yeah, something." Catra replies with a wry smile, "My King and Queen." Catra gestures to the tunnel, "You need to go now."
The King lowers himself down first without a word. When he reaches the largest part of the tunnel is calls for his wife to proceed. The Queen throws the shovel down first and then Catra helps her lower herself down. Before her feet touch the ground Catra pauses, "My Queen. Adora is in Bright Moon. She is safe. She will find you once we get back there."
The Queen nods. "Thank you Jester. I will work on my husband."
Catra grins and then nods as she lowers the Queen all the way to the ground. As soon as the Queen's is lowered down to the ground, gun shots are heard through the room. Catra ducks her

head into the hole, “Go! I’ll cover the tunnel entrance!”
Entrapta pulls Catra up and they find cover behind an old bookcase. Entrapta pulls Molly out from her bag, “I’m sorry Molly.” She says to the robot, her voice sad. She throws Molly back towards the hole and pushes another button on her remote, exploding the robot and instantly covering the hole. Catra grabs Entrapta once the drones are preoccupied by the explosion and head in the opposite direction.
They run through the castle, panting and Entrapta looks back every now and then. Catra fights off the drones, clearing a path for them to the exit. They finally see the clearing and Emily the second has risen up providing cover fire
“Argh!” Catra groans.
Entrapta turns and sees Catra being lifted up in a haze of smoke and electricity.

Adora gasps from behind the screen, her hand covering her mouth, “No…”

Catra growls as the electricity goes through her body, she still has enough strength in her to break out of it as she drops to the floor, landing on her side. Entrapta tries to grab Catra’s arm. “No. Get out of here Traps! I’ve got this.”
“Stop lying!” Entrapta screams back, “Come on Catra!”
“We won’t both get out of here.” Catra sighs from where she’s lying, “I’ll give you some cover. Now go!”
Catra gets up and runs into the smoke and electricity. Entrapta is frozen in place. Then she hears Catra yelling for her to go again. This time she runs. Emily the second covers her on the outside as Catra keeps whatever is inside the castle occupied. Entrapta runs as fast as she can back to the cover of the woods and meets up with Emily the second. She turns back to see if Catra makes it out. She stays watching for another half hour before the clones begin scouting close to the woods. She gets on Emily the second and heads back to Bright Moon.
The video recording stops there.

Adora looks up from the screen, “Where’s Catra?”
“Prime has here.” Entrapta says, “He went through Shadow Weaver and used her magic against us. I’m…I’m really… I’m really…”
Adora makes her way over to Entrapta. The smaller purple hair princess looks up, just barely, “I’m really sorry Adora.”
Adora pulls her in for a hug and Entrapta hugs her back. Entrapta breaks down in Adora’s arms as Adora’s tears soak into the purple hair in her face. Entrapta keeps repeating, “I’m sorry.”

Chapter End Notes

I don't mean to make Entrapta sad btw...

Reunions

Chapter Summary

Adora reunites with her parents.

Chapter Notes

New day, new chapter.
As always thanks for reading.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Adora!" The Queen runs and embraces her daughter in a tight hug. "I was so worried!"
"I'm so happy you're okay!" Adora words are muffled into her mother's shoulder, "How's father?"
The Queen looks around, "Oh there he is. He's busy helping the people with some tents. You know how he is." She looks back to Adora, "How did you get here so fast?"
"Oh, Glimmer popped me over." Adora sat back and watched her father, "How did you escape?"
Her mother hesitated. Adora waited patiently despite already knowing, she is staring intently at her mother until she cracks, "The Jester freed us." Adora just nods, "I'm sorry about what I said about her, Adora."
Adora shifted slightly after hearing her mother apologise for calling Catra unworthy for her, "What, uh, what made you change your mind?"
"I should have known better. I'm sorry. She is more than worthy for my daughter." The Queen smiled widely at Adora. The fact that it wasn't returned made the Queen concerned, "Adora? What's wrong? Where's Catra?"
Adora fidgeted with her shirt hem as she tried to control her breathing, "Shadow Weaver got her. Prime used Shadow Weavers magic and Catra… Catra saved Entrapta…"
"Yes, the Princess of Dryll." Her mother interrupted, "Did you know she had a lab in our castle the whole time?"

“Mom!” Adora whined, “That’s not the point. Catra’s been taken. Primes got her.”
The Queen covered her mouth to muffle the gasp, “We need to get her back!”
Adora smiled at her mother's resolve, “Yes. Yes we do.”
“Your father may need some convincing though.” Her mother provided, “He is still…upset…”
“What does he have to upset about?” Adora scoffed, “It’s ridiculous! How can he be so stubborn? She rescued both of you, without any backup and yet he still treats her like shit!”
“Language Adora!” Her mother scolds, “I already told Catra I will work on him. So, simmer down. We need to figure out how to get your Joker back.”
Adora blushes, “How do you know about that?”
“I’m guessing she hasn’t shown you her oath tattoo?” Her mother smirks.
Adora shakes her head, “Not clearly. I only saw it through the communicator screen, and it was blurry.” Her mother snickers next to her, “What? What’s so funny?”
“Oh Adora.” Her mother sighs, “When we get her back, you can take a look for yourself, and you will understand.”
Adora huffed and crossed her arms, “You’re seriously not going to tell me?”
Her mother shook her head, “Sorry dear, it’s not my story to tell.”
Glimmer teleports back in, startling Adora and her mother, “Oh good, your both here!” Glimmer’s breathing changed, “Prime has sent another message.”
“Randor! Come here!” The Queen called over to the King, “You have to see this! Princess Glimmer has a new message from Prime!”
“Alright woman!” King Randor stomps over, “You do not need to shout.”
A grin appears on the King’s lips as he wraps Adora up in a big hug, “Let me down!” Adora giggles in her father’s arms.
“No way am I letting you go again!” The King declares. He looks over to the Queen and grins. She yelps as he picks her up too and the three of them embrace in one big hug. “I amend my previous stance. I am not letting either of you go again!”

Glimmer clears her throat loudly, “I’m sorry King Randor, but this is important.”
The King releases his wife and daughter and approaches Glimmer, “Show me.”
She turns the screen over to show Adora’s family and presses play on the video.

“This is Lord Prime. I am very disappointed. I thought my demands were reasonable. It seems there’s one of you that thinks themselves better than the rest.” They drag out Catra. She’s unconscious and covered with blood. There are a few open wounds on her torso and her arm shoulder looks to be dislocated, but she’s breathing in shallow rapid breaths. “I have one final demand. Bring me Princess Adora and the Sword. You know what I am capable of.” He snapped his fingers and Catra stood up on her own. Her shoulder seemed to pop itself back in and the wounds on her body healed closed. When she opened her eyes, they were green. Catra smiled as she kneeled before Prime. “Glory to Prime.” Catra chanted and as she stood up, she smiled again. “Glory to Prime.”
“As you can see, your Catra has seen the light and believes in cleansing this planet.” Prime boasts. “I can bring everyone into the light. If you do not bring me what I desire, I will destroy this planet slowly and everyone and everything will suffer and burn.” An evil grin graces Primes face as the recording ends.

Everyone is silent. No one dares to speak.
“I have to go. We have to save Catra!” Adora stands up, “We have to save her!”
“Adora.” The King speaks up, “We cannot risk our lives for one.”
Adora’s balls her fists by her sides as she steps up to confront her father, “She risked her life to save yours. And mother’s. And everyone else in this camp! We can’t just leave her there.” Her voice breaks at the end of the sentence, “If you don’t do anything, I will.”
Glimmer pops up next to Adora, “Then I’m with you.” Adora smiles gratefully to her friend, “Even if she is an ass…”
Adora laughs but hugs her friend, “Thank you.”
“I’m with you too.” Adora turns around. The Queen reaches out to

Adora's hand, "I will help. We will get her back."
Adora brings her mother in for a hug. In the back there are calls from the people of their kingdom.
"I will help!"
"Me too!"
"I'll help fight Prime!"
"Get Catra back! We need her back!"
Adora is overwhelmed with the positive response and she can't help but feel proud of her Joker. Everyone turns to the King. He stands alone in his stance.
"Well? Will you help us get Catra back?" Adora asks.
The King stills, thinking. He runs his fingers through his beard and then clears his throat. "Okay Adora." Adora's eyes widen, unsure if she just heard him right. The King takes Adora by the shoulders, "Let's get our Jester back." A wicked grin on his face.
Cheers erupt from the camp as they unite to save the Jester and Adora's Joker.
Adora turns back to Glimmer, "Can you speak to your mother? See if you can convince the Princess Alliance to…"
She's cut off by Glimmer holding her hand up, "Adora, we all saw the video." Adora eyes widened knowing that everyone was aware that Catra was now working for Prime, "Don't worry. They are all on board to help. Especially Entrapta. I've had to threaten to destroy Emily and the rest of her toys if she doesn't stop trying to leave on her own."
Adora smiled at the thought, she never saw Catra get close to other people but at the same time she wasn't surprised. There were always a lot of times when they were apart, either by duty or from other things that were out of their hands. She never imagined that Catra and Entrapta would have gotten so close, so close that Catra would keep an entire lab secret from everyone.
The King approached the pair, "Excuse me Princess Glimmer," He started, "Can you ask your mother Queen Angella to hold a meeting for a rescue mission to save our Jester? All of these people," He gestures to his people that are now taking refuge in Limeria, "Are willing to fight Prime and his army. We will not lose are Jester to Prime. We will not let her down."
Adora gapes at her fathers words, "Are you saying…?

He turns away from Adora, “She is one of our people Adora. And she continues to live up to her oath that she swore to protect us. We will not leave her to the wolves. We will get her back.”
“Why do you still think she is unworthy then?” Adora’s eyebrows furrowed, “You speak so fondly of her but then the idea of us being together…”
“I am fond of Catra.” King Randor sighs, “I just don’t want you to get hurt.”
“She’s never hurt me!” Adora puts her hands on her hips, “She’s my best friend. How can you think she’ll hurt me?”
“Adora, you know your mother and I both love Catra.” He tried to pull Adora’s hands away from her hips, she lets them drop to her side as he gently grips her right hand, “But you know what happens when someone swears the oath.” Adora nods slowly still not understanding why it was such a problem, “Have you heard the oath? Really listened to it?”
Adora just stared up at her father, “I don’t know… I don’t understand… what are you trying to tell me?”
Her father sighs again, “Part of the oath is to surrender what you want the most. That is what the tattoo’s represents. Has she shown you the tattoo?” Adora nods, “Then you know what she had agreed to surrender.”
“I didn’t get a good look at it.” Adora admits.
“Okay…let me ask you this question.” The King relaxes a little, “Did she willingly show you on her on accord or did you demand to see it?”
Adora thinks back and then her lips form a thin line, “I, uh, I demanded she show me.”
Her father releases her arm, “Oh, well, then that changes things…”
“What do you mean?”
“You demanded to see it?” He asked to reconfirm, Adora nods, “But you didn’t get a good look at it? How can that be?”
“I demanded to see it as proof of the oath when she was in hiding. She only showed it to me over our communication devices.” Her father raised an eyebrow, “Don’t start, father. I was just trying to help her.”
“Well, in that case,” King Randor steps back and places both

hands on Adora's shoulders, "I deem her worthy. When we get her back, demand her to show you the mark again. You will understand what this conversation means."
"King Randor?" Glimmer cuts in after patiently waiting, "Where would you like to hold this meeting? If you would like, I can teleport you and a few of your people back to Bright Moon…"
"That'd work. It'll just be Adora and me though." He replies with a gently smile. He looks over to his wife, "Marlena!"
The Queen looks up from where she had been helping bandage the arm of a woman that had been injured in the fight, "Yes? Must you yell?"
He grins at her, "Yes. As king I must have a clear and demanding voice." The Queen rolls her eyes lovingly, "I have a favour to ask of you."
"Go on."
"Adora and I will be heading to Bright Moon to speak to the other kingdoms to mount a counterattack against Prime. We will also get Adora's Joker back." Adora's face turned red as she blushed, "Come on Adora." He laughed, "Are you so embarrassed to be in love?" Her face went even redder when he said that so loudly.
King Randor turned back to his wife, "Anyways, while I am gone, I ask that you continue to look after our people. We will be back soon." He kisses the Queen on the forehead and smiles.
The Queen rolls her eyes, "You know that I practically run everything anyways, right?"
"Of course, I do!" the King agrees, "I will never understand why you let me lead."
She nudges him, "I prefer not to have to attend all those boring meeting you have to. Not to mention, I don't enjoy having to wear royal military entire the majority of the time."
"Just admit it, love." The King teases, "You just can't stand dealing with people diplomatically."
The Queen smirks, "I could you know." She looks around to Adora, "But you know what happens if I handle things… diplomatically."
King Randor belly laughs, "Your idea of diplomacy is to use your fists, dear. It got to the point that none of the other kingdoms would meet with us because they were so afraid of dealing with

you."
"I got plenty done, did I not?" She smirks.
"Yes, you did. But at the same, the other kingdoms only came out of fear." The King laughed, "And we both know that's not how it should be. I know you never intended those meetings to end in a malee, but you seem to have a knack for it."
"It's not my fault that other kingdoms have such old thinking." Queen Marlena remarked, "If they want to speak down to us then they better back it up."
"Okay…" Glimmer snickers in the background, "Shall we get going?"
King Randor kisses his wife one last time and then holds onto Adora's hand as Glimmer teleports them back to Bright Moon.

Everyone is in the Bright Moon war room. Queen Angella chairs the meeting this time. There's a little bit of murmuring and chatting happening across the room as everyone gets settled down. The room is filled with more people than just the Princess Alliance. Apart from King Randor, there are the high ranking generals and other soldiers in the room. Entrapta is actually in the room, perched on top of Emily, still looking sullen.
Adora decides to sit next to her. The purple hair girl smiles gratefully back at Adora. A comforting arm from Adora wraps around Entrapta and a visible sigh of relief is let out from Entrapta as she leans into Adora's side.
"Are you alright?" Adora whispers.
"No." Entrapta answers simply, "But I will be once I get Catra back."
"We." Adora corrects as Entrapta looks up at Adora's expression.
"We." Entrapta repeats, a smile appearing on her face as she straightens herself out on top of Emily, "We will get her back."
Queen Angella clears her throat, "Thank you everybody for coming." She greets, "We will not be going through introductions but getting straight to the point." Everyone just nods as the room quietens down, "As you know King Randor's kingdom was attacked recently by Prime. As a result, their people have taken refuge in Limeria."
She looks over at King Randor with a look of concern but she just

gives him a slight smile, “In any case, we need to work together and fight Prime.”
A few cheers ring out around the room as Queen Angella gestures for them to calm down, “Thank you for your enthusiasm. So, in working together we will be splitting our resources for two missions.” Another round of murmurs, “As you are aware, the first mission is to fight Prime. We can only end the war when he is defeated. The second mission, I will let Princess Adora explain.”
Adora stands up from where she is next to Entrapa, “Thank you Queen Angella.” She takes a deep breath, “The second mission is to rescue Catra.”
Entrapta eyes lights up, “I want in on that mission!”
Adora giggles at Entrapta’s eagerness, “Yes. You will definitely be on this mission with me. I will also require a few more people.”
Mermista groans, “Ugh, fine. I’ll help or whatever.”
Glimmer snickers, “Me and Bow are in as well.” She doesn’t even look for Bow for confirmation but he is nodding in the corner.
Adora turns and looks to her father, “I will bring the sword with me.” King Randor isn’t surprised as he nods, “If Prime wants me, then he will get me.”
Queen Angella claps her hands together, “Well, that’s settled then. Adora, Entrapta, Glimmer, Bow and Mermista you may go and start planning your rescue. Everyone else, we shall start planning our attack on Prime. Oh Entrapta, before you go, can we speak to you first? We may would like to use some of your tech.”
Entrapta beams, “Of course!”

The rest of rescue team splits off into the mess hall. They pull a few tables together and move the chairs around their makeshift war table. Once satisfied, Glimmer teleports out and a minute later pops back in holding Adora’s sword. She places it in the middle of the tables and steps back.
Adora looks at the sword, focussing on the claw marks on the handle. She doesn’t make a move to take it, just stares at it.
Mermista speaks up first, “So, first I need to let you know Sea Hawk is also on this…team too. I forgot that he follows me wherever I go.” Glimmer snickers behind and Mermista glares back at Glimmer until she stops, “Anyways… Your castle is near

the sea, yeah?"
"Yeah, the sea is not too far from the castle." Adora confirms, "It's actually connected to our moat, so there's a dock on the north side of the castle. Why?"
Mermista rolls her eyes in a way that conveys that the others should know what she's thinking, "Okay… so, why don't we sneak in using the docks? It'd be a hell of a lot quieter and they won't be expecting it."
"And how are we supposed to get there without being spotted? It's not exactly hard to see a big ass ship sailing towards the castle." Glimmer points out, "Unless you can turn the boat invisible."
It's at that moment Entrapta joins group, sitting atop of Emily, "What were you saying about an invisible boat?"
"I was just saying that we would be spotted if we tried to sail into the fight against Prime." Glimmer recaps, "I might as well teleport everyone in."
"Glimmer, you know you don't have enough juice to do that and that would leave you vulnerable if you ran out." Bow provides, "You can't be reckless. Not with this."
The concern in his eyes breaks down Glimmers hard resolve, "You're right."
"I can get the boat to be invisible." Entrapta states plainly.
Everyone stops and turns to her with puzzled looks on their faces, "Oh, wait, not me. Melog can do it."
"Melog?" Adora asks, "Who or what is Melog?"
"Oh, that's right… you don't know about Melog…" Entrapta smiles understanding the confusion, "Melog is Catra's companion."
"How do I not know this?" Adora asks.
"There's a lot of things you don't know Adora." Again, monotone from Entrapta, "Let me just get them. It make take a while. They usually follow Catra around but Catra had sent them on a mission of their own a few weeks ago. She sent them out to find some tech for me." Entrapta pushes a few buttons on the new device she pulled out of her overall pocket and slid the device back in, "Done. They'll be here as soon as they can."
"Uh, and how long is that?" Mermista groaned, "I'll get Sea Hawk over to Bright Moon docks in a day."

“Melog will be here by then.” Entrapta grins happily as she busies herself with the communication device in her hands, “In the meantime, I’m going to work on upgrading my robots.”
“Thanks Entrapta.” Adora says as the Princess of Dryll exits into another room. Adora turns back to her friends, “Okay, let’s get planning!”

Chapter End Notes

Entrapta is kind of happy again..?

Recue Mission

Chapter Summary

Attacking Prime and his army to get Catra back

Chapter Notes

Happy new year! almost...
Enjoy and thanks for reading!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

King Randor leads the attack on Prime from the South, through the woods. Prime has taken King Randor's castle and is using it as their base. The rescue team will be going to be entering from the north, through the docks with the help of Melog. Adora hugged her father and mother prior to departing for her part of the mission. All abled men and women of King Randor's kingdom have taken up arms and march behind their King and Queen. Alongside them is Frosta, Perfuma, Scorpia and their troops as well as the Bright Moon army. Queen Angella will be running operations from Bright Moon of the other kingdoms while Spinneralla and Netossa ensure the villages and towns are vigilant of the incoming war. They will be available upon request from Queen Angella.
King Randor signals for his troops to get into position as his most experience troops march directly behind him and his horse, followed by the people that have taken up arms. The other princesses march alongside the King, their own troops marching behind them.
They march towards Prime's base, when the King signals everyone to halt. Everyone remains on high alert, not sure why they had stopped marching when they haven't engaged the enemy yet.
"To all my allies, I am grateful for your assistance. It will be this fight, today, that will end the war. End the virus that is Prime." A loud cheer erupts from the troops as the King grins, "So, fight with pride. Fight for your kingdoms. Fight for you land. Fight for your family. Fight for yourself. Fight for your freedom!" Another

loud cheer, “We will win! We have to win!”
The cheering continues as he looks to his allies on his sides. He nods and grins, eager to get started.
“Are you ready?” Perfuma asks softly to the King.
He grins wider, “Charge!”

The attack on Prime begins as Adora and her rescue team sneak in through the docks. Melog’s magic makes it easier for them to sneak in unseen thanks to their ability to make their vessel and them invisible. Once they get to the docks undetected, Adora signals for Mermista and Sea Hawk to stay on the boat with Melog and take out as many clones and drones by surprise. They will ensure that no one escapes by sea if Mermista has anything to do with it. Mermista grips her trident tightly in her hand as she smirks, eagerly waiting for her opportunity to take down Prime’s troops. Sea Hawk just as excited as he sails away from the docks.
“Okay, Lets go!” Adora signals, she’s got the sword sheathed and slung on her back as they move towards where Prime will be.
“Entrapta, can you see where they are holding Catra?”
Entrapta looks down at her tablet and they can see a dot on the screen moving around. It’s headed to the south. It’s heading south towards the attack. “She’s headed towards the south. We need to get there before she starts doing some serious damage!”
They all start moving quickly, Adora removing the sword from the sheath as she holds it in her hand ready to defend if she needs to.
“Glimmer, Bow, you guys know what to do.”
Her friends nod and Glimmer teleports the two of the away leaving Entrapta and Adora to continue to find Catra. “Are we close?”
Entrapta hums, “Yes, she should be just behind this door.”
Cautiously they open the door, wincing at every creak as it opens. They peek in and see that the room has been blown wide open. It has the perfect view of the battle happening on the south side of the castle. The door is yanked open as Adora and Entrapta are dragged inside roughly. They are tossed down in front of Prime sitting on the King’s throne.
“Ah, Princess Adora and…friend.” He greets wickedly, “I see you have also brought me the sword as well. Well done.”

Adora stands up, pulling Entrapta up with her, “Prime. Where is Catra?”
“Your Catra is right here.” He gestures to his right where Catra steps up.
“Hello Adora.” Catra says coldly.
Entrapta hums nervously, “Adora, I don’t think that’s Catra…”
“It’s okay Entrapta.” Adora whispers, “I know she’s still in there somewhere.”
“Now, Princess Adora. If you wouldn’t mind.” He holds his hand out, “The sword.”
Adora tightens her grip on the swords handle, “No. Release Catra.”
Prime puts his hand on Catra’s shoulder and laughs, “Catra is happy here. She doesn’t need you.” Catra green eyes flash back to normal of less than a second before going back to green. “Isn’t that right, little sister.”
“Glory to Prime.” Is all Catra replies.
Adora gasps, “Let her go!” She screams out, “You’ve got me now, so let her go.”
Prime examines the sword in Adora’s hand before he grins, “You have no idea how to use the sword. Do you?”
Adora frowns as she looks at the sword in her hand, “Shut up! Release her or…”
“Or you’ll what?” Prime growls. Adora stays silent. “Thought so. You know I think you two need some time to reconnect.” He turns to Catra, “Bring her down.”
Catra grins.
Adora watches Prime leave the room, Catra stays exactly where she is, waiting. Once the door shuts Adora turns around to see Catra who is no longer standing by the throne. Her breathing is growing rapidly as she tries to find Catra. She looks to Entrapta who is moving around the room looking for something and that’s when Catra attacks. Adora’s pushed down to the ground, falling down onto her hands and knees, the sword sliding out from her hand. Catra casually kicks the sword further away from Adora.
“Hello Adora.” Catra says circling Adora.
Adora gets back to her feet, “Come on Catra!” Adora pleads, “Fight it!”

“I don’t want to. I’m happy here.” Catra replies, “You can be too.”
A creepy grin comes across Catra’s face as they start hand to hand combat. Adora dodges Catra’s punches but every now and then she’ll miss Catra’s claws swinging through and ripping at her clothes and skin.
“I know you’re in there! Fight it!” Adora pleads again, “Remember your oath!”
Catra pauses. Adora thinks she’s gotten through. Out of nowhere Entrapta whacks Catra in the back of the head with a long piece of wood. Catra’s body takes the brunt but doesn’t move or flinch. Instead she grins a little wider, now focussing on Entrapta.
Entrapta makes a run for it, “Grab the sword Adora, I’ll distract Catra!”
Catra growls, “Come back!” She chases Entrapta out the castles walls and into the battle raging on outside.
Adora breathes heavily as she watches Entrapta coax Catra outside, she picks up the sword and then goes after them. Catra no doubt is fast. She catches up to Entrapta and pins her to the ground. Her claws at the ready to kill.
“Catra no!” Entrapta screams out, “This is not you! You promised!”
Catra stills, “You promised you’d come back!” Entrapta sobs, hoping that this is not her end. She has a remote in her hand, her finger ready to push the button that will enact Emily to take Catra out with a clear shot.
“…Traps?” Catra mumbles. Her claws retracts and her hand comes down to no longer threatening. Her eyes are still green. Catra shakes her head, trying so hard to get Prime out of her head.
“You PROMISED!” Entrapta screams out again.
Catra gets off Entrapta, holding her head in her hands as she takes off into the battlefield.
Adora checks up on Entrapta before giving chase after Catra again. Catra is avoiding all the swords and gun fire from both sides of the war as she crashes through everyone and everything in her way to try and get Prime out of her head. An arrow pierces through her shoulder and she comes crashing down to the ground. Adora reaches her and draws her sword to Catra’s throat.
“Catra!” Adora yells at her but remains ready, “Snap out of it!”
Catra eyes flash green and then back to normal again for a

moment. Catra closes her eyes trying to centre herself. When she opens them her eyes are green again. An evil green on her face as she pulls the arrow through her shoulder, seemingly without pain. She pushes herself closer to the tip of Adora's sword, "Go on, run me through."
Those aren't Catra's words. Those are Prime's taunts.
A tear escapes Adora's eyes, "Please Catra… please fight him…"
In the brief moment that Adora tries to wipe away the tear, Catra grabs Adora and pins her to the nearest tree. Spinning her around so Catra's chest is on Adora's back. Catra takes a deep breath, smelling Adora's hair. "Mm. Princess."
Catra pins Adora's arms above her head, the sword drops to the ground by the force as Catra presses harder into Adora's back. "Catra…stop! Please…"
Catra takes another deep breath in of Adora's hair, "What's the matter Princess? Isn't this what you want? Am I not who you want?"
Adora closes her eyes, "Not like this Catra." It comes out more like a whisper but it's not like the real Catra is there right now, "Before you do whatever it is you are going to do to me, can I ask you a favour?"
Catra snorts, "A favour? You want a favour?" Adora just nods, eyes still closed, hoping. "Okay, Princess Adora, what is this favour?"
Adora takes a breath in, "Let me see your mark."
"My mark?"
"Yes. Your mark. I demand to see it." Adora speaks with as confidence as she can, "I have the right to see it."
Catra's eyes fade back to normal as she looks down at the leather band wrapped around her forearm, "Let me get this straight." Catra says as her eyes glow green again, "I show you this mark and you will join me to bring glory to Prime?"
Adora doesn't answer as Catra presses a little more into Adora's back, "Just show me the mark first. Please."
Catra releases Adora so she can turn around. Instead of unlacing the band herself she holds her arm out to Adora. "You want to see it? Then do it."
Adora reaches out and starts to undo the strings around the band,

trying not to look up at Catra's face. She can feel Catra's eyes on the back of her head as she unties the band and it's unnerving. When the band comes loose, Adora gently takes it off and stands back waiting for Catra to turn her arm over so she can display the tattoo.
Catra flips her arm over so her palm is up and the tattoo is visible to Adora, "There. Now you've seen it."
Before Catra can pull her arm away, Adora grabs hold of Catra's wrist and holds it in place to get a proper look. She lets out a surprised gasp when she finally sees what the tattoo on Catra actually is. She could only make out the playing cards in the grainy picture when Catra showed her through the communication device but it's all clear now. There are 2 playing cards over her family's emblem. The one of the playing cards is a heart, a literal heart. The second playing card is a portrait of Adora. A portrait of Adora at 17 years old, because Catra had it tattooed on her at 16 when she took the oath.
Almost in a whisper but just loud enough for Catra to hear, "You gave up your heart and…me…when you took the oath?" She looks up at Catra finally, "But why?"
The green in Catra's eyes fade. Prime has been pushed out of Catra's consciousness for now. Catra covers the mark with her other hand, "Because I have loved you since…forever. Part of the oath is to surrender what means the most to you. It was a no brainer."
"You love me?"
"You're such an idiot." Catra grins.
Entrapta comes running from behind Catra and stabs something into her neck. Catra screams in pain as she falls forward, Entrapta on her back as Adora catches Catra in her arms.
"What are you doing?!" Adora frantically tries to stay upright.
Entrapta jumps off Catra's back, but leaves whatever she has stabbed in her neck there, "I had to."
Adora sees the Catra's pocketknife embedded into Catra's neck, "Why did you stab her?!"
Entrapta steps back, "I had to."
Catra pulls the knife out of her neck, blood spilling out of the wound. Adora moves quickly to press down on the wound, putting

pressure on it to stop the blood loss. “Lie down Catra!”
Catra chuckles, “Only in my dreams have you ever said that me princess…” Catra stumbles down to the ground, she lies in Adora’s lap while the blonde continues to put pressure on the wound, “How is it I am always in your arms? Just luck I guess.” Catra answers her own question.
Entrapta comes up behind Adora, gently pushing Adora’s hand off Catra’s neck and placing her own on top of it. “What are you doing Entrapta?”
Catra opens her eyes, “Hey Traps… Told you I’d be back…”
Entrapta gives her a half smile as she lifts her hand off Catra’s neck revealing a patch of sorts that stems the bleeding. She turns to Adora, “It was the only way to get Prime’s serum out of her system. The patch will stop the bleeding.” She turns to Catra, “I worried about you.”
“I’m sorry Entrapta.” Catra apologises, “Also stabbing me in the neck?”
Entrapta looks down, a little guilty for the action, “I had to.”
Catra grins, “It’s okay Traps. I don’t blame you for wanting to stab me. I would too.” Entrapta looks up and beams back to Catra. She quickly wraps her arms around Catra, “Oh, okay… didn’t think you were much for physical contact.” Adora crawls out from under both of them as she gets stands over watching.
When Entrapta just hums, Catra pulls her in just a little tighter. Catra then looks around and notices her arm band on the ground and Adora standing over her. “Hey Traps?” Catra gives her a brief squeeze, “Reckon you can get off now?”
“Oh, of course!” Entrapta leaps out of Catra’s arms, “I think we need to get back to the battle…”
“Yeah, right behind you.” Catra calls out after Entrapta who runs off into the distance, “Hey Adora.”
A moment passes and it’s Adora’s turn to jump into Catra’s, pinning Catra down to the ground. Not a minute too soon, Adora pushes herself up out of Catra’s arms and flicks her ear causing the hybrid to hiss and growl. Adora points to Catra, daring her to say something, “You are going to be the death of me. You know that right?”
Catra grins as she wraps her arms around Adora’s waist pulling

her back down, “I’m sorry Princess.”
“You’re supposed to just make the court laugh.” Adora huffs into Catra’s chest, “Not go around trying to get yourself killed!”
“I wasn’t trying to get myself killed…” Catra breathes out softly, “You are the most important thing in my life. I can’t stand to see you sad if something happened to your parents Adora.” Adora sighs, “Come on Princess. We need to help fight Prime.”
“Okay.” Adora gets onto her feet and then pulls Catra up as well. She hands the leather band back to Catra who promptly ties it back around her forearm.
“Here. Take it.” Catra holds Adora’s sword handle to her, “You’re going to need it to fight.”
Adora takes the sword and grins, “Side by side?”
“Hell yes!” Catra smirks as they run towards the battle.

The main battle is evenly matched. Both sides are not gaining or losing ground.
King Randor spots Entrapta joining the battlefield, “Where’s Adora?!” he yells, “Is she safe?”
Entrapta nods as she runs past towards Emily, “Emily! I’m so happy to see you!” She gets on top of the robot and starts pushing buttons on her remotes and almost instantaneously missiles and gun fire are launched taking out triple the amount of drones and clones as the troops are getting.
King Randor tries to look around when Prime beams in, making his presence known by slashing his own sword around and taking out both his clones and the enemy. Eying the King, Prime makes his way over, slashing indiscriminately, not caring who is in his way. The King slashes through clones and pushes away his own troops, looking to meet Prime in the middle.
“Ah, if it isn’t the King.” Prime taunts, “Your daughter disappoints me.”
“Good.” The King replies as they engage in a sword fight, “I hope she continues to disappoint you!”
Prime surprised by the King’s sheer power and skill, steadies and counter attacks, “I will break her!” He grits, “Once I kill you and everyone she loves. She will serve me.”
King Randor laughs, “You will do no such thing!” They fight

harder, pushing each other backwards and forwards, “I will kill you!”
Prime laughs this time, landing a solid kick on the Kings stomach making King Randor stumble backwards. With his sword primed to run through the King, Prime stutters backwards, clutching his face. King Randor recalls seeing something very similar that happened to Shadow Weaver.
“Get your father out of here Princess!” Catra growls.
“No. You get him out! I’m going to end Prime!” Adora argues.
Catra growls louder, “Listen to me Princess.” Adora frowns at the tone of being talked back to, “You are too valuable to go against Prime! I’m sorry.” Catra plants a kiss on Adora’s lips before shoving her back to her father, “Prime is mine.”
“Adora.” King Randor pleads, “Trust her.”
Adora groans but nods, “Fine!”
King Randor grabs Adora and they move away from Prime and back to the smaller fights whilst Catra sizes up against Prime.
“Ah! Little sister!” Prime taunts trying to connect to her, “I see you have somehow disabled our connection.”
“Yeah, it wasn’t really working for me.” Catra replies nonchalantly, “I really don’t like having more than one voice in my head”
“That’s too bad. But, not a problem. Another dose of serum will do the trick.” Prime circles, pulling out a syringe with green liquid in it, “Why don’t you come over here? I can make all your problems disappear.”
“Oh really?” Catra acts surprised, “So, it’ll get rid of you then? Cos you seem to be one of my problems.”
“A joker. Of course you are.” Prime seethes when he realises his method of intimidation isn’t working.
Dodging Primes swing of his sword Catra rebuffs, “That’s what the princess calls me after all. I’m sorry. Is that supposed to be an insult?” Another dodge and a roll out and away from Prime, “Come on, Prime-time, is that the best you’ve got?”
Prime growls at the retort, “Shadow Weaver had the right idea in the end, just poor execution.”
“Ugh, why does everyone want to execute me?” Catra groans whilst rolling her eyes before it’s quickly wiped off her face with a grin, “Is it my dashing personality?”

“I will finish what she started.” Prime swings his sword faster and more violently towards Catra, “You will die by my hand. I promise you this!”
Catra stands back just far enough out of Prime’s reach and just laughs, “So many broken promises. Oh, my heart.” She comes back and into range and punches him square in the jaw before rebounding back out of his reach.
“I offered you a change to serve under me and this is how you repay me?!” Anger clearly getting the better of Prime now, he sheathes his sword and closes his eyes.
Catra’s caught off guard when all his clones stop in their tracks and all focus on Catra. “Oh shit.” She mumbles before yelling back to Prime, “Can’t beat me one on one huh?”
“I’m not a fool. Why should I get my hands dirty?” He takes the syringe with the serum in his hand and holds it up, “Now. Brothers! Bring her to me. Dead or Alive.”
Realising she’s in a whole lot more trouble than she’s ready for, Catra decides it’s time to high-tail out of there as best she can. It’s no use as every direction she goes are clones. Clones that are trying to get. Trying to kill her. She grunts and growls as she slashes through clone after clone until her claws are sore and her muscles are tired. “Is that all you’ve got?!” She yells trying to invigorate herself to keep fighting.
As she’s slowly being overwhelmed by the sheer amount of clones attacking her, she trips and falls down. She hunches over waiting for the fatal blow. It doesn’t come.
“Get away from my Joker!” Adora screams as she slashes through the clones surround them.
“Are you okay?” The King reaches down and helps Catra up.
“Yeah. I’ve been better.” Catra replies as the King chuckles, “Say… have you got a spare sword? Knife? Rock?”
The King laughs a little harder as he slashes through a few more clones attacking them, “Yes Jester. Here.” He pulls out a dagger and hands it Catra, “I could have told you, your claws would hurt after a few rounds.”
The 3 of them fight back to back in a triangle as they force back the clones. Then a few more troops and the other princesses all join in to protect Catra from the clones.

“Hey Adora?” Catra pants out in between stabbing a clone through the head with the dagger and dodging another clones sword.
“What Catra?” Adora grunts out, fighting off 3 clones at once, “I’m kind of in the middle of something…”
“Cover me?” Catra grins as she kicks away a clone.
“What? Why? Where are you…?” Before Adora can finish that sentence, Catra has pushed a couple of clones and start sprinting towards Prime, “Catra! Damn it!” She motions to Entrapta as the purple hair girl beams with absolute delight and pushes a button on her remote.
Emily the second starts firing at the clones whilst Catra makes her way towards Prime, who stands with his hands behind his back, looking smug. Catra gets to Prime and charges in with the dagger. Prime dodges it easily as are the other attempts from Catra to impale him. Prime hands a well timed punch to Catra’s chest, as Catra rolls out of range. Huffing and puffing from the entire exertion.
“You cannot defeat me little sister.” Prime states, “Now, be a good little soldier and take the serum.”
“No thanks.” Catra comes charging again as Prime takes his sword out again and slashes Catra’s right thigh just above the knee, “Fuck!”
“It doesn’t have to be so hard. No one has to suffer more than they need to.” Prime smug tone transfers to his face as he stabs Catra through the left shoulder. “This is not necessary. There will be no pain once you join me.”
Catra hisses at the slashes on her body, “I’ve never really had a pain kink to be honest, but without pain there’s no learning. Fuck.” Catra stops and thinks, “I’m sounding real philosophical right now, huh.”
“Enough!” Prime scowls, whilst swinging a few more times with his sword as a clone kicks the back of her knee forcing her down as Prime stabs Catra though the side, just below her ribs. “I didn’t want it to come to this little sister. But you’ve left me no choice.” He takes the syringe out and plunges it into Catra, injecting the serum into Catra.
Catra stumbles back and drops to the floor. “Finish it.” She dares.

“Gladly.” He tries to access her mind. It doesn’t work. He tries to get the connection back into her mind. It doesn’t work. “What…?” Before he can finish asking his question, Catra has run him through with the dagger and clawed his face, chest, arms and legs. Bring Prime down in a screaming heap as he swings wildly with his sword.
“Must suck. You can get into my mind anymore.” Catra taunts, “Call off your army or I will end you right now.” When he doesn’t comply, Catra slashes at the base of his face a few more times as green blood spurts out from Prime’s body. Some lands on Catra, “Eww! What the fuck?”
She continues to slash wildly until she’s eventually flung off by Prime in a violent outburst. Prime, hunched over and growling even louder, closes his eyes to order his clones to attack again. Only this time, nothing happens. “What did you do?!”
“Ha!” Catra shouts in victory, “I knew I’d get the right one eventually. Oh,” Catra hisses as her she can feel the serum being rejected by her body, “thanks for connecting me to your mind. Did you forget?”
Prime tries one more time, but it’s no use. “This is not over.” Prime beams himself out and his army all fall where they stand. The drones start falling out of the sky, much to the dismay of the troops below having to take cover from the overhead barrage.
The serum flowing through Catra’s burning starts to burns through her veins. She grunts, falling down onto her knees and then falling down into the foetal position, trying not to scream as the serum tries to find a way out of her body.
Entrapta rushes over to where Catra and pulls off the patch she had placed on her neck and rips it off. Instantly the green serum starts to flow out along with the blood that’s bumping around her body.
“You have to put pressure on her neck!” Adora tries to get back in only to be held back by Entrapta.
“Wait.” Entrapta says calmly. She turns to Adora, “You have to trust me.”
Adora submits and sits back on her heels, ready to jump in. She grabs Catra’s hand in hers, “You better not die! Or I’m going to kill you.”

There’s no response to Adora’s threat whilst Catra’s body rids the serum through the stab wound in her neck. After a few more seconds, Entrapta slaps the patch back over Catra’s neck and starts to access the rest of her wounds. She signals for Adora to come closer and help with some of the wounds. The worst one, the stab wound just under Catra’s ribs.
It’s going to be a long road to recovery, Catra thinks to herself before she blacks out.

Chapter End Notes

I'm still working on the next chapter...it's been a long slog.
I hope you're still enjoying this as much as I am writing it.

No Time to Rest

Chapter Summary

An old friend returns to help Catra.

Chapter Notes

New chapter! enjoy.

"How bad is she?" Adora asks with concern as she holds Catra's hand in hers, "She's going to be alright, right?"
Entrapta finishes repatching the stab wound on Catra's neck and looks up at Adora, "She's been wounded…excessively. That serum Prime injected into her pretty much burnt her insides. I can really only treat the wounds I can see, however the other ones…well… that's going to need time for me to figure out."
Adora squints down at the patch, "What is in this patch?"
"Oh, it's my new tech I brought with me." Entrapta beamed, "I'm still analysing the data on it. Its original purpose was a quick pressure stop for stab wounds and such. I was very surprised about the effect it had on the serum." Entrapta went back to her tablet, "Once I go through the data and conduct a few more tests, we may be able to use this patch to ensure Prime can't gain control of anyone or anything."
Catra groans from being prodded by Entrapta in the neck but remains on the hospital bed with her eyes closed. Once again she's more bandage than herself but at least she's alive. The bandages around her hand are soaked through with blood, Entrapta mentioned that was due to the excessive use of her claws against metal and not flesh. Catra groans a few more times in pain as she tries to curl up into herself. She finally relaxes when Adora runs her fingers through Catra's hair, gently petting the base of her ears.
Entrapta turns to face Adora pulling out the pocketknife that she'd used to stab Catra in the neck to snap her out of Prime's control, "Here. Think you better keep this. I'm sorry I stole it off you before."

Adora accepts it, “Thank you Entrapta.”
“Hopefully I won’t have to stab her again for doing something so stupid again.” Entrapta humours, “It’s really not a good feeling… But! At least my patch worked. Now I can work on that.” The sudden change in Entrapta’s mood is offsetting to Adora, “Oh, Adora?”
“Yes?”
“Take care of her.” Entrapta asks earnestly, “I don’t have many friends, so I don’t want to lose any.”
“I’ll do my best.” Adora replies with a soft smile trying to be reassuring.
“I’ll be back to see if I can figure out how to help her once I look over the results from her tests.” Entrapta comes back with, “Don’t let any medical staff near her unless she really needs it. Okay?”
Adora nods confused as to why Entrapta would ask this, “They might make it worse if they use modern magic or medicines to fix her.”
Entrapta walks out of the room, leaving Adora alone with Catra. Seeing as Catra was curled up in the bed, there was enough room for Adora to slip under the covers too. Catra wasn’t connected to any fancy machines or anything so there’d be no chance of snagging an IV line or something. Adora spooned up behind Catra and gently lay her arm over Catra’s side. Sensing the presence of Adora next to her, Catra snuggled back into her friend and lifted her head just enough so Adora could move her arm under Catra’s neck and pull her into a light embrace.
“You’re going to be alright Catra.” Adora whispered into Catra’s ear, “I’ve got you.”
Catra groaned again, trying to curl up again as Adora tried to hum comfortingly and ran her hand up and down Catra’s arm. It seemed to help, just like when she had run her fingers through her hair before.
As Adora was drifting off into sleep, she felt Catra’s ear flick in the direction of the door, which in turn flicked across her face. She turned her head to see who was coming in. Glimmer and Bow snuck through the small gap they had when they opened the door. Whispering Glimmer asks, “How is she?”
Catra groans again and mutters something along the lines of

‘Sparkles” as her ears flop back down against her head, relaxed. Adora startles when she feels another dip in the bed that’s not made by her friends. She yelps when the mysterious dip appears in front of her as Melog who has curled themselves against the front of Catra’s body, wildly purring away.
“Melog?” Adora looks to her friends.
Glimmer nods as Bow tries his hardest not to coo at the sight in front of them.
“They disappeared once Mermista and Sea Hawk had secured the waterways.” Glimmer provides, “I don’t know where they went off to, but they came back with a new friend.”
Adora, who is still on the bed, pressed flush against Catra’s back, “She’s doing okay. Entrapta had a look over her and we fixed up her wounds. She told me not to let any medical staff in here due to the residual serum flowing in her veins.” She looks over at Melog snuggled into Catra, their eyes closed as they provide comfort to her, “Who did Melog bring?”
“Not sure who she is, but she’s really weird.” Glimmer answers, “Spinneralla and Netossa seem to have met her before.”
Adora nods getting off the bed, “Where is she now?”
“She said something about picking berries to make a pie?” Bow turned to Glimmer to see if what he just said was right, when she nods, he continues, “She mentioned Catra needing some ointment and she brought it with her but needs to make some… adjustments.”
“Okay…” Adora replies a lot more uncertain about this person Melog has brought into their camp, “Do you think she’s a threat?”
“Not unless she gets you with her broom!” Glimmer laughs, “No, she seems pretty harmless. Netossa thinks she’s got it in for Catra though. Last time they saw her, the old woman was attacking your Joker with her broom.”
Adora think about the possibility of Catra being attacked by an old woman and she giggles into her hand, “That seems very unlikely. Catra can defend herself.”
Just as Adora finished her sentence the door flies open and said woman bursts through the door, “Mara dearie!”
Adora looks around, whispering to Bow, “Is she talking to me?”
“Razz has been waiting for you Mara!” Razz steps closer to Adora,

getting a good look at her, “You were supposed to help me collect the berries to bake the pie.”
“Uh, I’m not Mara. My name is Adora.” Adora tries to correct as Razz just pushes past her towards Catra, “Who are you?”
Razz ignores Adora’s question as she stands next to Catra and tsks, “Ah, Catra. I told you, you would make Adora sad if you got hurt.”
“How do you know Catra?” Adora asks, “And how do you know about me and Catra?”
“Uh, should she be touching Catra?” Bow asks with concern in his voice, “Didn’t you say Entrapta didn’t want any medical staff touching Catra?”
“She definitely doesn’t look like medical staff to me, Bow.” Glimmer points out, “And Melog seems to be okay with her.”
Entrapta pops back in, “Ah! Razz! There you are!”
“Do I know you?” Razz asks confused.
Entrapta doesn’t get put off by the Razz’s nonrecognition and just powers on, “Very interesting. She does not remember me.”
Entrapta starts typing on her tablet again as she hovers around Razz, “Melog is quite comfortable with this woman, must be due to telekinetic connection with Catra.”
“Ah little one. What have you gone and done to yourself?” Razz asks a very not awake Catra as Melog moves off the bed as Razz assesses Catra herself. She turns to Entrapta, “You’ve done well.”
“Thank you!” Entrapta beams before going back to her tablet.
Razz pulls out the tub or what looks like cream, “Alright, all of you out. Razz needs to look after the little one.”
“What?” Glimmer almost screeches, “We aren’t going anywhere.”
Razz smiles a genuine smile that conveys to the others to trust her. They stop their mutterings and move towards the door, “Oh, Adora. You stay.”
Adora turns around and heads back to the bed as the door shuts with a click. “What can I do?”
Razz takes Adora’s hand in hers, “Just be there for her.”
Razz takes off the patch on Catra’s neck and applies the ointment. Adora remembers Catra saying something about a stinky ointment but this is absolutely foul. Catra starts twitching and groaning in pain when the ointment is applied, Razz nods at Adora. “It’s

alright Catra. I've got you."
Catra's twitching continues but the groan fades as Adora squeezes Catra's hand. Razz puts the patch on the table next to Catra's bed and waits. She looks at Adora, "Don't worry Adora. Little one here is strong. She'll make it. She's too stubborn not to."
Adora chuckles wetly at Razz's words, "She just scares me."
"Me too." Razz admits, "But she wants to prove herself to the world. To you."
"I can't be without her." Adora confesses, "She's my world."
Razz nods as Catra hisses in pain, curling and uncurling her body as she holds on tight to Adora's hand, grounding herself from the pain in her body. "She'll be ok." Razz reassures.
Adora isn't sure what to think. Melog just stares at Catra with concern while she moves around, contorting her body to try to minimalise the pain, which doesn't seem to work. Catra twitches violently as her eyes open suddenly and a silent scream erupts from her body as the rest of the green serum leaks out of her neck, dripping down her shirt. Adora moves to hug her from behind, ensuring her face is on the opposite side of the stab wound.
"Fuck!" Catra grunts out eventually when the pain subsides enough for her to form words. She looks around, confused as her eyes refocussing from the searing pain burning her insides, "Adora?"
Adora hugs her tighter, "I'm here."
Catra's chest rumbles with a purr as she leans back into Adora. Then she sees two other familiar figures in the room, "Melog? Razz? What are you guys doing here?"
Melog runs and pounces on Catra and knocks her and Adora back on the bed. The alien cat is purring up a storm in relief as Catra pets behind their ears. Adora coos seeing Catra interact with the big cat. "How do you and Melog…?
"Oh, yeah." Catra thinks back, "Me and Entrapta found them on one of our explorations on one of the planets during our 'off time." Catra looks at Melog in the eyes fondly, "They are the last of their kind after Prime invaded their planet."
"How did they survive?" Adora asks.
"Magic." Catra answers plainly. "I don't understand it." Looking

away from Melog, Catra spots Razz with her broom in her hands ready to strike, "Hey, Razz."
"I should beat you with this broom little one, for making an old woman worry about you!" Razz scolds.
"But I'm hurt…" Catra whines, "What are you doing here?"
Razz holds up the ointment bottle and grins, "Melog brought me here because you tried to get yourself killed!"
"Sorry Razz." Catra apologises sincerely, "I wasn't trying to get myself killed Razz! Promise."
Adora huffs behind her, "But yet you still seem to be in that situation."
"Don't you guys gang up on me." Catra threatens, "I'm hurt. Everything hurts." Catra pouts.
Adora flicks Catra's ear, much to the delight of Razz who laughs as Catra swears even louder, "That's what you get for scaring me. Again!"
"What is this? Gang up on the Joker day?" Catra whines and continues to pout.
"Don't you get it?" Adora moves around so she's face to face with Catra, "We all love you. I love you. I don't want you to get hurt or die. Fuck the stupid oath!"
Catra's eyes widen at Adora's view on the oath she'd sworn her life on, "You of all people should not be angry with the oath. We all pledge our lives to you and your family not because we have to. It's because we want to." Catra takes Adora's hand, "I have to protect you. I have to protect your family. I want to be worthy for you."
Adora stops Catra and then just laughs. Catra looks at her with confusion. It's at this point that Glimmer, Bow and Entrapta push themselves back in. Glimmer's about to mouth off something when she sees Catra sitting up and awake, "Welcome back, Joke-ass."
"Thank Sparkles." Catra replies with a smirk, "I didn't, hurt anyone did I?"
Entrapta rushes in and wraps Catra up in another unexpected hug, "Razz fixed you! I have so many tests…"
"Give me some time to breathe first Traps before you start prodding me again." Catra laughs off as she returns Entrapta's

hug, “Thank you. For stabbing me.”
“You’re welcome!” Entrapta beams as she pulls away from the hug and starts inspecting the green goo on Catra’s shirt, taking a sample with her before running out of the room yelling, “Get out of my way. I have to test this!”
Catra chuckles as she faces everyone in the room. “So, Prime got away.” Catra says, “Did you guys find Shadow Weaver?”
“No. Bow and I searched everywhere for her.” Glimmer recounts, “She didn’t even make an appearance in the battle.”
“When Prime took over my consciousness, I had a glimpse through the eyes of pretty much everyone that was infected. Including Shadow Weaver.” Catra closes her eyes trying to remember more, “I didn’t get a long enough look, but it looked like she was walking into the battle and she saw me with Adora and then that was it. I was hoping maybe you guys would have seen where she went.”
“Wherever she went, she did it without being seen.” Bow said, “I mean we were all kind of preoccupied with fighting the clones and there were a bunch of drones Glimmer was teleporting out of the sky…”
Catra sighed, “Great. So we still have to deal with Prime and Shadow Weaver.”
“Is she still infected?” Adora asks, “Will she be a threat?”
Catra snorts, “When is she not a threat?”
“Be careful little one.” Razz warns, “I’ve already told you she was dangerous. You would do well to avoid her.”
“Someone has to stop her.” Catra replies to Razz, “She’s evil.”
“We’ll get her. I promise.” Adora puts her hand on her shoulder, “We’ll all be on the lookout for her.”
“We need Entrapta to get more patches made up.” Catra says with urgency, “Or something that doesn’t involve stabbing infected people with a knife.”
Catra tentatively touches the wound on her neck, only to find that Razz’s ointment has worked wonders again and the wound has closed up and no longer bleeding. Catra grins and turns to the old woman, “Razz, your ointment fucking burns and stinks but it’s also really fucking awesome.”
The gets a whack on the head by Razz, “That’s for making me

worry about you!”
“So…not for swearing?” Catra teases only to get another whack,
“Okay, okay!” Catra puts her hands up in surrender as everyone else in the room giggles and laughs at the situation, “Thanks Razz.” Melog makes an annoyed noise for being ignored, “Sorry buddy. I know I scared you too. Thanks for bringing Razz.”
Melog trills at the praise and then decides they’ve had enough of it and walks out of the room to find Entrapta. Razz pats Catra on the head, “Okay little one. Razz needs to get back.” She moves around to Adora and squints at the blonde, “Look after the little one. She’s stubborn but loyal.”
Adora nods, “I will.”
And with that, Razz departs to wherever it is she goes to.
Bow and Glimmer wave her goodbye. Bow nudges Glimmer, “That was so weird, right?”
Glimmer agrees, “Yes, Bow. But she also fixed Catra up. So weird is good.”
Catra winces as her other wounds have not been healed as Razz only applied the ointment to Catra’s neck, “Fuck. I feel like I’ve been stabbed, shot and burned from the inside out.”
Adora deadpans back to Catra, “That’s because you have.”
“Oh, right.” Catra realises, “My shoulder feels fucked too.”
“Yeah, it was dislocated before Prime infected you and it did this weird thing where it popped itself back in.” Bow explained, “We watched it on the video recording her sent out when you were captured.”
Catra grimaces, feeling stupid for getting caught and then being infected to do the bidding of the enemy. Her next reaction is just to groan and lie back into the bed, “I don’t even remember most of that.”
Adora joins Catra on the bed, wrapping her up in her arms, “It’s okay Catra. We got you back.”
“Yeah.” Catra sighs, “He’ll be back. I know he will.”
“And we’ll stop him.” Adora softly says into Catra’s ear, “You got him pretty good so he’s probably somewhere licking his wounds.”
As she finishes that sentence she looks Catra dead in the eye, “You better not lick any of your wounds. If I catch you, I swear you will wish the ointment Razz brought was the worst thing you

ever felt.”
“Woah, what the hell Adora?” Catra hisses, “I’m not going to literally lick my wounds. Probably not.”
Adora eyes her, “Don’t you dare.”
Catra huffs, “Fine!” Instead Catra pulls Adora into her for a kiss and licking into her mouth, “Better?”
Adora blushes but still manages to say, “Better.”
Catra wants to tell Adora more about what she wants to lick when Bow clears his throat, “Catra, do you know where Prime is or when or where you think he’ll be next?”
Catra narrows her eyes, “Look, I don’t know where he went. But I know what he’s after.”
Catra turns her head and looks at Adora, the blonde furrows her brow in confusion, “What? Why is everyone looking at me?”
Licking her lips, Catra just says, “I think we’ve found our bait.”

Prime Time

Chapter Summary

Adora is used as bait to draw out Prime while they also look for Shadow Weaver.

Chapter Notes

Still working on the next chapter.
So enjoy this one for now.

"We are not using my daughter as bait!" King Randor states sternly at the idea of luring Prime out using Adora, "There has to be another way. I am not putting my family in danger again."
"My King," Catra steps up, she doesn't usually speak in these types of meetings but she can't stay quiet this time, "I don't want to put Princess Adora in danger anymore than you do." She sends a soft glance Adora's way as she speaks, "But, this is the only way. This could be the only chance we get to beat him."
King Randor sighs, looking to his wife for support. They share the same concerned look, "Adora? This is your decision. You know how your mother and I feel about this."
Adora takes a steadying breath in before answering, "I want to do this."
Catra steps up again, "I promise, nothing will happen to her." She turns to Adora once again and walks over, standing in front of her. She kneels bowing her head towards her princess, "I swear on my life to protect you."
Adora flicks Catra on the ear in annoyance and huffs, much to the meetings surprise, "I told you, stop trying to get yourself killed."
Catra doesn't move from her spot despite the ear flick, bowed down in front of Adora. She flicks her ear and just grins widely, "I'm sorry Princess Adora." Her tone is teasing despite how serious and dangerous her oath could mean, "My oath still stands. As does my mark."
Adora scoffs as she stares at the new leather band covering Catra's mark, she really wants to scream and dismiss the oath but

that would dishearten all the other soldiers that have taken the same oaths. Instead she crosses her arms and tries not to pout. All of which makes Catra love Adora more. "You're insufferable, you know that?" Adora huffs instead, "You are sticking by my side the whole time so I can keep an eye on you. Understand?"
Catra gives Adora a toothy grin, nodding in understanding before rising up and returning to her seat.
King Randor asks again, "Are you sure this is what you want to do Adora?"
"Yes, father. It is." Adora answers with a lot more confidence, "But I will not be alone. I will have Catra by my side."
The King nods in acceptance, "So be it." There's some murmuring from the other members of this meeting but they all quieten when the King clears his throat, "Tell me, Jester. Do you know when Prime will attack next? We will need to up Adora's protection, even with you by her side."
"Prime is still injured." Catra replies, "I can't tell you exactly when or where, I only know what he is after. And unfortunately or fortunately, it's Princess Adora and the Sword of Power."
"So, what do you suggest? We can't keep security detail on Adora every hour of every day for some unforeseen period of time." The Queen brings up, "We still have many injured to tend to."
"My Queen, I can stay with Adora." Catra speaks up, "If that is alright with you."
Another guard chimes in, "Me too, my Queen. I can watch over the Princess."
This earns a low growl from Catra. Adora hears it and puts her hand up to stop the number of guards volunteering to guard her, "Thank you all. I think the Jester and I will be fine. If the rest of you want to keep watch around the public spaces that would be well appreciated."
The other guards nod. Catra raises an eyebrow at Adora who just waves Catra's questioning look away, "Then it is settled." The King announces, "Next item on the agenda. Shadow Weaver."
Another low growl erupts from Catra upon hearing that name.
"We are yet to find her King Randor." Queen Angella reports, "We have sent many troops to scout around your castle, the woods and even around the outskirts of nearby towns and villages. She

has been extremely elusive."
"Did you check the castle?" Catra suggests. Everyone turns to look at her like she's undermined their capabilities, "I only ask because that snake has more hiding spots than a mole." Another round of snarky looks and unhappy faces, "I saw her come out from a secret room down to the moat when I was on the run, okay? So, there's a good chance she's still in this castle somewhere."
"What is with you and secret rooms, Jester?" King Randor asks, "If I recall correctly, you were also hiding Princess Entrapta's secret lab in my castle."
"That's true, majesty." Catra simply replies, "But I don't know all the secret rooms in the castle. I can ask Entrapta to do a search of secret entrances and rooms that we don't know of."
"Go. Do it." Catra gets up at the King's order, bows and turns towards the door, "Ahem! Forget something?"
The smug smile on the King's face is humiliating as Catra makes her way back and offers her hand to Adora, "Come on Princess Adora. I'm supposed to be your bodyguard or whatever as well now."
Adora takes Catra's hand, a blush on her face as she does this in front of everyone in the meeting and they head down to Entrapta.

They find Entrapta in the castle, in her secret lab that Catra has been keeping under wraps for the best part of three years. Melog is lounging about, napping on a makeshift bed in the corner and purring away as they listen to Entrapta work. They open their eyes briefly upon hearing Catra and Adora enter the lab, but pay them no attention as they go back to their nap. Catra lets go of Adora's hand and makes her way next to Melog and snuggles up into them on their bed, mimicking the way Melog did it when Catra was in the hospital bed. The both of them purr up a storm as Adora tries to pry her eyes away from the two cats in the corner.
Entrapta takes no notice whatsoever. She does however notice Adora in her lab, "Adora! What brings you here?"
Shaking herself out of staring at Catra and Melog and smiles at Entrapta, "Do you think you can help us find Shadow Weaver?"
"Why are we trying to find Shadow Weaver?" Entrapta asks as she

goes back to tinkering on the robot in her hands, “I thought we were going to find prime using you as bait.”
Entrapta’s bluntness makes Catra chuckle where she’s snuggled up next to Melog as Adora glares at her. “We can do both, Entrapta.” Adora replies, “Besides, we don’t know when Prime will strike. So the closer to the castle I stay, means there’s more guards around to fight him.”
“I thought Catra was guarding you?” Entrapta scratched her head.
“I totally am doing that.” Catra calls from the bed, “I’ve got one eye open. My good eye!”
“Catra!” Adora yells, “Get over here!”
Catra gets up and walks over to Adora, “Yes Princess?”
“Quit goofing off. I’m already on edge as it is.” Adora huffs, arms crossed across her chest. “And you’re not helping.”
Catra looks down at her feet, “Sorry Adora.” She keeps her eyes focussed on her feet longer, “I’m just trying to not to think about Prime right now. I’m already not sleeping…”
Adora uncrosses her arms and pulls Catra into her for a tight hug, “Catra…”
“It’s fine.” Catra mutters into Adora’s shoulder. She tries to pull back but Adora holds her into place, “I can’t protect you if I can’t see Adora.”
“Just a few more minutes.” Adora whispers feeling guilty for lashing out, “Please…”
“Okay.” Catra relaxes a little more into Adora’s arms. “Just don’t touch anything in this lab…”
Adora giggles at Catra’s mutterings. Entrapta stands idly by just watching the two embrace when Catra flicks her ear towards Entrapta, “Give us a moment will you Traps?”
“Sure!” Entrapta beams as she goes back to her robot back at her table.
Adora finally releases Catra from her hold. Her face is still sullen with guilt. “Fuck it.” Catra pulls Adora in for a kiss to take her mind off everything. She didn’t expect her princess to want to deepen it. “Mm?”
“Sorry.” Adora whispers breathlessly into Catra’s lips, “I, I don’t know what came over me.”
Catra smiles as squeezes Adora’s waist, “When this is all over,” she

looks over to see whether Entrapta is listening or even paying attention, when she deems it that Entrapta is indeed in her own little world, Catra whispers suggestively into Adora's ear, "I'm going to ruin you."
Adora shivers, clenching her thighs together, "That better not be a joke."
Catra grins, her fangs poking out, "I've never been more serious to taste you."
Adora blushes at the thought. "I don't think we'll get to do any of that until you marry me."
A look of shock appears on Catra's face, "Think your father will be okay with that?"
"I know he will." Adora smiles into another kiss.
"Eh, I guess we'll see about it." Catra dismisses the thought, "He was pretty pissed when he found out I took your first kiss."
"You didn't take it!" Adora protests, "I kissed you, remember?"
"Yeah I remember." Catra smirks at the thought, "Then again if I tried to kiss you first and I got caught, pretty sure I'd be back in prison again. Or worse. Your father and mother could make me watch you flirt and marry someone else."
"That bad huh?" Adora replies.
"Bad? You have no idea how jealous I got watching you get flirted with by all those suitors.." Catra growls a little, "and I don't think I can handle another one of those balls your father is going to throw once this war is over. Or even set you up on blind dates because you haven't picked any of those suitors."
Adora outright laughs at Catra's ramblings, much to the displeasure of Catra, "You are my Joker. I'm your Princess. That's all I need." As she pulls away from Catra she looks over her shoulder, "The proposal better be epic."
Catra grins widely as she rushes to catch up to Adora. "Hey Traps!"
"Yes?"
"Reckon you've got something that will help us find hidden rooms in this castle?" Catra asks bluntly, "I know you've got something in there. You've been through all the vents around the castle right? Got a map or something?"
"A map?" Entrapta pretends to think before breaking off into a

maniacal laughing fit before turning back to her normal self, “Why, yes of course I do.” Entrapta picks up one of her tracker pads and hands it to Catra, “Map of the whole castle is in there. I’m surprised that you still climb up the castle walls into Adora’s bedroom instead of the secret passageway to the vacant room next to hers.”
“I like the climb.” Catra simply says, brushing off anything else Entrapta has mentioned, “Besides, I told you to stop spying on me when.”
“Does everyone know Catra’s been sneaking into my room?” Adora asks the room sounding a little frazzled.
Entrapta hums before responding, “I don’t know about everyone… but you two seen to be very close. Closer now even.”
Catra just snickers as Adora’s face goes red, “Don’t you dare say you told me so.” Adora points to Catra, “Lets just find this damn secret room.”
“Thanks Traps.” Catra yells as back as she chases after Adora. “Adora! Wait up!”
Catra catches up to Adora waving the tracker pad in her hand. Adora turns to Catra, “Do you think everyone thought that we were… sleeping together?”
“If by sleeping together, you mean sharing a bed? Then I bloody hope so.” Catra answers, “If they think that we were fucking, well, if you want, I can go and beat up all those gossipers, but I doubt that’ll reflect well on our situation.” Catra smirks at the last bit of her statement, “Or we can beat them up together.”
Adora snorts and nudges at Catra’s shoulders, “I’d love to do that.” She steals a kiss from Catra’s lips first before continuing, “But, my parents would probably get you thrown into prison again for fighting.”
“Would be totally worth it though.” Catra laughs, “Now, let’s find all these secret rooms that Entrapta has found in your castle.”
Catra pushes a few buttons on the tracker pad and it loads up with a few beeps and a map showing where they are now. Adora looks around and back to the map a few times before questioning, “Where are we? Entrapta’s lab is not on here.”
“Well, of course it wouldn’t be.” Catra said amused, “Why would she put the location of her secret lab on a tracker pad that could

probably be hacked?”
“Good point.”
“Come on, if we start moving hopefully something will pop up on the tracker.” Catra starts walking away from the secret lab, looking between the surroundings and the screen. Adora followed behind her, smiling as she watched her Joker take charge. She was snapped out of it by Catra’s voice, “Adora?”
“Hm?”
“Are you even listening?” Catra tilted her head to the side at her unanswered questions.
“Yeah. Actually no. Sorry.” Adora answered honestly, a blush growing on her cheeks.
“What were you doing?” A smirk on Catra’s lips.
“Nothing…”
“Sure. Whatever you say Princess.” Catra rolls her eyes, “Anyways, I said there’s a whole bunch of rooms or somethings in this direction.” Catra points to the right side where the walls have collapsed from the invasion. “But we’ll need to clear some of these rocks and bits of body parts out of the way.”
Adora scrunched up her nose at the body parts comment which made Catra giggle, “Shut up! I’m happy to move rocks but body parts…”
“You’ll leave to me?” Catra asks smugly, “It’s fine. I can get my hands dirty for my princess I guess.”
They start moving some of the debris in their way. The wall on the right that’s collapsed in, shows a pretty good view to the outside environment. The wind blows through the big gaping holes in the walls causing dust to fly around, making it hard to see and sometimes breathe. Adora coughs on the dust particles littering the air as they move stones from their path, instinctively Catra moves Adora behind her. She rips off the bottom of her shirt and hands it to Adora who loos at her questioning.
“Use it. Cover your mouth and nose so you can breathe dummy.” Catra explains without turning back. Adora takes it and covers her mouth and nose, “Stay close.” Catra’s ears twitch the further they travel.
Adora nods as she makes her way closer behind Catra, holding onto Catra’s belt to stay close. “What do you hear?”

“I don’t know.” Catra answers, ears still twitching moving erratically on top of her head on high alert, her fur bristles under her clothes, “Everything here feels…wrong.”
Catra picks up and moves a few more rocks blocking their way, pushing away a few body parts with her foot when she comes across something gleaming in the sunlight. She stops as Adora bumps into her with the suddenness.
“What is it?” Adora whispers.
Catra doesn’t answer, instead she bends down to move the debris around the object all the while Adora hovers over her shoulder. Catra picks up the item, standing upright and inspecting it in the light. “This is the vial Prime gave to Shadow Weaver to inject the serum into herself to prove her loyalty to him.” She sniffs it, “Smells pretty fresh.”
“Fresh? As in…?”
“No.” Catra cuts Adora off promptly, “Fresh as in she’s used this before she escaped. So there’s a good chance he still has one contact point here.”
“That’s not good. She could be anywhere.” Adora looks to Catra who is still staring at the vial in her hand, “Catra?”
Catra snaps out of the visions in that swirled around her head at the sight of the vial, “Yeah, uh sorry.”
“What did you see?”
Shaking her head of the thoughts, Catra rubs her temples, “She’s not here, Adora.” Catra runs her hand through her short hair, “I got a glimpse, but it was dark. Cold. Far.”
“Do you think she’s with him?” Adora asked wrapping her arms around Catra, “Wherever he is.”
Catra shakes her head again, “No. She doesn’t have that capability. And Prime needs someone down here. He needs eyes on the ground.” Catra squeezes her eyes shut, “I still feel the serum burning through my veins and it feels like he might be in my head sometimes.”
“I can’t even begin to imagine what it was like for you Catra.” Adora pulls Catra in tighter, “We will get him. I promise.”
“I know.” Catra sighs, “We need to get back.” Catra looks around feeling uneasy, “We’re too far from help.”
Adora nods and lets Catra go. Catra’s eyes dart around the

corridor, “We’re being watched…” Catra grabs Adora’s hand roughly and then leads her running back towards Entrapta’s lab. They get back to the lab and Catra slams the door shut behind them, locking it. The whole thing startles Entrapta and Melog who look up in confusion.
“Catra! Adora! What are you doing back here so soon?” Entrapta excitedly asks, “Have you found what you were looking for?”
“No Traps.” Catra answers, “We found this though.” Catra hands the vial over to the scientist, “We think Shadow Weaver is Prime’s contact on the ground. She’s not here.”
“Entrapta. We need to get back to the others.” Adora says urgently, “Catra doesn’t think we’ll be safe here.”
Entrapta thinks for a moment before replying a very enthusiastically “Okay!” as she quickly bags a few items and calls for Melog. “Where are we going?”
“Back to join the rest of the troops.” Catra gestures to the door, “We need to go now.”
“What’s the rush?” Entrapta slings her bag over her shoulder and pushes a few buttons on her own tracker pad, “Emily! Come along!”
Melog stands next to Adora, she pets him on the head as he purrs calming her down from Catra’s stressing, “Are we ready?”
Without waiting for an answer, Catra flings the doors open and motions for the rest to follow her. Her fur is still bristling and her tail weaves through the air nervously. She turns and motions for everyone to stay low and stay quiet whilst she leads them back to the safety of Bright Moon through the woods.

They get back to Bright Moon and meet up with Adora’s father and a few guards. The rest of the allies have scattered back to their own kingdoms in case Prime decides to veer off what Catra thinks he will do and invade them instead to recruit more ground forces. Queen Angella has offered for King Randor and his people to stay in Bright Moon until their kingdom can be rebuilt. But that will have to wait until Prime has been taken care of.
“Ah, Adora. Princess Entrapta.” King Randor greets, “Jester.”
“My King.” Catra drops to one knee, dropping her head. “Prime is still using Shadow Weaver through the serum. She’s been

injecting."
"I take it you didn't find her then?" The King sounds a disappointed.
"No Sir." Catra answers curtly, "She's not at the castle anymore."
"Why have you come back then?"
"Father. We think Prime is coming soon." Adora interrupts as she taps Catra on the shoulder to rise.
"Hm. Yes. I believe Catra is connected to Prime even with the serum out of her body." Entrapta says whilst tapping on her tablet, Emily whirls next to her and Entrapta pats the robot on the side, "Emily agrees with me."
"Jester, is this true." The King asks firmly.
Catra shakes her head, Prime's trying to get back into her mind.
"…yes."
"Anything you would like to share?" King Randor continues to probe, "Tell us now."
"My King… Argh!" Catra groans holding her head. Adora rushes next to Catra, rubbing her arms up and down trying to calm her. Her body starts trembling and shaking violently. Catra's eyes roll up into her head. She lets out a low growl before everything stops. She finds herself on her back on the ground. Her head in Adora's back. Once she's regained her ability to speak, "Adora. Run. Now!"
"What?"
"He's coming!" Catra shouts as she scrambles up on to her feet, pulling Adora up with her, "You need to get somewhere safe!"
"Catra! There is nowhere safe." Adroa yells back.
Catra pulls out her sword, "Get your sword Adora." She turns to the room, "Get your swords! All of you!" She moves to face the King as Prime beams in at the doorway with a wicked grin on his face.
Catra shouts, "Protect the Princess! Remember your oaths!" and yells to Entrapta, "Get to Queen Angella and let her know Prime is here!"
Entrapta nods as she mounts Emily and heads out the back door of the room.
Prime doesn't move.
"Attack!" The King orders as the few guards in the room and Catra

charge towards Prime.
Prime's has his sword out, easily defending the attack from all sides. One by one the guards are stuck down until it's just Catra facing off with Prime.
"Come back for more?" Catra goads Prime, "Go on then. Strike me down. If you can." Catra bares her fangs and grips her sword just a little tighter.
"Tell me little sister." Prime starts.
"I am not your sister." Catra grits out.
Ignoring Catra he continues, "Is she worth fighting for? Are they worth giving up your life for?"
King Randor pushes Adora behind him, shielding her as he tries to back her out from the room, Prime sees the movement behind them, "See. Look for yourself." Catra looks up a moment to see the King and Adora backing out of the room, "They would abandon you without a second thought."
Catra stays silent, hoping that Prime's little speech will let Adora escape. She simple growls back at Prime as they stand off against one another with their swords at the ready.
"Would they do the same for you?" Prime's grin growing wider at the realisation he has hit a nerve, "Would they call you family if they knew the real you?"
Catra's smirks at Prime's ego, "They already know what I've done."
"Yes. They only know what you've told them. But I know your deepest, darkest secrets." His eyes darken, "After all, I've been in your head."
"And I've been in yours." Catra spits back.
Prime laughs, "And what have you discovered? Will you be able to defeat me with that knowledge?"
"Here's the thing," Catra sidesteps Prime's lunge at her, "I know my fate." Another lunge, another dodge, "But I also know," Prime slashes this time, Catra jumps back narrowly avoids the blade, "that you will be dying not by my sword," Prime knocks the sword out of Catra's hand and grins.
"You are right about that." Prime sneers.
"No." Catra shakes her head, extending her claws, "You will die," Prime lunges at her again as Catra dodges the 3 strikes, "by my

claws.” Catra pounces onto Prime and slashes his face with her claws. Prime screams in pain from the claw marks as he throws Catra against a wall, shrieking back as he covers his face where Catra had clawed.
“That is enough, little sister!” Rage taking over his voice, “You will not be the one to end me!”
“No. But I am!” King Randor runs him through from behind, the king’s sword protruding through Primes chest. “I am ending this now!”
Catra chuckles from where she lies on the ground, she has definitely broken something but she can’t help but laugh at Prime’s demise. “How does it feel, Prime? To be bested by the Jester of all things?”
Prime is still shocked, no words coming as blood spills out of his lips. The King rips the sword back out of Primes body as their foe drops to his knees, clutching his chest before dropping to the floor, gurgling and struggling to breathe.
King Randor walks over to Catra, “Are you alright Jester?”
“Yes sir.” Catra answers trying not to hiss in pain, “I’m pretty sure there’s something in me that’s been rebroken.”
The King holds his hand out for Catra, “Come on. Get off the floor.”
Catra takes his hand and she gets on her feet, needing the King’s help to stay upright, “Where’s the Princess?”
“She’s with Princess Glimmer.” The King answered, “She’s fine.”
Just as Catra was about to relax she pushed the King hard to the right as Prime charges at the with his sword, running the blade through Catra, pinning her to the wall behind. She screams in pain and with her claws lashes out as she slashes open his throat. Prime’s green blood spurts up across Catra and the wall as he clutches at his throat.
“No!” King Randor screams as he decapitates Prime. Prime’s head rolling away from his body along with the tips of a few fingers as his body slumps down to the ground. The King runs to Catra, “No. No no no! Catra.” He cups Catra’s face in his hands as she starts to lose consciousness. “What do I do? What do I do?”
“Get help…” Catra breathes out, “Don’t tell Adora I got hurt again.”

A small smile on Catra's lips. The King tries to smile back. He puts his hand on Catra's shoulder, "I'll, I'll be right back Catra."
Catra chuckles despite the pain, "Okay. I'll just hang here."
The King chuckles himself at Catra's antics despite the situation. He nods to her before disappearing out the door. Catra can hear him yelling out for help. Catra's ears picks up distress that's not related to the King's asking for help. She hears the words Adora and Shadow Weaver. And then everything goes black.

Friendly Distraction

Chapter Summary

Entrapta and Melog to the rescue!

Chapter Notes

New chapter for those following my updates!
And for those just coming around to check this out.
Enjoy and thanks for reading.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra wakes up to a warm tongue licking her face. There's a purr that comes with that tongue.
"Took you long enough to get here." Catra quips. Melog growls at her, "Yeah, yeah, I know. Get this fucking sword out of me."
Melog pulls the sword out as Catra holds in the scream trying to get out from the pain.
"Thanks bud." Catra covers the stab wound with her hands, trying to put pressure on the wound, "Where is she?"
Melog looks down, he looks sad.
"Don't worry bud. We'll get our princess back." Catra pets Melog trying to reassure them, "Even if it kills me." She takes the patches from her pant pockets and applies one to the stab wound on her chest, Melog helps in getting the patch on her back over her clothes. "Just hope I don't bleed to death first." Catra laughs to herself.
Catra pulls herself on Melog's back as Melog grabs Prime's body in their mouth, "Do your thing bud."
With that Melog turns both them and Catra invisible as they head back to the Entrapta's secret lab in the castle.

The King returns with help for Catra only to find the room empty of both Prime and Catra's bodies. The only things left in the room apart from his slain guards that Prime had slaughtered and the green and red blood mixed together covering the walls, the floors

and part of the ceiling.
Queen Angella stops behind the King, “Where is she?”
“How can this happen? I wasn’t even gone that long?” King Randor stands with his hands on his hips, “I don’t understand.”
The medical staff that he had brought with him tend to the fallen guards as the pair search the room to see if Catra or Prime is somewhere in there. A few more of Queen Angella’s guards come through with large bags for the bodies of the slain and they start moving the corpses out.
“Where is Catra?” King Randor says more to himself than anyone in the room, “And where is Prime’s body?”
“I don’t know, Randor.” Queen Angella replies, “Who could have taken two bodies that quickly and unnoticed? It doesn’t make any sense.”
The pair stand together in silence. Just staring at all the blood and entrails that still stain the room with the same questions swirling around their heads. Eventually that silence is broken.
“What happened to my daughter? She was supposed to be safe here as long as we took out Prime.” King Randor scowls, “How could she have been kidnapped by Shadow Weaver?”
Queen Angella took a step back from the fiery king trying to remain calm despite the circumstances, “She has my daughter too.”
“How could this have happened?” The King sat down on one of the chairs in the room, “I’ve lost my daughter and my Jester.” He sighs, “Adora’s going to kill me when she finds out I lost Catra.”
“We will get them back.” Queen Angella voice cracks a little, she’s worried for her own daughter.
“I’m sorry, Angella.” King Randor says, the fire in his belly dying down, “What happened?”
Queen Angella sat down across from Randor and sighed, “Adora and Glimmer were escorted back to Glimmer’s room by the Bright Moon guards. Shadow Weaver got to them. No one saw it coming. She is powerful. More so than when she was harnessing the power Prime had provided her.”
“Where did she take them? Why did they take them?”
“She left a note.” Queen Angella handed Randor the note, “She wants our kingdoms for our daughters. And she wants the whole

ceremonial proceedings too."
"That's crazy!" King Randor exclaimed, "She wants to legally take over both our kingdoms while holding our daughter's hostage?"
Angella nods, as he reads the note, "How are we supposed to reply to her if we don't know where she is?"
"I don't know. I've got my best people looking into it." She answered.
Bow popped his head in, "Queen Angella?"
"Come in Bow."
"I think I know where Shadow Weaver went." Bow provides, "And it's not where you think it is."

Catra and Melog arrive back at the castle and at Entrapta's lab thanks to Melog's invisibility cloaking abilities they are able to get in without being noticed. The door to the lab opens and shuts silently as Melog pads into the lab with Catra on their back. Entrapta immediately turns to face the door when Catra drops Prime's body on the floor of the lab. Prime's head rolls around the floor a bit. Melog makes themselves be seen again and Entrapta's face drops almost immediately.
"Catra!" She runs over, hopping over Prime's body and helps Catra off the hybrid, Catra is barely conscious, her eyes having trouble staying open, "Fuck!"
Catra cackles, "Fuck indeed…" Catra groans, "I, I don't think," a hiss, "I've heard…you…swear before."
Entrapta rolls Catra onto her stomach and takes off the patch, lifting up her shift and applying a new patch to the wound. "Turn over." Entrapta instructs now that the back is patched up, "I'll need to fix the front."
Reluctantly Catra rolls onto her back, grunting and hissing the whole way over, "How bad is it?"
"I kind of wish everyone would stop asking me that question when it comes to you." Entrapta replies with an annoyed tone, "Adora's right."
"Yeah, she always is." Catra sighs as Enrapta grabs some bandages off the table, "We have to get her back. This plan has to work."
Entrapta puts a calming hand on Catra's shoulder, "It'll work.

Because it’s your plan.”
“She wasn’t supposed to get kidnapped though.” Catra huffs and then hisses again when Entrapta takes the patch off the stab wound on her chest, “I should have known Shadow Weaver would strike when Prime was fighting me.”
“You couldn’t have known that Catra.” Entrapta states in a matter-of-fact tone, “But we will stick with the original plan. Shadow Weaver won’t hurt Adora.”
“I guess not.” Catra sighs rubbing her eyes, “Is the tracker working?”
“Yes. Shadow Weaver is exactly where you said she’d be.” Entrapta tells her whilst pushing down on the new patch, “It’s too bad Razz isn’t here. I could really use some of that ointment she has. I tried analysing it, but there’s something strange about it in my tests.”
“I doubt she’ll give you the ingredients Traps.” Catra grits out, “Just patch me up already and let's get Adora back.”
“Slight change of plans…”
“What? Ow!” Catra grunts as Entrapta poke Catra in one of her broken ribs.
“Shadow Weaver has taken Princess Glimmer as well.” Entrapta keeps prodding Catra earning more hisses and growls, “She was caught in the crossfire.”
Once Entrapta has finished poking, prodding and fixing up Catra, Catra sits up, pulling down her shirt. “Sparkles doesn’t deserve this. None of them do. I should have put her down when she was locked up. Would have been real easy too. Could have snuck up on the old witch and clawed her eyes out and slashed her throat.”
“Catra, stop. Also move your arms so I can wrap this around your chest.” Entrapta sternly says while unrolling the bandage, “Focus on what we can for now. It won’t help Adora or Glimmer dwelling in the past.”
“I know.” Catra breathes out, “Am I good to go now?”
“As good as you’ll be.” Entrapta says with a bit of reservation seeing Catra covered in bandages again, “You’re going to make me fix you up again after this, aren’t you?”
Catra catches the small grin on Entrapta’s face after she asks the question. Catra grins widely back, “Of course.” Catra stands up,

testing the movement in her body, "Yep, restricted movements are always my favourite. And besides, I wouldn't have anyone else fixing me up apart from you."
Entrapta gives Catra a concerned look and Catra returns the look with a dopey grin making the purple haired princess roll her eyes, "I'll get Emily and Emily the second ready. You and Melog head on first, I'll meet you there."
Catra nods as she pulls herself onto Melog's back again.
"Alright buddy, you know where to go." She turns to Entrapta one last time, "Uh, do you want me to do something with Prime before I go? Throw it? Burn it? Bury it?"
"Mm, I haven't decided yet." Entrapta thinks, "I might get Emily to go put him in the freezer until I decide…"
"Ok, sure… whatever you want to do." Catra pats Melog on the side as the alien cat trots out of the lab and away with Catra on their back, "See you there, Traps! Don't be late!" Catra calls cackling away.

Catra and Melog are waiting on the rooftop of the castle overseeing the woods. Catra looks around to where Adora's bedroom is, amazed that this was one room that didn't get bombed during the invasion. There's a light on in the room. Adora's in her room. Shadow Weaver ever the sentimental idiot has decided to use a familiar place to play her power move. She sees some rustling not too far from where Emily the second is hidden. It's not Entrapta. The silhouette is familiar. She looks around and there not too far in the distance is King Randor and a small army of troops along with a few familiar faces. Bow is standing next to the King looking concerned. Queen Angella surprisingly is also present. She's whispering into the ear of one her general to be relayed to the rest of the troops. This is not good. Entrapta finally arrives and settles down near Catra.
"This is not good." Entrapta whispers into Catra's ear, causing them to flick and hit her in the face. She doesn't move when it happens, "They cannot be here. They will increase the number of casualties."
"I know!" Catra growls back. "We've got two choices." Entrapta nods, listening intently. "Okay, King Randor and everyone else

thinks I'm dead right now. So option one, we go with the original plan and hope that they haven't got their shit together yet and we can get in and out before they even move in. Or option two, you scare them off with your Emily's and I can get in and out before they can make a move."
"Those both sound like terrible plans." Entrapta replies not impressed, "Why don't we work together with them? You know you'll have better odds not dying if Shadow Weaver has more targets."
Catra snorts at that assessment, "More targets? I don't think so Traps. We can't risk anymore people."
Entrapta nods, "You remember what Adora said right?"
"I do." Catra recalls, "But I also told her that I would lay my life down for her as well."
"Fine! I'll distract them. Option two is probably the better option anyways. Less casualties." Entrapta tells her, "I swear Catra, if you go get yourself killed…"
Catra cups Etrapta's face in her hands before she can spiral, "Hey. Hey look at me." Entrapta sniffs trying to hold back the tears, "I'm not going to die. Not anytime soon anyways."
"How can you be so sure?"
"Because everyone has tried and no one has succeeded." Catra smiles softly. When Entrapta doesn't move or say anything Catra sighs, "Remember that promise I made you when we went to save the King and Queen?" Entrapta nods, "I'm making that same promise now. I will return. Count on it."
Entrapta tries to smile. False hope is all she is going to get. So she nods as Catra releases her face and pulls her friend in for a hug.
"All this for a girl."
Catra snickers, "All this for my princess."
"We'll get them back." Entrapta says as she is released from the hug, "And it will all go well. It has to."
"Alright. I'll wait for your signal." Entrapta nods as she heads back to her robots.

Catra watches from her spot on the rooftop with Melog as Entrapta moves around with her two robots. She watches King Randor's group stays positioned near the bridge in the distance.

Catra doesn't like lying to the King but sometimes it's necessary. And she would rather die than let her mother or father face the same fate. Besides, Catra doesn't have a kingdom to run or rebuild. She can probably be replaced. Shadow Weaver would never hurt Adora. Catra knows that for a fact. She's always been that witch's favourite for some reason. Hopefully Sparkles is fairing well.

"Why the fuck did she stick us in your bedroom?" Glimmer huffs, pacing nervously up and down next to the bed, "I'm just saying, what does Shadow Weaver even want? She hasn't even made any demands!"
"She wants power." Adora answers, "She wants my father's kingdom."
"Why am I here then?"
"I'm not too sure Glim." Adora shrugs, "At least she hasn't done anything to us. She was always really bad to Catra."
"Your girlfriend Catra?" Glimmer raises an eyebrow teasingly.
Adora blushes and looks away, "We haven't really talked about any of that…"
"Mmhm."
"It's true!" Adora protests, "Every time I get her back, she's injured or dying or the combination of both."
Glimmer walks around the room and then goes to the balcony, "Can we climb down from here?"
Adora gets off the bed following Glimmer. She looks down over the balcony wall. "Glim, can't you just teleport us out of here?"
Glimmer gives Adora a look of 'well duh, I've tried', she crosses her arms over her chest, "Yes! I have tried to do that! Did you think I didn't try doing teleporting the first moment I got?"
"Sorry Glimmer." Adora leans against the railing of the balcony, "The only person I know that could get up and down these walls is Catra."
"Claws right?"
"Yeah."
Glimmer continues to look down, "She's crazy though, you know that right?"
"Yeah, it's pretty high up here." Adora replies looking out into the

distance, “She’s kind of fearless. Even when she’s standing up for me when she knows I’m wrong.” A small smile creeps up on Adora’s face.
Glimmer shakes her head with a smile, “I meant she’s crazy about you.”
“Oh! I, uh, I don’t know about that.” Adora pushes back a lock of hair behind her ear, “It’s still kind of new.”
Glimmer rolls her eyes, “She’s still an ass. Your Joke-ass.”
The two share a laugh before there’s a knock on the door. They both startle.
Adora calls out, “Who is it?” When no reply comes, she makes her way to the door. “I can’t open the door from my side.”
The door opens and a waves of black smoke wafts through.
“Adora.” Shadow Weaver greets, shutting the door behind her, “And Princess Glimmer. I hope your accommodations are… satisfactory.”
“It’s fine.” Adora answers, looking away from Shadow Weaver gaze, “What? Why are you here?” Why are we here? What do you want?”
Glimmer comes back over and stands next to Adora, her hands on her hips. Shadow Weaver growls at Glimmer’s protectiveness.
Shadow Weaver reaches her hand out and cups Adora’s jaw. Adora tries to shake it away but this time Shadow Weavers grip is tighter around it, “Why do you fight me? Do I not take care of you? Look out for you?”
Adora tries to take a step back, but Shadow Weaver has her frozen in place, “Please…”
“Let her go!” Glimmer shouts, “Leave her alone! What do you want?”
Shadow Weaver waves her arm and a puff of black smoke encases Glimmer, “Quiet Princess Glimmer.”
Glimmer goes limp, hanging in the air. Her eyes are wide open in fear as the black smoke fills her senses. Adora whimpers, “Stop. Please. Let her go.”
“I’m sorry Adora.” Shadow Weaver runs her thumb over Adora’s cheek as Adora turned her face away, “I didn’t quite hear that.”
Adora glares up at Shadow Weaver, her hands balled into fists. She knows Shadow Weaver is baiting her. As much as she wasn’t

to fight back, she knows that it might not end well for Glimmer. Instead, she answers, “Nothing, Shadow Weaver.”
“That’s what I thought.” Shadow Weaver let go of Adora’s chin. She flipped her wrist and Glimmer fell to the ground panting for breath. “Take care of Princess Glimmer, would you?”
“Yes, Shadow Weaver.” Adora replied.
“I’ll be back when that animal of yours returns to try to save you.” Shadow Weaver casually says as she exits the room. “I look forward to killing her once and for all.”
Adora helps Glimmer onto the bed, “Are you okay?”
Glimmer hisses with pain, “I’ll be fine Adora.” Adora sits on the bed next to Glimmer, worried. “Don’t worry Adora, your Joke-ass will be fine. She always is. Isn’t she?”

Entrapta’s distraction tactic to lure back King Randor and his forces from the castle and back further into the woods, unfortunately that tactic meant that the King’s forces were no longer able to use any elements of surprise since Entrapta’s robots are lighting up the woods like a Christmas tree. Catra can even hear Entrapta’s excited cackling in the distance.
Once the other troops have moved back to the safety of the woods far enough, Catra and Melog run along the rooftop towards Adora’s room using. Unfortunately Catra didn’t count on Melog’s steps being so heavy and making such obvious noises. She pulls Melog to a stop and leaps off their back.
“Sorry bud, your paws are too loud.” Catra whispers to a disappointed Melog, who picks up one of their paws and inspects it, “I’ll take it from here. Head inside and wait for me at the first meet up point.”
Melog makes a sound of understanding, quickly nudges Catra under her chin and then takes off in the other direction, still being loud and heavy on their paws. Every step makes Catra cringe. When Melog is far enough in the distance, Catra waits in place for a few minutes, just in case Shadow Weaver is listening to their footsteps. With Melog gone, Catra doesn’t have the element of invisible surprise so she’ll just have to rely on good old fashioned surprise. Once Catra is satisfied that the coast is clear she pads lightly and quietly towards Adora’s bedroom. It’s not often she has

to scale the rooftop to get there, but it'd be easier to drop down than climb up. Catra perches herself just above Adora's room waiting for Entrapta's signal to go.
Entrapta's crazy cackles get louder after every explosion as she gets more and more excited. The woods light up with every explosion, as Emily the second starts moving around the woods, stomping about and making a lot of noise. So much so that Adora and Glimmer rush out to the balcony and watch the ruckus. Catra looks around to see if the light show has caught the eye of Shadow Weaver, but so far there's no sign of her. Glimmer is pointing to the small fires and smoke bellowing in some parts of the woods, creating commentary on what she thinks it happening. Catra tries not to give away her position by laughing at Glimmer's very poor effort. Adora remains silent. Catra can see her body stiffen with every explosion. But it's not just the noise that has her worries, it's something else. Catra's ears twitch, staying on high alert as she continues to wait.
Finally a flare is shot up in air. That's the signal.
Catra hops down and lands behind the two princesses on the balcony, "Hey Adora."
Both Adora and Glimmer turn around lightening fast. Adora's eyes going wide as she see Catra, "You can't be here! She's planning to kill you!" Adora whisper-yells grabbing Catra's hand and pushing her towards the balcony.
"Yeah? But when is she not trying to kill me?" Catra quips much to Adora's disapproval as she gets Catra's back to the balcony, "Good thinking Princess. Exactly what I was thinking."
Catra pulls out a rope, moving back towards Adora's room as she ties the end to a pillar and comes back to the balcony, throwing the other end down. "What? Are we climbing down the wall? Glimmer asks rather loudly.
"Shh!" Catra shushes Glimmer, "But yes, we can't exactly walk out Adora's door, can we Sparkles?"
Catra pulls on the rope to make sure her knot is going to hold and then gestures for them to get moving, "Come on! Get going!"
Glimmer huffs, "I wouldn't have to climb down a rope if I had my powers."
"Well, you don't. So start climbing." Catra hisses.

“Fine!” Glimmer hops on the balcony rail, grabbing the rope in both hands and then freezing, “Fuck… it’s really high!”
“Seriously Sparkles?!” Catra growls as she stomps over to Glimmer, “Look at me Glimmer.”
Glimmer tears her gaze away from the height of the drop, “What?”
“One. Don’t look down.” Catra grabs Glimmers chin before she can look down again, “What did I just say?” She lets go of Glimmers jaw, “Second. Grab the rope and lean back, using your legs to kick out and you can walk down the wall. There’s enough notches and holds on the wall that you’ll be able to get down pretty easily. You’ll only need to get to the next large window. It shouldn’t be too far down from here. You can do it. Trust me.”
“Trust you?!” Glimmer raises her voice a little but Catra’s expression doesn’t change. That’s when Glimmer realises Catra was being sincere, “Ok, fine.” Glimmer takes a grounding breath and then start walking down the wall.
“You’re doing great Glimmer.” Adora encourages. “Just keep going. You’ll have your feet on the ground in no time.”
“Shut it, the both of you! I can’t concentrate!” Glimmer scolds much to Catra’s amusement, “Adora! Get your ass on this rope too!”
Adora turns to Catra who gestures for her to follow Glimmer down, when she doesn’t Catra gives her a questioning look, “I’m not carrying you down on my back Adora. My claws still hurt and you’re heavy.”
Adora shakes her head, “It’s not that.”
“Okay.” Catra tilts her head, “Adora, we have to go, like now!”
When Adora doesn’t move, Catra picks Adora up and heaves her over her shoulder, “If you’re going to be like that, then I will have to carry you down on my back.”
Catra grunts as she steps up onto the railing, “Adora, grab the rope.”
Letting Adora down back onto own two feet, she grabs the rope but doesn’t descend, “You need to come down too!”
Catra rolls her eyes, “Fine, we’ll climb and talk. Happy?”
Adora nods.
Catra watches Adora take the first step down, leaning back and

using her legs her first step is shaky, but Catra knows that once she gets into a rhythm, she'll descend faster. Catra breathes out a sigh of relief, "Go to the next window down. Melog will meet us there to bring you guys to the next check point. Go!"
Adora and Glimmer make their way down slowly, Catra watches.
"Catra! Look out!" Adora screams.
A bolt of red lightening hits Catra in the chest, scorching her white bandages as she loses her grip on the balcony railing and start to fall. By sheer luck, Adora manages to grab her hand on the descent causing Adora's legs to slip from the wall. Catra is pulled up into the castle with a decent whack.
"Argh…" Catra groans as Adora winces trying to keep hold of Catra's wrist.
"Catra…" Adora grits, "I can't… hold…"
Adora grip gives and Catra is no longer in Adora's hand as her eyes widen in horror.
"Fuck!" Catra grunts, "Fucking Prime! Fucking Shadow Weaver. Fucking claws." Catra swears louder as she winces and hisses in pain at digging her into the stones of the castle, "Traps is going to kill me…"
Catra looks up and sees Adora trying to right herself on the rope, her grip is waning with the extra effort of catching Catra and it doesn't look like she'll be able to hold on for too much longer. Grunting again Catra starts to climb up the wall using the notches and hand holds she's dug in over time getting close to Adora.
"Fuck it. Come here Adora."
Adora reaches her hand out to Catra who promptly grabs it and swings closer to Catra, "I don't think I can." Adora pants.
Pulling on Adora's hand hard, she manages to get Adora's hand onto her shoulder, "Okay, Princess. Hop on."
Squeezing Catra's shoulder, Adora lets the rope go as she wraps her other arm around Catra's neck tightly. Running out of air with Adora's chokehold, Catra climbs down to the window where Glimmer is waiting. Once they are safely inside, Catra lets Adora down before dropping to the ground to recover and catch her breath. There's some scratching from the other side of the door that startles Glimmer and Adora.
"Can one of you guys let Melog in please?" Catra mumbles from

her spot on the floor, “They don’t have thumbs, so opening doors is kind of hard.”
Adora crouches down next to Catra, massaging her arms while Glimmer cautiously moves to the door and slowly opens the door. The door swings open as Melog pushes their way in, nearly knocking over Glimmer in the process. Glimmer quickly shuts the door silently and leans up against it.
Melog nudges at Catra’s head to indicate their here, “Thanks bud. Give me a minute would you?” Melog ignores Catra and nudges her again, “Come on bud! I’m really fucking tired!” A third nudge and Catra begrudgingly get off the floor, “There! Are you happy?” Adora giggles watching Catra fight with Melog.
By the door, Glimmer huffs, “If you two are done fighting or whatever, should we, I don’t know…escape!”
“Yeah, yeah Sparkles. We’re coming.” Catra replies as she grabs Adora’s hand, “Come on Princess.”
“What’s the plan?” Adora whispers to Catra.
“We’re just going to walk out of here. Quietly.” Catra answers.
“What?!” Glimmer almost screeches before remembering to keep her voice down, “And how do you suppose to do that?”
Catra pretends to present Melog to Glimmer. Eventually it clicks in Glimmer’s brain. “We shouldn’t have to do touch each other like your magic. Melog can just get all of us as long as we are close together and within their view.” Turning back to Melog, “Ready bud?” Melog nods, “Okay, let’s go.”
Catra cautiously opens the door and peeks out, looking left and right, up and down. No sign of Shadow Weaver. Great. She pushes the door open a little wider and signals for the princesses to follow. Melog turns on his invisibility as they sneak out.
What they don’t see is the white eyes and black smoke of Shadow Weaver hiding in the far corner.

Chapter End Notes

Next time:
Final chapter = final showdown
Thanks for reading!

Finally!

Chapter Summary

The final showdown with Shadow Weaver

Chapter Notes

Final Chapter of this fic!
Did I keep you waiting too long for the finale?
As always, enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Are you sure we're invisible?" Glimmer asked, "Because I can see you guys, it doesn't make any sense!"
Catra turns around and glares angrily at Glimmer, hissing at her quietly, "Keep your voice down Sparkles! Unless you want to be electrocuted by Shadow Weaver again." Glimmer looked at Catra confused, "Yeah, I saw it happen."
Catra scoffed as she turned away from Glimmer's scowl before the sparkly princess whispers angrily back, "And you did nothing!"
"I'm sorry Sparkles. It would have given me away." Catra apologises flatly, "But, she wasn't trying to kill you though. Just a bit of torture." Catra faced Glimmer and smiled lopsidedly, "Trust me, I've felt the difference. When she's trying to torture it feels more…like a prolonged aching. When she's trying to kill you, well, you'll definitely know the difference."
Adora squeezes Catra's hand to bring her back, "Come on. We have to keep moving."
Catra nods and offers Glimmer one too as they continue on, "This way."
"Why aren't we going straight to the main entrance?" Adora asks as Catra leads them away in a different direction, "I thought you said we were going to just walk straight out."
"We are." Catra simply states, "Trust me."
"With my life." Adora completes Catra's sentence.
Melog stops in front of them. Their ears twitching along with

Catra's as they swivel their head side to side to find the source of the sounds they've been hearing. Catra on high alert too, she signals for everyone to stop, her claws sliding out in readiness.
"Guys…" Glimmer informs, "What's that?"
She points to something floating in the corner, dark shadows.
"Fuuuck!" Catra growls, "Adora! Sparkles! Run…now!"
Catra barrels straight into the shadows swinging wildly, connecting with nothing while Melog pouncing onto the walls where the shadow were.
"I'm not leaving you!" Adora shouts, getting into her fighting stance.
"Yeah, me neither." Glimmer smirks next to Adora.
They all remain silent for a moment as Catra signals for everyone to keep it zip up. Melog starts creeping towards the door quietly, Catra gestures for them to follow Melog towards the door and into the next room.
"Ahem." The clearing of Shadow Weavers throat sends a chill down Catra's spine as the group turn around facing the sound, "I am very disappointed."
They all stay silent and still, hoping Melog's invisibility magic will keep them out of harms way. They watch as Shadow Weaver floats from where she was hiding in the shadows on the walls and corporealizes to move among them. Catra suppresses a growl as does Melog upon seeing Shadow Weaver. Adora and Glimmer hold their fighting stances, ready to spring into action if needed.
Shadow Weaver eyes no longer glow green but back to white. Her scent is tainted with something else. Prime. She's mixed the serum in with her own dark magic.
Shadow Weaver moves around Catra first, slowly but deliberately. As there's no attack from the witch, Catra lets her pass. She floats past Melog and Glimmer stopping directly at in front of Adora. Shadow Weaver turns so she is face to face with the blonde.
"Adora."
Adora startles and jumps back instinctively, smacking herself back into the wall behind. Melog rushes in, baring their fangs and claws at Shadow Weaver, getting thrown back for their efforts. Glimmer runs at full speed, fists at the ready and is thrown into the same wall as Melog. Adora starts punching and kicking at Shadow

Weaver. She hits nothing but air and shadows.
“Hey Witch.” Catra drawls behind her, “I heard you were looking for me.”
Catra gets a well-timed swipe in at Shadow Weaver, knocking her mask off.
“Insolent!” Shadow Weaver throws out, swinging wildly. Catra dodges out of the way of her lashing out as Adora moves behind Shadow Weaver, trying to knock her down. “Enough!”
A wave of dark magic rises up through the shadows, lifting up all four of them. She opens the door that they were initially going to go through and tosses Melog and Glimmer out of it. They land with a thump as the doors slams shut again.
“Did you really think that creatures little magic trick could fool me?” She turns to Adora, “Well?”
Adora doesn’t say anything. Shadow Weaver snarls, dropping Adora down the ground before shoving her roughly up against the wall so she can get a clear view of Shadow Weaver without the mask.
“Leave her alone!” Catra shouts, still floating in the air, “You witch!”
Shadow Weaver moves her left hand up towards Catra and makes a fist, instantly the air around them changes. Red and blue lightening light up the dark room and the smell of smoke bellows in the air and the sound of Catra grunting as that lightening starts to run through her body.
“Now,” Shadow Weaver turns back to Adora, “where were we?”
“Stop it!” Adora yells.
“No. I don’t think I will.” Shadow Weaver chuckles wickedly, waving a finger around creating another swirl of electricity that runs through Catra, “I told you. The Jester will die by my hand.”
Adora tries to lash out at Shadow Weaver, but the dark magic swirling around keeps her in place, “Don’t.”
“Don’t what, Adora?” Shadow Weaver taunts, “How could you fall for such a lowly creature?”
“She’s not lowly!” Adora screams unable to break free, “What do you want?!”
Shadow Weaver releases both of them as Catra slumps down to the ground, gasping for air and spasming, twitching from her

overstimulated muscles.
“What do I want?” Shadow Weaver repeats. She paces around the room chuckling at the question, “Power. What else is there?” As Shadow Weaver looks back over to Adora, she notices that Adora is gone. And so is Catra. She lets out an angry growl as she storms out of the room.
While Shadow Weaver paced around, pondering her answer, Adora had swung Catra up and over her shoulder and ran out the door that Melog and Glimmer had been flung out. Adora looked around for Glimmer and Melog.
Glimmer comes rushing out to attack, Adora dodges out the way, “Glimmer! It’s me!”
“Adora?” Glimmer squints, “Adora! It is you!” Glimmer runs in for a hug before stopping just short, noticing Catra lifted up onto Adora’s shoulder, wiping the blood from her nose Glimmer snorts, “I knew we’d have to carry your Joke-ass at some point.”
“Shut it Sparkles…” Catra grunts out without any bite, “You didn’t just go through the death sparks.”
Melog comes round and Catra pats Adora on the shoulder to indicate for her to be put down. Catra pulls sits down beside Melog, “Thanks buddy.” She pets him on the side. Turning to speak to the two princesses, “We need to go. She’s coming. I can feel it.”
Holding on to Melog, Glimmer and Adora chase after the cats, running through the castle. They stop for a moment so the princesses can catch their breaths.
“Hey Adora?” Catra asks, “You got my pocketknife? You know, the one Traps stabbed me in the neck with?”
Adora pats down her clothes, “Aha!” she pulls out the pocketknife and hands it to Catra, “Here. It’s yours after all.”
Catra takes it and rolls it around in her hand before pocketing the item, “Thank you.”
Adora smiles softly back at Catra, “Your welcome. I think you should hold on to it a little better. Every time you lose it or give it away, you almost die. So, keep it for now.”
Catra nods. “We need to get up high. Rooftop high.” Catra smirks at Adora, “Do you want to be the bait again Princess Adora?”
Adora huffs, “What makes you think she’d follow me anyways?”

“Pretty sure she wants you for some twisted reason.” Glimmer throws out into the conversation, “Has she always been that creepy around you?”
Adora shrugs, “I don’t know. I never really thought about it.” She rubs the back of her neck, “She wasn’t really even around me that much.”
“Pfft, that’s a fact.” Catra agrees, “When she wasn’t creeping around you, she was torturing me. She hid it so well that no one even knew it was happening.” Catra sighs, “But enough about her being a creep. We need to move.”
Catra looks around, “Sparkles, go with Melog. Shadow Weaver won’t follow you.” Before Glimmer can argue Catra adds, “When you get out of the castle, find Entrapta. Tell her we’ll be on the roof and to get ready for my signal.”
“Where the fuck am I supposed to find Entrapta when we get out?” Glimmer shrieks.
“Melog will lead you to her.” Catra answers casually, she leans down to Melog, “Take care of her, okay?”
Melog nudges under her chin in acknowledgement as Glimmer pulls herself on Melog’s back, taking off full speed. They disappear into the darkness. Catra grabs Adora’s hand, “Come on Princess, we need to go up.”
Adora inhales deeply, “Okay.”
Catra senses Adora’s anxiety, “Hey,” Adora looks over, “Bet I can beat you to the top.”
A cheeky grin appears on Adora’s face as she pushes Catra back before sprinting off upstairs with Catra yelling and laughing after her. Adora runs up two flights of stairs and instantly winds herself as Catra catches up.
“Hey! That’s not fair!” Adora pants after Catra who’s making light work of the stairs.
Before Catra can make a witty remark, there’s a chill in the air. They look at each other knowingly, Catra comes back down and puts a hand on Adora’s shoulder, “You’ll be fine. She likes you. I’ll meet you up top. Just lead her up.” Catra plants a quick kiss on Adora’s lips and then bounds up the stairs as fast as she can so not to be seen by Shadow Weaver.
“Adora.” Shadow Weaver calls from a few steps below, “Why are

you avoiding me?”
Adora laughs at that question, “You kidnapped me and locked me in my room!” Shadow Weaver stills, “And you’ve been hurting Catra for years! I’m going to get as far away from you as I can.”
Adora finds a second wind as she starts running up the stairs two at a time whilst Shadow Weaver growls, “Come back here, child!”
Concentrating on getting up the stairs, Adora doesn’t reply. He legs burn from sprinting up the stairs and her lungs are on fire but she pushes on until she can see the door to the roof. The closer she gets to the door, the more she realises there’s actually no need for one as there’s a very large hold right next to it, most likely from one of the blasts. Adora is breathing hard as she pushes through and arrives on the rooftop stone surface. She looks around for somewhere to hide, but there’s not more there to get behind. So instead she moves as far from the stairs as she can.
Shadow Weaver blasts the door away, splinters of wood and pieces of rock fly through the air as Adora ducks trying to avoid the larger bits. Adora stands back upright and sees Shadow Weaver standing where the doorway once was. Her scarred face and white eyes glare at Adora, she looks to be suppressing a snarl. Adora stands her ground, ready to fight.
They stare at each other in silence until Shadow Weaver breaks the silence with a sigh.
“Princess Adora, come to me.” Shadow Weavers voice softer, luring.
“No.” Adora replies simply.
“I will not ask you again.” Shadow Weaver warns with a tinge of annoyance in her voice.
“No.” Adora repeats defiantly.
Shadow Weaver shakes her head in disappointment, “The Jester has corrupted you.” Before Adora can answer, Shadow Weaver wraps Adora in her dark magic and pulls her towards herself, holding Adora up with magic just a breath away. “Prime may be gone, but the power he infected me with still exists in me, as it does in the Jester.” To prove her point she squeezed her grip around Adora’s body making the blonde gasp at the sudden tightening and it becomes a little harder to breathe.

“What do you want?” Adora grits out her chest squeezed by the dark magic.
“Ah, sweet child.” Shadow Weaver lulls, “I want power.”
“But you’ve already got power.” Adora tries to reason.
Seeing Adora struggle to breathe, Shadow Weaver releases her grip on the princess, “You can never have enough power, Princess Adora.” Reaching into her robes, Shadow Weaver pulls out a vial with green liquid in it, similar to the one Catra found in the castle debris when they were searching for secret rooms.
“What’s that?” Adora asks.
Holding the serum up to Adora’s face, Shadow Weaver grins, “This is a modified version of the serum that Prime uses. I’m going to inject you with it and you will be under my control.”
“No!” Adora shouts trying to break free of the dark magic. “Get away from me!”
“Argh!” Shadow Weaver screams as the hold on Adora releases and she falls to the ground. She looks up and sees Shadow Weaver clutching her face, fresh claw marks across her face. Adora gets up quickly, moving away from Shadow Weaver and into her fighting stance.
“Didn’t you hear the Princess?” Catra rasps, she’s perched on the edge of the roof wall, “She said, get away from her.” The growl escapes Catra’s chest as she finishes the sentence.
Shadow Weaver doesn’t say anything as she lifts her arms and throws red lightning bolts at Catra. Following the jester as she dodges and moves around the rooftop, trying to stay clear of Adora. Meanwhile Adora creeps up, trying to get behind Shadow Weaver for a surprise attack. As Shadow Weaver is distracted, Adora strikes Shadow Weaver in the back of the head with a large stone. The stone breaks on impact as Shadow Weaver turns and swings wildly, smacking Adora on the side of the head and knocking her out.
Catra rushes in, pouncing on Shadow Weavers back and digging her claws in. Using her claws like the reins for a horse, Catra pulls Shadow Weaver away from Adora’s body that is currently slumped against the wall. Grunting with effort, Catra yells out, “Now!”
Emily the second fires 3 shots, all landing on their mark on Shadow Weavers chest. The witch cries out in pain as the shot hit

her chest spilling a mix of green and red blood from her body. Shadow Weaver grabs Catra and body slams her into the ground, winding the Jester who groans in pain. Not too far away she can hear the familiar cackle of Entrapta's voice. The purple haired princess is yelling something in the distance that Catra can't quite make out as Catra's head begins to pound from the impact. The next thing she hears is a growl that isn't hers, that's when she realises it's actually Shadow Weaver, looming over her, dripping blood on her.

"Hey Shadow Weaver." Catra croaks out, "Could you scoot back a bit? You're bleeding on me and it's kind of gross."

Shadow Weaver picks up Catra's left foot and starts dragging her away, "Always the joker, aren't you?"

With inhuman strength, Shadow Weaver swings Catra like a baseball bat into a wall that separates the castle buildings. Catra groans again, she can feel blood pooling behind her head. Catra tries to sit up, quickly deciding that's a terrible idea and keeps herself slumped to the side instead, "Well, I am the court appointed Jester. So, yeah, if the name fits, I sits."

"Shut up!" Shadow Weaver growls, "Where is Adora?"

Catra tries to focus, but her head feels heavy and her eyes hurt, "She probably went to get you a present." Catra chuckled to herself on the ground, turning enough to lie on her back. She can feel Shadow Weaver looming over her again, "Seriously witch, stop bleeding on me. I don't want to catch whatever disease you have."

"Enough." Shadow Weaver growls, lifting Catra up with her dark magic, "Any last words?"

Catra growls as she eyes the 3 shots that Emily the second had put into her chest, "Yeah." Catra grins, "Boom."

Shadow Weaver gives her a confused look before she drops Catra to the ground, hissing in pain as she looks down at the 3 wounds on her chest. Catra just cackles maniacally as she tries to get further away from Shadow Weaver.

BOOM! BOOM! BOOM! Thump.

The 3 shots Emily the second had shot into Shadow Weaver's chest had detonated from the small explosives Entrapta had loaded into the ammunition. It wasn't enough to kill her, but it put

a big dent into the witch's torso and her magic. The witched heaved, slumping over and collapsing onto the floor. Blood pooled around her.
"Seriously!?" Catra tried to shout, "How did that not kill you?!" Groaning she forces herself to get up, "Now I have to actually get up again."
Shadow Weaver chuckled through her own pain, "If I die, I'm taking you down with me."
"Fuck!" Is all Catra can say when Shadow Weaver charges towards Catra, hands hat the ready to grab the jester. Catra manages to kick Shadow Weaver hard enough making them both fall over. They are both panting on the ground. Catra rolls over first and she watches Shadow Weaver do the same. Catra has her hands on her knees, trying to take deeper breaths while Shadow Weaver slouches over, touching the blood leaking from her chest. Catra hears a snarl from the witch.
A red bolt of lightning hits Catra's body, burning her from inside out. Before Catra's eyes squeeze shut in pain she sees the evil grin on Shadow Weaver's face, taking great pleasure in torturing her. She sees a blonde blur sprint towards Shadow Weaver and the burning stops. Adora has sprinted over and punched Shadow Weaver, breaking her concentration. Catra can hear Adora grunting as she continues to throw punches at Shadow Weaver, landing a few and knocking the witch back a few steps. Shadow Weaver blocks the barrage of punches and kicks from Adora, growling loudly before grabbing Adora by the neck and squeezing.
"No!" Catra shouts. Ignoring all the pain in her body and the blood stinging her eyes she sprints towards Shadow Weaver and pounces on her back once more, digging her claws in. This time she stabs at the witch with her pocketknife. Eventually burying the blade into the witch's neck causing Shadow Weaver to let go of Adora, flinging her arms violently trying to get Catra off her back and pull out the knife that has been buried in her neck. Catra refuses to let go of the knife's handle, using it hang on to Shadow Weaver a little longer. Adora appears out of the blue and shifts Catra's hand off the handle and drags the blade across Shadow Weavers throat, opening up her neck and cutting through the vital arteries and veins.

Catra leaps off Shadow Weaver's back, Adora drags them back far enough from Shadow Weaver's reach as they watch the once Royal Advisor choke and gurgle on her own blood, unable to breathe. The sound of her slowly dying is awful, even if she was not a good person, but they couldn't risk getting too close and falling for one of her tricks again. Eventually all her choking and gurgling dies down and Catra and Adora breathe out in relief.
"Hey Adora." Catra croaks out, "Not to wreck this absolutely perfect moment, but before I pass out again…" Catra's legs give out from under her as she tries to lower herself down to the ground gracefully but ends up kind of plopping down instead even with Adora trying to support her. "Thanks. I think I'm good down here. Join me."
"Okay." Adora drops down to the floor a lot with a lot more coordination.
Catra's bloodied hand rests on Adora's thigh, "So," a hiss of pain, "I know this isn't the epic proposal or fancy or even the right time…"
Adora leans in and kisses Catra on the lips, hard. Then she whispers, "Yes."
Catra cackles, "I haven't even…" another kiss, "asked you…" Adora kisses down Catra's neck, "anything yet?" Catra stops Adora's kisses and just cups her cheeks in her hands, "Are you sure?"
Rolling her eyes for good effect and planting another kiss on Catra's lips, "Yes."
"Cool." The dopey grin returns to Catra's face, "Assuming your father doesn't kill me first."
"He's not going to kill you. Trust me." Adora returns, "I'm pretty sure he's gotten over himself now."
Catra laughs, "Also if you keep kissing me, I'm definitely going to pass out." Adora nods feeling a little embarrassed, "Don't worry it, Princess." Catra reaches into her pants pocket and pulls out a device, "I hope this didn't get fried." She pushes the button on the device as it beeps.
"Hello?" Entrapta's voice comes through the device, "Catra?"
"Hey Traps," Catra rasps, hissing as she tries to shift so she can lay down, "come get us?"
"Are you hurt?" Entrapta voice filled with concern before changing

back to her perky self, “Well…if you can talk to me, you must be fine... mentally.”
Catra chuckles, “I’m not too bad Traps. Didn’t even get stabbed this time. Can’t say the same for Shadow Weaver though. Pretty sure she’s dead. But you might want to confirm when you get here.”
“We’re on our way.” Entrapta ensures, “Also, Adora?”
“Hey Traps.” Adora answers a little too loud, “I’m okay too. Just a few cuts and bruises.”
“No, that’s not what I was going to ask.” She pauses realising that she probably should have asked, “But, uh, that’s good you’re not hurt. I was actually going to ask you to make sure Catra doesn’t fall asleep or pass out.”
“Oh! Of course.” Adora replies, “Do you know where to find us?”
“Find who?” before Adora can answer, Catra and Entrapta are both cackling. Adora flicks Catra’s ear in retaliation making Catra go from laughing to grunting in pain.
“Ow!” Catra tries to reach up to rub her ear but realises her arm feels too heavy to do that, “Fine, I deserved that… but Entrapta started it!”
“What? Are you five?” Adora scolds.
“Okay! We’ll be there soon!” Entrapta hangs up ignoring Adora's scolding of Catra.
Adora talks to Catra, keeping her awake until the others can reach them. It’s not long until they are back in Bright Moon recovering.

Back in Bright Moon infirmary, Catra’s back in the infirmary, more bandage than herself again. Entrapta probably broke a few of Catra’s already fragile ribs when she had run up and hugged Catra upon seeing her hurt all over again. After more scolding and not so gentle bandaging, Entrapta had relaxed enough to get back going over her notes and how to improve the ammunition to be bigger and more impactful. Adora had been taken away to get checked over and came back as soon as they let her. It seemed everyone had wanted to check up on Catra after everything that happened. She heard Glimmer try to trick her into acknowledging them by calling Catra all sorts of crazy names, mainly Joke-ass, dumbass or just plain old ass. Catra would pretend she was

sleeping so they would leave her alone and it worked…mostly.
It didn't work on King Randor or his wife.
"I know you aren't asleep Jester." King Randor warned teasingly, "We saw your ear twitch when we walked in. You aren't as smooth as you think you are."
Catra cracked an eye open and the Queen shouts, "AHA! I saw that!"
"Argh. Fine! You got me!" Catra groans, "What can I do for you majesties? Perhaps a song? Or a limerick? I can't do anything physical because, well, you know…I'm kind of broken."
The King flicked Catra in the ear as Catra suppressed the urge to swear in front of the royals, "That's for letting me think you were dead!"
"You've been hanging around Adora too much, my King." Catra grits rubbing her ear, "Where is she anyways?"
"I asked her to give us a few minutes alone with you." The Queen replied.
Catra nodded but looked confused.
"Here." The King holds out a small box, "Take it."
"Uh, what is it?" Catra takes the box.
"My gift to you to give to Adora." The King says plainly like she should have known.
Catra's ear twitch on her head upon hearing all of that, she hadn't even opened the box yet so has no idea what the King is talking about. Opening the box with one hand, she looks up at the king even more confused, "A mini pack of playing cards?"
The King and Queen break off into a rambunctious laughing fit, while Catra just stares at the 'gift' they've given her, "Stop…" the king tries to stop laughing, "it's just…too… funny!"
They break out again in laughter as Catra clears her throat, "Okay… did you guys get into the good stuff already or have you been raiding Entrapta's mini playing card sets?"
"No, Jester." The Queen calms down enough to answer for the both of them, "We haven't started celebrating yet. We are waiting for you to be well enough before we do."
"Uh, okay. Thanks my Queen." Catra looks down.
King Randor now calmer, puts a hand on Catra's shoulder, "Give them to Adora. And I swear, if you hurt her…" the King turns

serious, scary even, “I will kill you myself.”
“Randor!” the Queen shoves her husband playfully, “Leave Catra alone. I’m sure Catra will not wilfully hurt our daughter.”
“Hate to break it to you two, but she’s already said yes.” Catra admits, “I thought she’d already told you.”
“Always the joker.” The royals laugh again, “When exactly did you even have time to propose? You don’t even have a ring?” The King asks. “And don’t tell me you did it because you thought you were dying.” Catra looked away, “Really?!”
Catra nods sheepishly, “I thought I’d only have one chance…” Catra almost whispers the last part.
“Well, that won’t do.” King Randor pretends to think, “I have an idea.”
“No!” Catra protests, “It’s done. You’re too late!”
“Bring Adora in.” King Randor gestures to one of his guards, “You are going to do this right. I don’t care how hurt you are.”
Adora walks in, confusion on her face as she sees her parents standing by Catra’s face with smiles plastered on their faces, “Um, hi?”
“Adora. Come over here.” Her father grins, “The Jester has something to ask you.”
Catra rolls her eyes at the King’s lame attempts to help her. Her eyes refocus on Adora who comes closer until she’s standing next to the bed and holds lays her hand in Catra’s, “What’s this?”
“A mini pack of cards.” Catra answers glaring at the King and Queen. Adora has the same look of confusion on her face that Catra had not that long ago, “Yeah, don’t ask.” King Randor being ever the opposite of subtle nudges Catra on the thigh causing Catra to yelp in pain.
Adora interrupts whatever is going on, “Okay, what are you guys up to?”
Catra groans, she can’t even sit up to face palm, “Adora, I tried to explain to the King and Queen that I’ve already proposed and you said yes.” Adora blushes, she hadn’t told anyone yet, “Then the King decides he wants to ‘do it right.’” Catra turns to her future in-laws, “What does that even mean?!”
Adora smiles, “Technically, you didn’t finish your proposal…”
A look of betrayal on Catra’s face makes Adora giggle.

“You know what? Nope. I don’t want to be a part of this weird ass family that's nearly gotten me killed multiple times.” Catra huffs with very little intent behind those words, “I take it back.”
Adora clutches her heart dramatically, “No? So, you want to go back to watching me be flirted with while I find a suitor?”
A low growl from Catra’s throat gives her away, “Fine. I don’t take it back.” Catra rolls her eyes, she gingerly takes the cards out of the deck and goes through it, finding what she’s after, she puts the rest of the pack down on the bed and clears her throat.
“Adora, I didn’t think I’d have to do this again or in front of an audience…” Catra glares at the King and Queen, “But since we are no longer in danger from the likes of Prime or Shadow Weaver, would you…marry me?”
As she said the last two words, she held out 2 playing cards.
Adora takes the two cards, “I don’t know if these two cards go together?” Adora teases but leans in for a kiss, whispering “Yes” into Catra’s lips.
“I’m sorry dear, what was your answer?” The Queen chooses that exact time to ruin the moment.
“I said yes.” Adora answers without even looking away from Catra, who’s looking at her with the dopiest grin she’s ever had. “I knew you were my wildcard. My Joker.”

Turns out, the mini packet of cards the King gave to Catra were custom made cards to reflect the mark on Catra’s arm from the oath. One of the Joker and one of the future Queen Adora. Because the King and Queen wanted a holiday before the big rebuild had to happen and they were happy to leave it in Adora and Catra’s very capable hands. Once Adora’s Jokers body had healed that is.

Chapter End Notes

So, you've reached the end.
Hope you enjoyed the story as much as I enjoyed writing it.
Thanks for reading!
Until next time :)

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!